

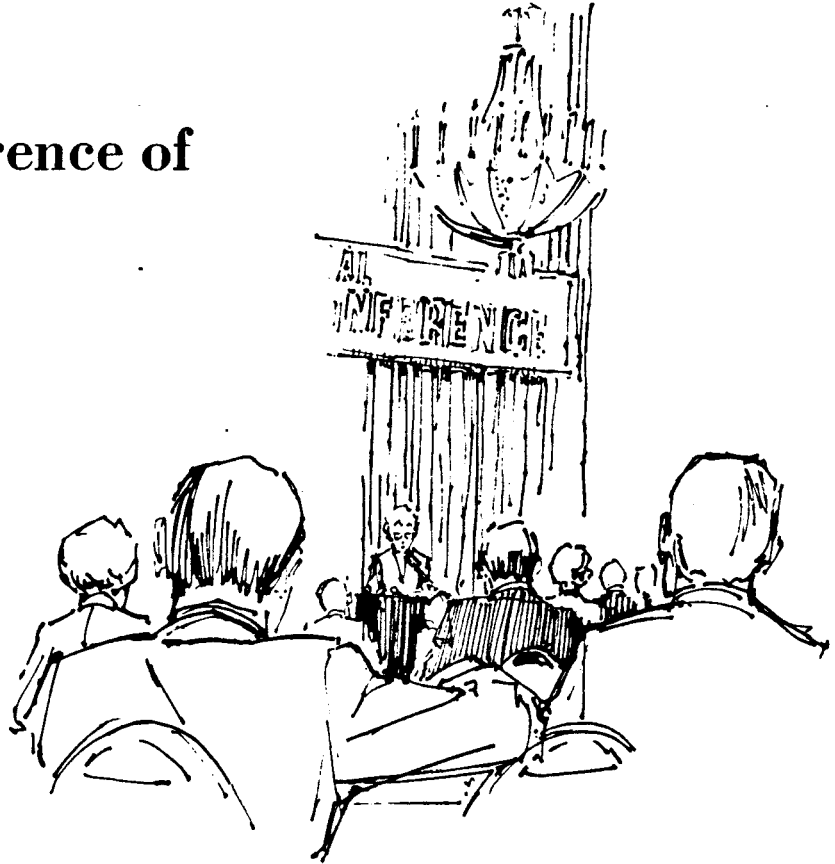
Unity: Through Love and Service

The Twenty-Fifth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1975

Final Report

Hotel Roosevelt
New York
April 21 - 26



Copyright 1975 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.

Mail address: Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, N.Y. 10017



Confidential – full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

Regions: See Nominating Committee report, p. 37; Advisory Action 67, p. 49

A.A. Regional Forums: See trustee committee and staff reports, pp. 35, 36

Regional trustees: See Floor Action 5, pp. 45-46; brief biographies, pp. 58-59

Contents

	Page		Page
Conference at Quarter-Century Mark		G.S.B. and G.S.O. Reports: Massive A.A. Growth Shown in	
Off to a High Start (opening day)	5	Reports of Trustees, Directors, Staff, Committees	
Love Feast (opening dinner)	5	General Service Board	27
"Silver Is Symbolic of Feeling and Love" (keynote)	5	A.A. World Services	27
New York A.A.'s Extend Hospitality	6	Literature distributed - 1974	28
New Archives Room Thrills Delegates	7	Archives	28
A Verbal Medley Shows Unity (closing talk)	7	Conference	28
Four Trustees Bid Farewell (closing brunch)	7	40th Anniversary International Convention	30
		Cooperation with the Professional Community	31
Presentations and Workshops: Four Big Subjects		Institutions	32
Explored at Depth		Internationalists	32
Understanding and Living the Twelve Traditions		Literature	33
Our Legacy of Unity	8	Loners	33
Personal sobriety tools found in the Twelve Traditions	8	Nominating	33
How the Traditions counsel humility and responsibility in our sober lives	8	Overseas	34
A.A. love and structure for sharing help us avoid bossism and fights	10	Policy	35
Anonymity saves us from empty ambition	10	Public Information	36
Group Support for Group Services		Service Coordinator	36
Groups improve traditional support of services - but the deficit lingers	11	Staff Coordinator	37
Contributions from a larger percentage of groups stressed as an important aim	11	World Service Meeting	37
When we blow out A.A. anniversary candles, let us light a few	12	A.A. Directories	38
How freeloading groups can pitch in to help the Fellowship beat inflation	12	Finance - see Presentations, page 11	
Grapevine		Grapevine - see Presentations, page 12	
Circulation at peak in spite of price rise	12	Ask-It Basket: Questions Reflect Fellowship Concerns	38
Can the Grapevine avoid controversy?	13	Advisory Actions (Conference committee reports):	
Our magazine both records and makes A.A. history	14	1975 Conference Voices Group Conscience	
Who jumped on the packages?	15	Floor Actions	41
Some good uses for the Grapevine	15	Agenda	42
A.A.'s Twelve Concepts for World Service		Conference Report and Charter	42
"The future belongs to you"	15	Cooperation with the Professional Community	43
Understanding the Concepts, for us, begins with just showing up - sober	16	Finance	43
Who decides? Who acts? What about unpopular views?	16	Grapevine	43
For decisions, these tools are helpful in our home areas	17	Institutions	43
Delegated authority - and the Six Warranties at work	17	International Convention	44
		Literature	44
Workshops and Discussion Topics: Discussions Cover a Variety of Topics		Policy and Admissions	44
A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field: consensus reached on terminology and roads to clearer understanding	19	Public Information	45
Unstructured Workshops: topics chosen on the spot for free-ranging discussions	19	Committee on Trustees	46
Is Sponsorship Slipping or Only Changing?		Delegates-Only Meeting	46
Where does sponsorship begin today?	19	Financial Data	
Modern sponsorship remains true to A.A.	20	Income Statement: General Service Office	47
A.A. Literature: Is There Too Much? Is It Too Specialized?		Income Statement: A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	48
Is It Becoming a Substitute for Person-to-Person Contact?		Combined Balance Sheet: G.S.O. and Grapevine	49
Literature is no substitute for handshakes and sponsorship	20	1975 G.S.O. Budget	50
Literature array responds to needs and fills a big budget gap	20	1975 Grapevine Budget	50
The Role of the District Committee Member		Growth and Money at G.S.O.	50
Many small districts prove more effective than a few large ones	21	1974 Group Contributions	51
These five tips on better D.C.M.'s can bring other benefits, too	21	Rosters	
Personal Service Highlights	22	1975 Conference Committees	52
		1975 Trustees' Committees	53
		Who Makes Up the Conference?	53
		1975 Conference Members	
		Trustees (General Service Board)	54
		A.A.W.S. directors, G.S.O. staff, Grapevine directors, Grapevine staff	56
		Area delegates	56
		Electoral Map - U.S. and Canada	59

1950-1975

25 Historic Years—Two Silver Anniversaries

- 1950 Traditions "formally adopted" at A.A.'s First International Convention, in Cleveland, Ohio; in the November Grapevine, Bill W. wrote: "Dr. Bob and I propose the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous . . . representatives who will sit yearly . . ."
- 1951 First meeting of General Service Conference (37 delegates, gathering at New York's Hotel Commodore April 19-22) voted A.A.'s basic literature should be "Conference-approved"
- 1952 Conference members unanimously approved Bill's and Lois's encouragement of Al-Anon Family Groups
- 1953 Conference rejected the idea of incorporating A.A.
- 1954 Conference approved the title (and duties) of general service representative (G.S.R.)
- 1955 Third Legacy accepted at Second International Convention, in St. Louis, Missouri
- 1956 Conference approved formation of a trustees' Public Information Committee
- 1957 Conference approved publication of "A.A. Comes of Age," by Bill
- 1958 Conference recommended the name change from General Service Headquarters to General Service Office
- 1959 Conference voted that the confidential *A.A. World Directory* be used for A.A. purposes only
- 1960 Conference urged special study of clubhouses
- 1961 Because of financial factors, Conference rejected paperback edition of Big Book
- 1962 Conference approved Concepts for world service
- 1963 Conference affirmed there is no formal relationship between A.A. and religious retreats
- 1964 Conference approved protection by copyright of A.A. Grapevine material
- 1965 Conference approved proposal for pamphlets "The G.S.R.," "The A.A. Group," "A.A. in Your Community," "A.A. in Hospitals," and "A.A. in Prisons"
- 1966 Conference agreed General Service Board should have 14 A.A., seven nonalcoholic members
- 1967 Publication of "As Bill Sees It," a small book of daily readings, was announced
- 1968 Conference approved plan for first "sobriety survey" of U.S. and Canadian A.A.'s
- 1969 Conference okayed color-TV public service announcements about A.A.
- 1970 35th Anniversary International Convention attracted 11,800 to Miami Beach, Florida
- 1971 Conference recommended forming trustees' committee on cooperation with the professional community
- 1972 Conference recommended limit on individual members' contributions to G.S.O. be raised from \$200 to \$300 per year
- 1973 Conference members got first copies of new A.A. booklet, "Came to Believe. . ."
- 1974 Conference approved plan for publication of new booklet, "Living Sober"
- 1975 Conference urged wider study and use of Traditions and Concepts

Groups and members — spring 1975

	Groups	Members
United States	14,448	287,699
Canada	2,427	42,922
Overseas	6,088	107,127
Hospitals	1,046	28,057
Prisons	1,021	35,962
Lone Members		450
Internationalists		516
Totals	25,030	502,733

(Including nonreported members, actual membership is estimated at more than 800,000 worldwide, in 92 countries.)

Confidential — full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This new usage — to facilitate communication within the Fellowship — was recommended by the Report and Charter Committee (see p. 42) and approved by the Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

Off to a high start

Exactly at 10:00 a.m. Monday, John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., nonalcoholic chairman of our General Service Board, mounted the dais at the front of the Terrace Room of New York's Hotel Roosevelt, to welcome the 133 members of the historic 25th annual meeting of the General Service Conference of A.A. (U.S. and Canada). The flags of the two countries and New York State and a banner proclaiming the Conference theme ("Unity – Through Love and Service") formed the setting for speakers.

Ninety-one area delegates (see pp. 56-58) sent by U.S. and Canadian A.A. groups and 42 other Conference members (see pp. 54-56), who made up the voting membership, sat facing the dais at long tables laden with ashtrays, pencils and paper, and pitchers of iced water.

They had begun drifting into the adjoining Oval Room at 9:00 a.m. for registration, picking up their portfolios and expense checks, having coffee, and chatting with old and new friends.

Ann Macfarlane, G.S.O. staff member retiring September 1, gave a moving keynote address (at right) on the Conference theme. Ann had attended the first Conference in 1951 and every succeeding one except that of 1964, her "sabbatical" year.

Welcome was also extended by Richard ("Mick") McFarland (Kentucky), area delegates' chairman, before Robert ("Pearse") Pearson, general manager, made introductions: Conference committee chairpersons, the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, nine nonalcoholic G.S.O. department heads (see p. 56), and many of the employees in these departments.

After Dr. Jack gave the report of the General Service Board (see p. 27), Pearse sketched briefly the mechanics of the Conference, and Cora Louise ("Loving Invitation") Belford, Conference secretary, reviewed the agenda.

The Conference was on the way to completion of its first quarter-century.

Love feast

By the time Silver Anniversary Conference members and guests arrived at the Grand Ballroom on the mezzanine of the Hotel Roosevelt for the opening dinner Monday evening, everyone (some 300) looked already "high" on the love part of the Conference theme.

When Bob Hitchins ("the cemetery drunk") quieted the excited throng, there was a hush for the invocation delivered by Dr. Jack. When Pearse (Bob Pearson, the bell-ringer) introduced among the guests a dainty white-haired woman in a white and silver gown, the crowd rose to its feet applauding Lois, widow of co-founder Bill (and "First Lady of Al-Anon"). Later, she led us in the Lord's Prayer to close the evening's A.A. meeting.

The meeting consisted of 17 three-minute talks by G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, led by Pete Slager, delegate from

Western Michigan, who was also the featured speaker. He told of "leading a sheltered life" – almost 20 years in prisons (four in solitary confinement without a bath, shave, or haircut) during his active alcoholism. "If I had to go through those 20 years again to get here, I'd do it," Pete said.

Keynote

For the first time in history, a G.S.O. staff member made the keynote talk, at the historic 25th meeting. She is the senior (in service) staff person, Ann Macfarlane, currently staff coordinator, who retires September 1 after 27 years at G.S.O.

'Silver is symbolic of feeling and love'

This year we commemorate two anniversaries: the 25th annual Conference meeting and the 25th year since our Traditions were accepted by the Fellowship.

Twenty-five years means a silver anniversary. I like knowing that silver is symbolic of feeling and love, very right for us as A.A. members.

First, we received our Legacy of Recovery, the Steps. Then we accepted the Second Legacy, the Traditions. Finally, we resolved that the General Service Conference should become the voice of the group conscience of the Fellowship, guardian of the Traditions, and sole successor to Bill and Dr. Bob.

In this anniversary of the Traditions, it is good for all of us to reaffirm their binding power, and to be grateful for them. They appear symbolically as the Unity leg of the triangle within the circle which stands for the whole world of A.A.

The words Unity, love, and Service slip easily off A.A. tongues. They're big words, but what do they mean specifically? To me, Unity means that diverse elements – and that's us, all right – are all working together to find ways to make a harmonious whole, so our primary purpose can be carried out most effectively.

Unity also means continuity. We need more than a momentary feeling of unity, so we may continue to exist for the alcoholics of tomorrow. This is our ideal, and also our achievement. I am not saying we have ever had perfect harmony among ourselves – far from it. But it seems to me a continuing miracle that, in spite of many differences, we keep on trying to put principles before personalities. Only by doing so can we do best what A.A. was formed as a fellowship to do.

Service means, as Bill said, anything whatever that legitimately helps us reach alcoholics. There is an infinite variety of A.A. service work for us to do. One way to actualize the meaning of Service is through the Conference – our Service Legacy – the structure which makes it possible for us to consult the group conscience of A.A. Now, the World Service Meeting provides a worldwide sharing of experience, strength, and hope, so we can do better Twelfth Step work wherever we are.

Love is a big word, and yet it's very simple, as all of us in A.A. know. It's hard to define, since it is a feeling, but we are experiencing it this minute, and we know without explanations what

Opening day

it means for us. More than anything else, it was the love in people that brought healing to me.

It colors all we do, say, or think. This doesn't mean we are continually swept up in waves of love. As humans, we are vulnerable to envy, anger, or resentment; but we are exceptionally lucky to have our program to guide us back to our true selves — and to the knowledge that we are in harmony when we are experiencing love.

Bill said the Traditions “ask each of us to lay aside pride and resentment. They ask for personal as well as group sacrifice. They ask us never to use the A.A. name in any quest for personal power or distinction or money. The Traditions guarantee the equality of all members and the independence of all groups. They show how we may best relate ourselves to each other and to the world outside. They indicate how we can best function in harmony as a great whole. For the sake of the welfare of our entire Society, the Traditions ask that every individual and every group and every area in A.A. shall lay aside all desires, ambitions, and untoward actions that could bring serious division among us or lose for us the confidence of the world at large. The Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous symbolize the sacrificial character of our life together, and they are the greatest force for unity that we know.”

Essentially, nothing has changed for us since the Fellowship accepted our service responsibilities on that historic 1955 day in St. Louis. The Traditions have kept us whole as a fellowship. We are, almost without trying, a stable society, because of the strong framework that we have for our lives: our Steps, our Traditions, and the Conference itself.

None of these Legacies, including the Steps, were achieved without trouble and difficulty. They were not handed down to us after a flash of revelation, but were brought about through struggle and conflict.

We are all such individuals! We are not saints. Without some conflict, there can be no sense of life. If it had not been for the passionate interest and love that many A.A.'s have had and have for the survival of our program, and the way they voiced their concern, A.A. might not have evolved as it has. God works through people, and not just the so-called good ones.

I'd like to review some unifying Conference actions. In 1951, when 37 delegates, representing the most populated centers of A.A. growth, met together for the first time, Bill reminded us that the John D. Rockefeller Jr. decision of “no money” had saved us from professionalism. Also, it was recommended that our books and pamphlets be Conference-approved. And a fixed term of office for A.A. board members was established, confirming our principle of rotation.

The second year, delegates reminded themselves that the purpose of the Conference was not to govern, but to serve, and the principle of rotation at *all* service levels of A.A. was affirmed.

At the third Conference, there were 75 delegates, and Bill said, “The process of maturing will go on as long as we last.” At this Conference, there was the rejection of the idea of congressional incorporation. It was stated, “We believe that *spiritual faith and a way of life* cannot be incorporated.” It was also stated that “A.A. can and will survive as long as it remains a spiritual

faith and a way of life open to all men and women who suffer from alcoholism.”

In 1955, the preliminary charter of the Conference was adopted, along with a plan for selecting A.A. trustees from outlying areas. In 1956, we decided delegates should not succeed themselves, and we approved a public information policy statement. In this year, Bill first introduced the ideas of petition, appeal, participation, and decision.

The 1957 Conference approved new bylaws of the board. The 1958 meeting approved the principle of a ratio change in the makeup of the board — but it took eight years more before the final change was ratified by the Conference, indicating there should be certainty, not compromise, before action is taken.

In 1961, we emphasized the spiritual oneness on which our Fellowship is based, and in 1968, we talked about Unity. Bill said that without Unity there was no Recovery, and that all the Traditions related to the A.A. common welfare. The emphasis was on survival, and Bill said, “Problems and difficulties of the future may be greater than those we have already survived.” But he ended by saying, “There is a love among us that passeth all understanding, and it will sustain us through all the trials that lie ahead, no matter how formidable.”

In 1974, we stressed cooperation with those outside the Fellowship, as well as cooperation with each other. Our love can't amount to much if it cannot stretch to those outside A.A. who are working so hard to help alcoholics in their own way, just as we are working in ours.

The 1951 experiment in faith has become an enduring reality, but I like to think that we'll be taking our inventory from time to time, just as we did in 1963, when Bill said a presentation on “A.A. Takes Its Inventory” marked a historic moment in the development of A.A., and was a sign of growth.

The Conference, since it links all of us together, is perhaps the one body most representative of our ideal of Unity. It exemplifies Service, and if we take an inventory at a Conference, we are in some measure taking A.A.'s inventory.

Our history has had its stormy times, but we came through beautifully. Since our Traditions, Steps, and Conference remain unchanged, we will find ways to meet whatever challenge may come — if we have love enough, trust enough, and faith enough in one another and in a loving God, who will express Himself once more through our group conscience, as we work together in the days to come.

Ann Macfarlane

New York A.A.'s extend hospitality

Thirty-three New York A.A.'s took turns in the State Suite of the Hotel Roosevelt greeting Conference members' spouses and arranging tours, shopping, and other entertainment. They formed the Hospitality Committee chaired by Connie Thayer, of New York's Lenox Hill Group.

Activities available included opera, ballet, theater, symphony music, sports events, the circus, luncheons and teas, sight-seeing, and tours of the United Nations, NBC-TV studios, the

Metropolitan Museum of Art, and the National Arts Club.
(Plus, of course, A.A. and Al-Anon meetings galore.)

Thirty-six wives, two husbands, and assorted relatives accompanied Conference members to New York.

New archives room thrills delegates on tour of G.S.O. and GV offices

The newly established A.A. archives room on the eighth floor at 468 Park Avenue South was the climax of Conference members' Thursday-afternoon tour of the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices.

Our nonalcoholic archivist, Nell Wing, the late Bill Wilson's personal secretary for over 20 years, is in charge of the invaluable treasure of original manuscripts, letters, taped reminiscences, and other memorabilia of A.A.'s earliest days. (See p. 28.)

A verbal medley shows unity in Conference members' own words

Unnoticed by many Conference members, Bob Hitchins, chairman of General Services, sat through most Conference sessions in the back row, diligently taking notes.

That's how he was able, Friday afternoon, to deliver a stunning closing talk that wrapped up the entire week's activities.

Threaded together on the theme of "Unity – Through Love and Service," Bob's talk summarized the week's thinking in a medley of actual quotations from statements made during the week by 53 Conference members. He stated that we can look to the future of A.A. with great joy and faith when we find any group of members so thoughtful and inspiring.

Four trustees bid farewell

The closing brunch Saturday morning was virtually an after-meeting get-together. Members arrived to find breakfast tables set in the Terrace Room, with the Early Bird Conference issue of *Box 4-5-9* at their plates.

After the meal, Dr. Jack, Pearse, Bob Hitchins, Mick McFarland (area delegates' chairman), and Byron Barnes (Mick's successor for 1976) expressed gratitude to key G.S.O. people who had contributed to the success of the Conference. Among the most prominent were the four retiring trustees of the General Service Board, each of whom spoke briefly. Here are highlights of their remarks.

'Confidence in our trusted servants'

The night after Bill W. died, I led a meeting of my group and was in a rage that not one of those clowns said a word about Bill. Only later did I realize that, in a way, they were paying tribute to his wisdom and accomplishments. None of them had ever known him, but they had no fear for A.A.'s future. As Bill had dreamed and worked to make true, they trusted the principles of the A.A. system of trusted servants to keep our Fellowship going for the sake of the next drunk who walks in the door.

What has impressed me most in Third Legacy work is the genuine selflessness all of you display. You are people willing to work even when the spotlight is not on you.

Ralph Ahringer, Glen Head, N.Y.

'Love somebody? Tell'em!'

In A.A., I had a hard time identifying at first. I'd never had wrecks – I just did \$55 damage to a \$95 car, that's all. I'd never been arrested; I was just put in jail for safekeeping.

One day, our chairman said, "If you had any other disease, you'd try to find out all you could about it, and the recovery process." That started me reading all the A.A. pamphlets and started me on the service road. Now I've reached a turn in the road. My group has assured me they'll welcome a former trustee as coffee-maker. In A.A., our leaders are but trusted servants, so for a leader to return among the members is a promotion. I'm so grateful.

My little A.A. daughter has advised me, "If you love somebody, tell 'em!" I love all of you.

Junior Anderson, Needham Heights, Mass.

A word about personalities

Don Austin's talk is tough to summarize. The Texan from Chappell Hill described it as "my own obituary. This is as close as I'll ever come to hearing my own funeral. I'm having a great time.

"Since I've always been a rebel at heart, I want to talk here about personalities, from whom I have learned so much about our A.A. principles of love and service," he said. "Because of all of you, I need never walk alone."

Don proceeded to express, with touches of humor, his personal gratitude to each of the G.S.O. and Grapevine people, his fellow trustees, and all delegates from his region.

'Summed up in the word "people"'

My little stint on the board can be summed up in one word – people. I've learned so much. Everyone I have met has been my teacher.

Some of you know that my friend Bob Hitchins and I have not always agreed 100%. But what you don't know is that he has always been my "sponsor" on the board.

At leaving, I don't really feel sad. I recall that the end of my drinking life meant the beginning of a new life for me.

Tom Grafton, St. Boniface, Man.

In memoriam

Sam Leckie (Wyoming), Panel 24

Four Big Subjects Explored at Depth

Understanding and living the A.A. Traditions . . . delegates share their experience

Personal recovery from alcoholism in A. A. may be more influenced by our Traditions than we ordinarily realize, according to delegates who led the first presentation-discussion of the Silver Anniversary Conference, Monday afternoon. The subject was particularly appropriate, since the Fellowship adopted the Twelve Traditions just 25 years ago.

John Bealer, M.D., nonalcoholic trustee from Bethlehem, Pa., chaired the panel and the floor discussion, which was followed by workshops on the Second Legacy.

For all workshops, Conference membership was divided into nine smaller sections, each moderated by a delegate, with another delegate chosen to report back to the full Conference the group conscience expressed in each workshop. One trustee and one G.S.O. staff member attended each section.

Here are digests of the panelists' remarks.

Our Legacy of Unity

This year marks the 25th anniversary of the Twelve Traditions' acceptance by A.A. members at the 1950 Cleveland Convention. They voiced their conviction that the Traditions were "the platform upon which our Fellowship could best function and hold together in unity . . ."

Unity is implicit in all the Traditions. They help us to live and to grow — in love, in service, and in unity.

"Throughout A.A.'s Traditions is the confession that our Fellowship has its sins. . . . We have character defects as a society, and these defects threaten us continually. Our Traditions are a guide to better ways of working and living," Bill W. said.

Cora Louise asked me to open this panel with a few words on unity. Many people in and out of A.A. have already had a great deal to say about unity. "We must all hang together, or assuredly we shall all hang separately," Ben Franklin said in 1776.

From Bill, again: "Unified we live; disunited we shall perish." And "Should we lose our unity, the millions of alcoholics who still 'do not know' might never get their chance."

We all know the words. Being able to read or quote those words is one thing. Being able to feel them, to live them in our hearts, is another.

John Bealer, M.D., trustee

Personal sobriety tools found in the Twelve Traditions

I have had to stop and think about the tools that I have used to build a happy, comfortable, sober life. The Traditions were right there, staring me in the face.

In 1949, a few men met in my town and started our A.A. group. Despite misunderstandings, errors, frustrations, and slips, they managed to stick together, realizing their personal recovery depended on unity. When I walked through the door seeking help, the group was there to give me hope. I have tried to put the common welfare first by yielding my will and opinions, even when I know I'm right. If it was not for the "we" of A.A., I would not be here today. My sobriety depends on unity. I know, for I tried it alone and it didn't work.

When I first came to A.A., I was intrigued by the lack of organization such as I had known in other societies. No rules or regulations, no president, nothing I could see to keep the Fellowship going. What kept A.A. strong and growing? I found the answer in the Second Tradition. God's love, working through the conscience of man, not organization, keeps A.A. together.

Since I have been a delegate, it would be easy to let the old ego take over and try to run the show. In the Third Step, I turned my life over to God's care, and Tradition Two helps me leave it there. For me, the strongest attraction of the Fellowship is the Third Tradition. My husband was sober in A.A. before I came, so I knew no one would measure the sincerity of my motivation in approaching A.A. What hope and encouragement it gives to answer the question "What do I have to do to join A.A.?" with "Have a desire to stop drinking." I must be ever mindful of receiving new people as I was received — no questions, no tests, no votes — just as they are.

The longer I am in A.A., the more I realize the importance of the Fourth Tradition. It gives me freedom to practice A.A. the way that is best for me, as long as I give others the same freedom. My thinking and attitudes change, but I must not force my feelings and will on others. If I am to have continued, comfortable sobriety, "autonomous" I must be, but not at the expense of other persons.

People who come to our group from other parts of the country and immediately begin to criticize us, because we don't do things "like we do at home," often have trouble staying sober. Perhaps I would not be comfortable in your group, but it is up to me to change, not to try to force you to change.

To outsiders, I may well represent A.A. as a whole, so my freedom to do or say as I please needs to be watched. For A.A., I want only the best impression to be made.

This Tradition gives true independence if we accept the responsibility that goes along with it. I find I do indeed use these Traditions as I do the Steps, to maintain a happy, sober life.

Peggy Busch (South Carolina)

How the Traditions counsel humility and responsibility in our sober lives

Isn't Tradition Five what it is really all about? Isn't the first half of the Twelfth Step for all practical purposes the same? Many times I've said, "I'm going to revert to twelfth-stepping." There is no greater satisfaction than carrying the mes-

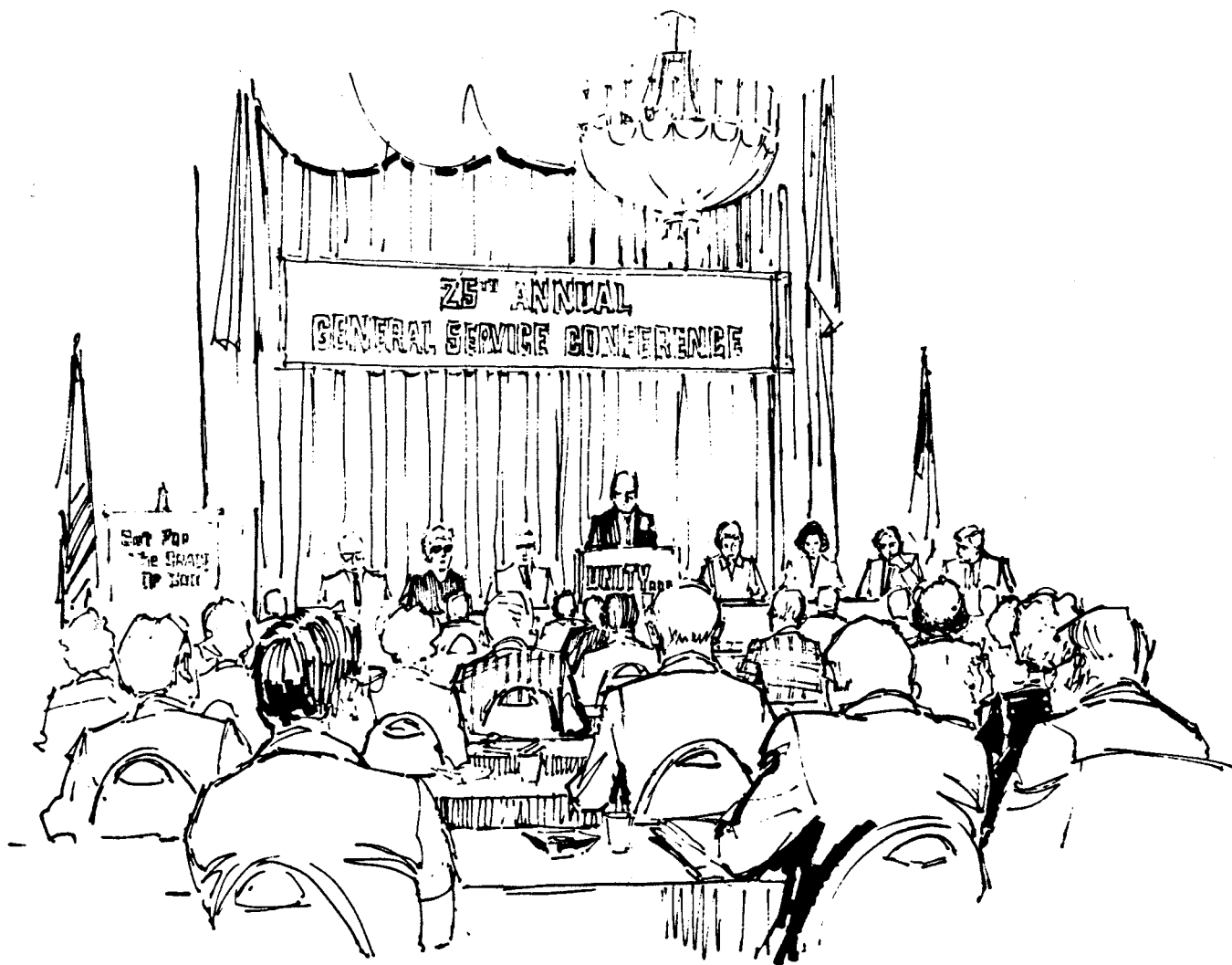
sage to the still-suffering alcoholic. My fondest A.A. memories are those early attempts at Twelfth Step work. Now, I find myself not doing as much face-to-face message-carrying as before, because of A.A. service work. One of the hardest things I've had to do was to refuse a Twelfth Step call because of these conflicting obligations. Each *group* "has but one primary purpose" — not each individual. I remind myself that I can, and do, derive the benefits of Twelfth Step work through service.

In recent years, with abundant Federal and state funding of alcoholism recovery programs, the Sixth Tradition becomes even more vital to our Fellowship. Yet I hesitate to become smug in my attitude toward other agencies. If A.A. as a whole had performed its primary purpose to the maximum degree, neither these agencies nor their monies would be in existence. My first instinctive reaction to these agencies is to offer unlimited cooperation. But the Sixth Tradition, derived from long and bitter experience, tells me to slow down. In the long run, adherence to the Traditions will be the best

way. A good portion of my own sobriety can be attributed to use of this Tradition.

Upon arrival in A.A., I wanted to know, "Who gets the money?" I was informed there was very little money in A.A. However, *some* money is necessary for the survival of the Fellowship. Why are sober alcoholics so touchy about finance? Why does money collected at meetings get diverted? I've had newly elected group secretaries ask, "I have X hundred dollars in our group kitty, and what will I do with it?" I am reminded to take my own inventory. If things are not up to par, it is probably due in part to the leadership — that is, *my* leadership. In "A.A. Comes of Age," Bill says, "There is not the slightest danger that A.A. is ever going to get too rich from the voluntary contributions of its members!"

Upon my receipt of suggestions on this presentation, my first reaction was: "What an order! I can't go through with it." But it made me take a long, hard look at the Traditions, to review their meaning in my mind. Discussion with others



has provided me with additional knowledge on the application of these Traditions which I had previously overlooked.

Wesley T. Smith (Arizona)

A.A. love and structure for sharing help us avoid bossism and fights

Some years ago, I became the paid secretary in our central office. Another member became a paid worker for the state Division of Alcoholism. Those were the days when our Fellowship was still young enough that many were "viewing with alarm for the good of the movement." How grateful I am to members who kept me alert to my job responsibility. My fellow member and I were kept keenly aware that attendance at meetings was to insure our own sobriety. Each of us, like all other members, had *one* voice which we were free to raise. Those older members were the beloved teachers of our Eighth Tradition.

I approached my term as delegate with many doubts. There was much to be done. Our past delegate had had the idea for a School of Structure and Information. Members of the assembly said, "We don't know anything about it, so we can't take part." Our response was: "We don't, either, so let us all learn and grow together." We have our school, correcting misinformation with correct information. Our hearts were full as we saw in action 46 G.S.R.'s and committee members at our recent assembly. We are working together to build a *sharing* structure. It allows us to guide with love and understanding — as opposed to organization, which requires directing and commands. Our Ninth Tradition allows us, not to seek retribution, but to keep firm the structure built with love.

Our area had reason to be very grateful for the Tenth Tradition. A situation involving a patient and our state institution created an issue so heated it became controversial and newsworthy. We in A.A. surely had feelings, and members who worked with agencies in the field of alcoholism had opinions. But they never in any way expressed these opinions as *A.A. members*. They knew which hat to wear, and left their opinions outside our meetings. We had to leave the issue to those outside A.A. who were more able to engage in battle. The issue has not been resolved, but our Fellowship still carries the message to the suffering alcoholic, keeping A.A. alive for still-unborn generations.

Dorothy Gadoury (Rhode Island)

Anonymity saves us from empty ambition

Perhaps thousands of alcoholics are still fearful of coming to A.A., afraid their identity might be revealed. The promise of privacy implied in our name allows thousands to enter the A.A. door. Perhaps more than half our members have said their first news of A.A. was from a radio or TV program, a newspaper, or a magazine. But Bill said that the Eleventh Tradition "is a constant and practical reminder that *personal* ambition has no place in A.A.," and that each member is "an active guardian of our Fellowship."

This Tradition reminds me to observe 100% anonymity in the public media, but I can reveal my A.A. membership privately

to my physician, minister, or employer or to anyone else I choose.

"Anonymity" in our Twelfth Tradition suggests to me humility as a result of spiritual restraint. For my own survival, I had to place the common welfare first, give that kind of love that has no price tag, and do so without expecting something in return — without reward or praise. Anonymity is sacrifice of self. As Bill said, "The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice." I believe the way to practice these principles in all my affairs is shown to me in the Traditions. They give directions for doing so in every part of my life, inside and outside A.A.

Faith that works takes action in my life. I am deeply grateful for my sobriety. If I am truly grateful, I am also responsible — and responsibility, I believe, is what the Traditions are all about. Faith without works is an empty thing, and gratitude is a very active thing. Gratitude without responsibility, I believe, is called hypocrisy.

When we learn to love one another, we learn to serve. When we serve, we help to guarantee that A.A. will be here in the future to carry the message to those alcoholics yet to come.

Jack Barnes (Northern Interior California)

Workshop report-back: More discussion of the Traditions at group meetings and A.A. conventions was unanimously encouraged by delegates of the Silver Anniversary Conference, according to Warren Russell (Connecticut), chosen by his fellow delegate-reporters to deliver a consensus of their reports on the week's first workshop. "Most groups are not aware that every Tradition came about as a solution for actual problems which threatened the early groups," Warren said.

Group problems are often associated with specific Traditions, several reporters had found. For example, accepting meeting space rent-free violates our self-support Tradition. Problems also arise in connection with the two anonymity Traditions, and those on nonendorsement, group conscience (trusted servants), requirement for membership, and group autonomy.

Among suggestions made were: (1) more use of the film "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions"; (2) acquainting newcomers with the Traditions as a part of sponsorship; (3) giving "A.A. Comes of Age" as an anniversary present; (4) using Traditions as themes for assemblies and state conventions; (5) putting on amateur plays about the Traditions; (6) encouraging members to use the Traditions in personal recovery matters; and (7) "Let It Begin With Me" — especially at the 1975 International Convention.

Advisory Actions related to Traditions: p. 43, report of Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, item 6; p. 45, report of Conference Policy and Admissions Committee, item 4.

Group support for group services

It's really amazing how self-supporting A.A. manages to be, even in times of economic recession. But group contributions for the services all groups get free from G.S.O. are still lagging behind the cost of the services.

Both these aspects of A.A. finances were pointed out clearly Tuesday afternoon in discussion following the week's second presentation. Brooklyn banker Arthur Miles, nonalcoholic treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, led a panel of three speakers. (Further financial information is given on pp. 47-51.)

Groups improve traditional support of services — but the deficit lingers

Report of trustees' Finance Committee: Our financial picture for 1974 could be considered satisfactory, especially in view of economic conditions. Net literature sales for the year totaled \$1,244,700, an increase of \$91,800, or 8%, over 1973. However, because of substantial increases in both paper and printing costs, the gross profit from sales showed only a 2.3% increase over the previous year. Contributions from groups and A.A. members totaled \$749,800 for the year. This was \$51,200 more than forecast, and \$103,900 more than received in 1973 — a 16% increase. Interest income, produced by depositing daily contributions in a demand savings account until needed for expenses, amounted to \$8,000. Total income (publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest income) increased by \$117,900, or 8.6%, over 1973.

Total expenses were also up, an increase of \$80,100 — just about as budgeted. Inflation and, happily, growth both contributed to this increase. The moratorium on the A.A. directories in 1974, plus the nonrecurring 1973 construction expenses, kept the over-all increase at a fairly low level.

In summary, the General Fund deficit of \$134,900 was offset by publishing net income, \$260,600. This left a net income of \$125,600 for 1974.

The budget for 1975 has been reviewed and approved by the board Finance Committee. It allows for increases in both income and expense. Total income is budgeted 11.3% higher than 1974 actual. Total expenses are expected to be 17.5% greater than 1974. A net income of \$66,900 is anticipated.

Possibly because of high unemployment, the percentage of groups contributing again declined slightly. Of course, we neither expect nor want large contributions from depressed areas. We are more interested in these groups' participating in the Third Legacy structure by giving *something* than we are in how much they give.

If we can get broader-based support from the Fellowship, our concern for the future can be greatly diminished.

Arthur Miles, chairman

Advisory Actions related to finances: p. 43, report of Conference Finance Committee, items 1, 2, 3, 4.

Contributions from a larger percentage of groups stressed as an important aim

Expenses of your General Service Office can be broken down into three separate areas. These are:

- 1 Publishing expenses, fully covered by the net income from sales of literature.
- 2 Various general expenses (such as those of public information, cooperation with the professional community, World Service Meetings, board meetings, and any other special projects of the board). These are paid for out of publishing income.
- 3 Expenses of servicing the groups. Last year, A.A. groups and members contributed \$749,800 toward the cost of group services. However, contributions fell short of covering the cost of group services by \$64,000. This difference was also paid for out of the net income of publishing.

Let's concentrate on the contribution dollar. How much is spent per group? How much is that being affected by inflation? How are contributions allocated for service expenses? Are we operating as efficiently today as we were in 1970?

We have chosen 1970 for comparison because the Fellowship has grown as much in the past four years as it did in the previous ten. As A.A. has grown year by year, the purchasing power of the dollar has declined. This has been especially so in the last two years. We here at G.S.O. are doing what we can to cut basic costs, so that inflation and the cost of more services to more groups will still leave us with a workable budget. Despite inflation, the cost per group has not gone through the ceiling. In fact, when we adjust to the 1970 dollar, the service cost per group actually *declined*. In 1970, with 16,459 groups registered, the cost per group was \$29.86. Allowing for a 32% decrease in the value of a dollar since that year, the average cost of servicing a group in 1974 was \$22.03. While the number of groups has increased by 8,589 since 1970, more than a 50% increase, efficiency has increased, too. G.S.O. has been able to add needed services and still keep within a practical budget. For example, ten years ago, there was one employee for each 300 groups; today, there is one G.S.O. employee for each 330 groups. Refinements of procedures have helped us cope with increasing work loads.

Your contribution dollar is put to work in many ways. For instance, Conference expense is budgeted at \$50,600 for 1975. However, this expense increases sharply when costs of A.A. staff and clerical time are added to the over-all cost. The same would hold true for the cost of the A.A. directories. Budgeted expense is \$40,000. When the required *salary* allocation of *all* the employees involved in the directories is added to the printing and mailing expense, the total cost is closer to \$70,000. (Salaries, of course, are charged against *all* service costs.)

Continued support from groups and members is vital if we are to maintain the good health of the Fellowship. With the rapid acceleration of growth, it becomes obvious that now is *not* the time to curtail group services. It is time to urge *increased financial support* from a larger percentage of groups. In the past four years, the percentage of groups contributing has fallen from 63.2% to 56.9%. Of course, some groups are in depressed areas, unable to contribute much. However, if all groups would

contribute *something*, no matter how little, A.A.'s proud Tradition of self-support would be safe.

Dennis I. Manders, controller

When we blow out A.A. anniversary candles, let us light a few

Bill W. and Dr. Bob had the courage to call a General Service Conference. They could see A.A. growing and knew they would not live forever, so they placed their trust in us.

"Trust" is the key word. Many alcoholics have placed their trust in us, and vice versa. To uphold this trust, we must be ready at all times to carry the A.A. message to those who still suffer. Besides being living examples, many people carry the message with literature from G.S.O.

In 1973 alone, over 5,000,000 pieces of A.A. literature were distributed. People are thirsty for knowledge on how to recover from alcoholism. To publish costs money, and inflation has hit A.A. My area suggested last year that we raise the price of literature to stay out of the red.

As of February 1, 1974, publishing costs had risen 60% in 14 months, and our cost of doing business in the General Service Office had increased — rent, utilities, postage, office supplies, and, I do hope, wages and salaries.

At some of these increases, we might have balked, but we saw there was no easier, softer way — literature prices would have to go up. When they do, on May 1, a discount structure based on quantity orders will help hard-pressed intergroups and central offices. Recently, I attended an anniversary dinner in my area with about 425 people present. I got to speak to a good many of these people, and not one objected to the price increases.

At the 1974 Conference, we talked of group contributions. Some areas were generous; in others, contributions lagged. Maybe if we can get people to feel *gratitude*, we can make them more conscious of our needs. There probably are members out there blowing out candles on A.A. birthday cakes. Let us all get going and light a few. We never seemed to mind when our favorite beverage had a price increase. Neither should we mind a slight increase in something that could be the difference between life and death.

As I said, Bill and Dr. Bob started these Conferences to put world services into our permanent trust. Let us not fail.

Paul Slatky (Northern Wisconsin/Upper Michigan)

How freeloading groups can pitch in to help the Fellowship beat inflation

As the number of groups increases, so does the cost of services to these groups. In 1965, just ten years ago, there were only 12,400 groups. Today, that has just about doubled. Approximately 25,000 groups are now active. This represents a growth of 100% over ten years.

Automation and economies cannot compensate for all of the inflated and normal increase in expenses resulting from this

100% growth factor. For the continued health of the Fellowship, contributions will have to keep pace. The less than two-thirds of the groups that do contribute must help support the more than one-third that do not contribute.

There is also galloping inflation. Its rate was 12.2% in 1974, better than 1% a month. There has been a total depreciation of 72% in the service dollar since 1965. In other words, it now takes \$1.72 to provide that same dollar's worth of services given in 1965. Contributions have not kept pace with inflation.

It has been suggested by the board Finance Committee that the allowable individual gift per year or bequest be increased from the present maximum of \$300. That change would be of some help in increasing contribution income.

Are the delegates, committee members, and G.S.R.'s going to have to hit the road and start knocking on the doors of some of the groups that are not sharing this load? I know some groups just do not have funds for G.S.O. But there are many that are taking a free ride.

When we see these groups, we should stress the Regular Contribution Plan or "A Penny a Day for Sobriety" (\$3.65 per member per year). The Birthday Plan also needs stressing — \$1.00 a year for each year of sobriety up to a maximum of \$10.00. It is a rare occurrence when a group does not respond once it has been informed of its responsibility.

Are we carrying the message of the need for G.S.O. in our worldwide Fellowship? If not, let us get on with this task immediately, if not sooner.

Carleton Mendell (Maine)

Grapevine

A.A.'s monthly magazine had to be subsidized by the General Service Board in some of its early years, when income did not meet expenses. But the Grapevine has for many years been enough "in the black" to make a yearly donation to the board's General Fund for support of worldwide services to groups.

The circulation has now topped 81,000 copies per month, it was revealed Wednesday morning, during the Grapevine presentation. Trustee Ralph Ahringer, president of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and chairman of its Corporate Board, led off this session, in which four other panelists participated.

Circulation at a peak in spite of the price rise

Corporate Board report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is a corporate arm of the General Service Board. The nine directors (including three trustees, the editor, and the managing editor) meet quarterly to execute the business of the corporation. We are responsible for publishing the magazine, adhering to the Twelve Traditions, selecting the staff, and planning the budget. Daily operation is delegated to the editor and managing editor, traditionally A.A. members, with equal responsibility, assisted by a free-lance copy-editor-proofreader and a secretary.

Before I was elected, everything was running smoothly, though it hadn't always been so. Now, the Grapevine was in the black, paying its own way. I hadn't counted on much change. But the growth of A.A. naturally affected the Grapevine. I've seen circulation go from 65,400 to over 81,000, with a resulting deluge of mail and good-quality manuscripts. I've also seen the Grapevine Calendars go from 15,000 to 25,000.

Then came automatic data processing. I watched that dedicated staff of six, under Kitty, start from the beginning to learn a new system, which bogged down over and over. Magazines are generally a natural for a computer, but not the Grapevine, with its one-to-one communication from A.A.'s. This was a new experience, even for expert programmers. They tried to do it *their* way, instead of our way, and you know what happened. Today, it is a fairly smooth operation.

Then there was the problem of mailing. We wanted to mail in a sealed envelope, but the post office requires the name of the magazine to appear on the envelope. To avoid this, we have always mailed in a plain, open-end wrapper, applied by hand. This labor became too expensive, and with increased circulation, too slow. So we put "Box 1980" on the cover and on the envelope. Now the Grapevine can be mailed in a machine-stuffed, sealed envelope, at a great saving of time and money.

In 1973, the Grapevine expanded its offices — not much, but we now look like a growing operation, with space for the Corporate and Editorial Boards to meet, and for visitors to research articles. Our mailing room, which handles the calendars as well as every other item the magazine offers, now seems large enough.

In 1974, we budgeted to keep the Grapevine at 35c. But by July, with skyrocketing costs in paper, printing, and mailing, we knew we'd have to move fast or lose our hard-won self-supporting status. So with the November issue, for the first time in 17 years, the Grapevine reluctantly increased its price to 50¢, or \$5.00 a year.

Finally, in the past four years we have been able to contribute \$55,000 to the General Fund of the G.S. Board, the very fund that once subsidized us for quite a few years. It makes all of us feel good to know the Grapevine is doing its part in unifying our Fellowship.

Ralph Ahringer, chairman

Can the Grapevine avoid controversy?

Editor's report: We have to practice A.A. principles in the Grapevine. One of the first of those is: We are self-supporting. We do not carry paid advertising. Another can be paraphrased from our Preamble: We are not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization, or institution, and we do not wish to engage in any controversy. There are developments in the alcoholism field not compatible with our A.A. philosophy. Most of these are reported in the gray pages at the back of the magazine, the "About Alcoholism" section. They are there for information, not because the Grapevine approves or endorses them. We respond to some of these with our own A.A. opinion, but do not engage in controversy.

Still, a magazine would be terribly bland if there was never

any controversy. In A.A., there are as many opinions as there are alcoholics. We welcome diverse points of view. We have a continuing controversy between the atheists and the believers, between those who want to talk only about booze and those who want to talk about all sorts of problems. And there is always the oldtimer who says, "They didn't do it that way in the old days." This kind of controversy makes better reading and a more interesting magazine, we feel. But we try to make it quite clear that the opinions expressed are those of the writer, the individual member.

Often, a piece in the Grapevine will start a response from readers that results in a number of articles on one theme. We may link together several as a sort of symposium.

My work experience began as a reporter and minor editor on a magazine, but most of my experience has been in the art field, so I have a special concern for the appearance of the Grapevine. When 48 pages have been put together in paste-up, I assign art to some three or four professional artists in A.A., who make finished drawings for us, without remuneration or recognition.

We stress humor a great deal. We believe laughter has a healing quality; when we can begin to laugh at ourselves, we are well on the road to recovery.

Some things we do not publish. We do not use tributes to individuals, nor any poetry.

Five times a year, we meet with the Editorial Board of professionals in publishing, writers and artists. We evaluate the Grapevine, seek out new thinking and directions. As the result of our sharing, assignments for special articles may be made on the spot.

The Grapevine is a different magazine from what it was years ago. In those days, there were a lot of bottles with skull and crossbones, or bottles chasing people or luring them to destruction, and there were pictures of drunks passed out or lying in the gutter. A great deal of the material was of the blow-by-blow drinking-story kind. Now, we think the Grapevine reader is not so much concerned with past drinking as with recovery.

The Grapevine today deals with the strength and joy of living the A.A. way. We talk about spiritual growth and how to cope



with fear and depression and ego. You won't find as many drunks in the Grapevine today. You will find more sobriety.

Our plea to all of you is: Think about our Grapevine as a major tool for achieving and maintaining sobriety. Along with Twelfth Step calls, telephone therapy, the Big Book, and special pamphlets, remember the Grapevine. Because it is reborn every month, it is the newest and best reflection of A.A. life as it is today, *right now*. Yes, we want a bigger circulation, more subscriptions — but most of all, we want people reading, using, and talking about the Grapevine.

Jack Morley, editor

Our magazine both records and makes A.A. history

Managing editor's report: Communication at the GV is really good. We're such a small staff, we've done away with written memos. The loudest voice carries the news through the Grapevine.

Mail and manuscripts come to my desk at least three times each day, and every piece is thoroughly read and acknowledged — unless, of course, the writer is *completely* anonymous. (Even those with just initials and an address are answered, pointing out the difficulty of such communication. Oddly enough, when they write back, we find they simply don't understand anonymity applies to the media, not to the personal level.)

The mail runs the full gamut of a lively A.A. meeting. Some letters are hilarious; some, very moving; others, downright shocking. The real excitement is coming across an excellent article, and this happens frequently.

For the past two years, we've campaigned to have A.A. publications that reprint from the Grapevine give the proper credit, to help protect our copyright. The greatest offenders were prison publications. I remember saying to Jack, "Whatever can we do about these prison publications?"

He thought a moment, then solemnly replied, "I don't suppose we can do anything. They're already in prison."

For the past three years, our November issue has carried A.A. history and reprints of early articles. We call it "the classic Grapevine." I'd like to bring you up to date on some history you may have missed.

Do you know why the Grapevine came into being? Because some A.A.'s whom Bill called "six ink-stained wretches" really cared about the members in the armed forces in World War II, and wanted to help them keep in touch. So the first Grapevine came off the presses on D Day, in the form of a newspaper, and went free to every known A.A. member overseas. Soon, groups at home caught on and asked that it be our A.A. magazine.

Concerns that bother some of us today had their trial run in the GV many years ago. For instance: outside agencies. The front-page headline in the very first Grapevine was "Two Yale Savants Stress Alcoholism as a True Disease." The first announcement of the forming of the National Council on Alcoholism appeared in the Grapevine. N.C.A. was never connected with A.A., but it has certainly helped to remove the stigma.

It has done battle against the disease of alcoholism in many ways A.A. cannot. Yes, A.A. has a good history of cooperation with agencies in the field of alcoholism.

Reported in the Grapevine was the little-known fact that an epic gathering met in July 1945 to celebrate A.A.'s tenth anniversary. From 36 states, 2,500 A.A.'s gathered with Bill W. and Dr. Bob in Cleveland's Music Hall.

Also in 1945, GV headlines proclaimed, "Evidence on Sleeping Pill Menace," followed by "Pills and Twelfth Step Work," and in that year, Bill W. wrote on "Those Goof Balls."

More and more, Bill used the Grapevine as a means of communication with the groups. Beginning in August 1945, he wrote a series on A.A. group experiences, "the Twelve Points to Assure Our Future." Discussion was hot and heavy for more than four years. Should we drop anonymity? What about accepting fortunes left A.A. in wills? What about clubhouses? Membership rules? Finally, in their present form as hammered out in the Grapevine, the Twelve Traditions were accepted at the Cleveland 1950 Convention as our Second Legacy, that of Unity.

About this time, an increasing number of nonalcoholics were reading the Grapevine and knew little about A.A. To clarify what we are and what we are not, in June 1947 the Grapevine carried a definition of A.A.: "Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share . . ." Yes, our well-loved Preamble, written by the first Grapevine editor.

In the 1940's, Bill and Dr. Bob were discussing a plan by which the membership would take over service jobs the founders and earlier members had performed for so long. And 1950 saw the birth of the Third Legacy, that of Service, perhaps the biggest responsibility of all.

The seventh issue of the Grapevine carried Lois W.'s story. Lois told how she came to live by A.A. principles for herself, not just for Bill. Until Al-Anon groups were started, letters from spouses and their children were run in the Grapevine. Today, we try to publish at least one major Al-Anon article each year.

Through the years of Grapevine publishing are many articles by such early friends as Sister Ignatia, Dr. Harry Tiebout, the Rev. Sam Shoemaker, Bernard Smith, Paul De Kruif, Fulton Oursler, Father Ed Dowling, and far too many more to mention.

In 1961, Bill W. wrote Dr. Carl Jung, telling the good doctor of the part he had played in his message to alcoholics and eventually to A.A. Dr. Jung replied to Bill's letter, and this now-famous correspondence was first published in the Grapevine in 1963.

Bill later became busy on yet another writing project for A.A.'s, the Twelve Concepts for world service. These were adopted by the 12th General Service Conference, in 1962.

For some time, Bill and Dr. John L. Norris, chairman of the G.S. Board, discussed a plan to increase the number of A.A. trustees in relation to nonalcoholic trustees. This was published in the Grapevine in 1966, and voted into being by the 16th Conference that year.

Perhaps you begin to realize the deep gratitude that has been mine for the opportunity to participate with the whole of Alcoholics Anonymous through the Grapevine pages. I'm happy to see and feel unity all around me, growing just as fast as A.A. itself.

Paula Carpenter, managing editor

Who jumped on the packages?

Circulation manager's report: I'm here to share a little of our Grapevine business with you. I promise not to give a blow-by-blow on routine subscription procedures. They differ from other magazine offices' in only one respect – service. Service is of vital importance, because we know this is an opportunity to help carry the message. The other five members of the business staff are not alcoholics. You'd never guess it!

The past several months have been a trying time for some of our subscribers. In 1973, we began conversion to computerized mailing. After most of the problems had been ironed out, we were notified by the mailers they were going out of business. This meant another conversion, with new coding, new problems. I am happy to report we are beginning to surface, and we thank all our subscribers for their patience.

As a result of computerized mailing, we can give faster, more efficient service to each subscriber. And what is more important, we haven't lost the personal touch. Many orders arrive with notes and requests. Keep right on sending them. You will be hearing from us with tender loving care.

Unfortunately, in one area we have no control – the post office. We have had packages returned looking as if someone had been jumping up and down on them. We urge any subscriber receiving such a package to notify us immediately, and we will send duplicate copies.

Back issues of the Grapevine go to hospitals and institutions whenever requested, and our correspondence makes it clear the Grapevine is thoroughly read in these institutions.

Past delegates have been such a help in carrying the Grapevine message to their areas. We want to count on Panel 24 delegates' becoming active Grapevine representatives. Panel 25, we will get you next year.

Kitty Kiernan, circulation manager

Some good uses for the Grapevine

Conference committee report: One of the discussion groups I belong to uses an article from the Grapevine as a discussion topic once a month. We find these topics human and personal. Sometimes, a different slant, a different wording will hit someone who may have been deaf or blind to the Twelve Steps. Through these topics, our discussions grow more lively. The recent vintage of articles attracts the younger newcomer. Using "Closed Meeting Topics" is a unifying experience, because we are discussing A.A. as it is today.

Bill W.'s article on love saved my sanity, my marriage, my sobriety. When I realized how long it took Bill to achieve mental sobriety, my guilt disappeared. Articles like this appear

every month in "Closed Meeting Topics." They mean the breakthrough in mental sobriety, the new frontier we must traverse to find a warm place in the sun.

Louis Geoffrion (Southwest Quebec), chairman

Advisory Actions related to Grapevine: p. 43, report of Conference Grapevine Committee.

A.A.'s Twelve Concepts for world service

The Twelve Concepts, guiding principles of the least familiar of A.A.'s Three Legacies – the Third, that of Service – have proved very helpful in solving group, area, and central-office A.A. problems. Conference members agreed in a presentation-discussion session Thursday morning. Many delegates declared they will try to help the general A.A. membership become more aware of the Concepts.

Like the Traditions, the Concepts were an especially appropriate presentation topic for the 25th Conference, since the General Service Conference itself is the chief instrument through which Third Legacy responsibilities are carried out by and for the membership at large.

Trustee Margaret Carlson, Agawam, Mass., served as moderator and made the introductory comments.

'The future belongs to you'

These simple but meaningful words were spoken by Bill 13 years ago on this very spot, to the 1962 Conference as it gave approval to the Twelve Concepts for world service.

"Since all my main service tasks are now complete," Bill said, "it seems right that my primary and long-held responsibility for our *world operations* ought to end with this session. This should be the final step in placing A.A. wholly on its own."

In 1946, an earlier step toward this goal had given us the Twelve Traditions. In 1955, at the International Convention in St. Louis, we had accepted the Conference Charter. And now, Bill had spent several years detailing and putting on paper the exciting collective experience contained in the Concepts, in order that this final transfer of responsibility could occur.

The Traditions tell us how A.A. groups and individual A.A.'s can relate successfully to each other and to A.A. as a whole. The Concepts are a beautifully simple pattern for the functioning of our service structure and for the *relationship* of all its different parts to the *whole*.

At the International Convention in Miami Beach, the late Bernard Smith, nonalcoholic trustee who played such an important role in creating our service structure, spoke on "Unity and Continuity." He talked of unity as a totality of *related* parts. "Our Fellowship is composed of all the groups of A.A., the separate areas of the General Service Board and all of its related service organizations, and the

Conference, . . . and so the whole of the parts becomes *one* — the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. This unity can have continuity only so long as the structure of Alcoholics Anonymous remains strong. Slowly and painstakingly,” Bern continued, “we have built upon the spiritual foundation of this great Society a structure that can, with continued devotion, insulate this Fellowship against the ravages of time, of dissent, of materialistic decay.”

As members of this Conference, we are the *custodians*, not only of the Steps and the Traditions, but also of the Concepts. What are we going to do with this Legacy? First, we trusted servants should *not* keep it to ourselves, but make it available to our entire Fellowship — and we can do this only through our own knowledge, because we cannot pass on that which we do not have! Therefore, it becomes important that you and I take the time and make the effort to *understand* well enough to communicate. We should understand *each* Concept well enough to talk about it, its application, and what it means to A.A.’s future.

You and I should know: who has the final authority for world services; how our trustees relate to our business corporations; how we handle the situation fairly if someone disagrees with the majority; how our Conference relates to the board of trustees; why it is so necessary for us to have *good rotating leadership*; why Conference action should never be personally punitive nor incite public controversy.

As Bill said of the Concepts, “They detail the experience and reasoning on which our operation stands today. These Concepts aim to record the *why* of our service structure in such a fashion that the highly valuable experience of the past and the lessons we have drawn from that experience can never be lost or forgotten.”

Today, with over 25,000 groups spread all over the world, it becomes increasingly important for all of us who work for A.A. “Unity — Through Love and Service” to understand how our world service structure functions and how it developed, through trial and error, through discussion and concern, and above all, through foresight governed by love and faith. Now we have the design outlined in these Concepts for the interrelating of all the many parts, so they add up to an effective, unified, continuing *whole*. And here we are again at — unity.

The Concepts help to insure A.A. unity and do a very beautiful thing for us: They *free* you and me so we may devote our attention to carrying out our Fellowship’s primary purpose. So, in a sense, the Concepts, too, help to bring recovery to the alcoholic out there, *anywhere in the world*, who might need our help.

Margaret Carlson, general service trustee

Understanding the Concepts, for us, begins with just showing up — sober

A.A. was an infant when members began asking, “How can this experience be shared? How can the word be spread?” Soon, they realized the need for world services, and this resulted in the creation of a trusteeship in 1938 for services

which could not be handled by single groups and areas. Early A.A.’s yearned for simplicity, but realized that without essential services for communication, for reaching out, A.A. could die. Through the years of trying to determine which services A.A. could and could not perform, many hurdles were encountered. There were problems of money and anonymity and many others, but A.A. gained valuable experience, and by 1948 our necessities were clear.

Dr. Bob’s illness caused facts to be faced. Work commenced, and our first Conference was held, in 1951. When one of the delegates to this first Conference, Tom S., from Florida, asked Bill what he must do, Bill said, “Just show up in New York sober, Tom.”

So, we see, necessity was a reason for this shift in responsibility and authority to A.A. as a whole. Other reasons center around Tradition Two — like all the Traditions, the voice of experience. It leaves little doubt. Groups are the final authority, and leaders are entrusted with delegated responsibilities only.

At St. Louis in 1955, when Bill delivered our world services into the keeping of the Conference, everyone knew our General Service Conference truly represented the conscience of A.A. worldwide and was going to work. The life of each of us and of our groups is built around principles. The compelling love of one drunk for another and for our principles is a great force for unity. The penalty for disobedience is clear. It has now been proved that we can rely on group conscience and our trusted servants.

We learn in Concept Two that delegated authority is not new in A.A. From the beginning, large delegations of service authority had to be made. Dr. Bob transferred to Bill most of his immediate responsibility for world service. Later, Dr. Bob and Bill found it necessary to delegate part of their active authority to the trustees.

Great difference between *ultimate* and *immediate* authority became apparent. The ultimate authority finally went to the groups. But for effective action, the groups delegated authority to service representatives to act and speak for them on most matters of world services.

For practical purposes, this Conference is the active voice and the effective conscience of our whole Society.

Nancy Rushing (Mississippi)

Who decides? Who acts? What about unpopular views?

Three months ago, Concepts Three, Four, and Five meant nothing to me; I was barely aware of their existence, let alone their meaning. Yet, after some hours of reading, I find that if we have a knowledge of sorts of our magnificent Traditions, the Concepts are not all that awesome to understand.

Concept Three has been labeled the “Right of Decision” Concept. This means to me that we must recognize the importance of the group conscience at all levels of A.A. To be more specific: Even though my area may inform me of its feelings concerning matters presented at the Conference, I have the right, after listening to other views, to decide, with God’s help,

what is best for A.A. as a whole, even though it may not be in agreement with my area's thinking. I am not a messenger who is "instructed" how to vote, but a trusted servant with the right to decide on my own conscience. Each group of responsible leaders applies its own authority and responsibility to each problem. Our entire program rests on *mutual trust*. We trust God, A.A., and each other. The Right of Decision that we offer is not only the practical means by which our leaders act effectively, but is also the symbol of our implicit confidence in them.

Concept Four is known as the "Right of Participation." It deals with the individual right of persons, groups, committees, and corporate staff of A.A. to have a vote. Our Charter provides that the trustees, the directors of our service corporations, and their executive staffs always be voting members of the Conference. In no event should we ever consider forming "second-class citizenship" in A.A. The Right of Participation starts when the new member joins a group and begins participating, building sobriety. Our relationship with one another has been defined as a brotherly partnership. The spiritual corporation of A.A. should never regard any members as "second class."

The "Right of Appeal" is what the Fifth Concept deals with. The minority voice shall always have the right to be heard. It's like the guy in the back of the room, whom we have to love. He is usually not very popular; he is argumentative and sometimes has opposite points of view. But we must listen to him, because just this once he may be right, and we cannot afford *not* to listen. Another illustration: When a candidate cannot poll the two-thirds vote necessary for election, his name is placed in the hat, according to our Third Legacy election method. In the drawing of lots, the *minority* candidate has an equal chance with the *majority's* choice.

Our program, based on the spiritual principles of our Traditions, is, in my understanding, a beautiful definition of democracy. By our willingness to apply this particular Concept, we are protected from our own power-driving ambitions. As long as we are willing to listen to minorities, we can avoid the danger of becoming an apathetic, self-seeking, uninformed majority.

Bob Tetrault (Western Massachusetts)

For decisions, these tools are helpful in our home areas

My area of expertise happens to be as an accountant and management consultant. I find the Twelve Concepts of A.A. to be just as meaningful in a troubled business relationship as they are in A.A. In addition to the workable administrative procedures beautifully defined in the Concepts, there is recognition of the need for dignity and of human worth.

Concept Six deals with the responsibility we here have. We must provide the proper management decisions in large matters of general policy, to insure A.A.'s survival and its capability of carrying the message. Surely, a group as large as we are cannot meet weekly to make the nuts-and-bolts decisions needed for a smoothly functioning operation, nor to make immediate administrative decisions necessary sometimes. Therefore, the needed balance is furnished in giving the *chief* initiative and *active* responsibility to the trustees. Since they are involved in

active management of our service organizations, they are in the best position to recommend future policy.

A beautiful system of checks and balances is established by Concept Seven. To guarantee effective management of our service activities, wide freedom in decision-making is important for the trustees; but it is equally important that A.A. should have no bosses. So Concept Seven gives the control of the purse strings to the Conference itself. If power was severely abused by the trustees, the delegates — representing the grass roots of A.A. — could simply cut off contributions, thereby "throwing the bums out." (In my experience here, all items which might be controversial have been brought before the Conference for recommendations, despite the fact that the trustees have the *legal* right to make decisions without consultation.)

Concept Eight simply calls for the delegation of authority according to solid corporate-management principles. Top management must reserve its energies for high-level decisions, then delegate the authority to independently make the smaller decisions and *carry through* the major ones. Sound management also dictates that employees in charge of obtaining a desired end result must have an active voice in decision-making.

Concept Nine has been a lifesaver for me this last year, during a baptism by fire. It describes in some detail the expectations that A.A. should have of its leaders, and the expectations leaders should have for themselves. After a great deal of soul-searching and a thorough rereading of the Concepts, I decided that, although I had a responsibility not to force my own views on our membership, I also had a responsibility to speak up if others might be doing so. Only time will tell whether my decision was correct, or whether I was a victim of my own power drive. The important thing is, the Concepts are here to be used by us in the necessary decision-making.

Jo Hajdu (Alaska)

Delegated authority — and the Six Warranties at work

I didn't feel that an assignment on the Twelve Concepts was really my interpretation of love. But it has certainly made me aware of the importance of these Concepts. Concept Ten: In this one, where we speak of *responsibility* being matched by an equal *authority*, I feel any member asked to do a responsible job also has authority to make decisions. Let's take an example. At the group level, we elect our meeting chairman for the month. He (or she) has a responsible job. When we elected him, we also gave him authority to make decisions, such as meeting topics for the month. The chairman's authority is limited to matters pertaining to that job, of course. Limits of authority are defined in specific job descriptions.

Authority may also be defined by Traditions, resolutions, or appropriate charters and bylaws. This Concept takes us to the Second Tradition, with the group conscience as the *ultimate* authority, but the trusted servant having the *delegated* authority.

Concept Eleven: Here again, we find the preceding Concepts in action, putting delegated authority to work. This Concept mentions the underlying structure of service. We have found

out, through practice, that it is a very effective method of operation – but what is it composed of? There are nine standing committees of the G.S. Board, plus the two service corporations: A.A. World Services, Inc., and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The committees are: Nominating, Finance and Budgetary, Archives, Conference, Institutions, Public Information, Cooperation with the Professional Community, Literature, and Policy. We have talked about the Rights of Decision, Participation, and Appeal by all. By placing principles ahead of personalities, by rotation, by proper compensation, and by working in harmony with each other, we can practice spiritual principles in all our affairs.

Concept Twelve: The Conference Charter is an informal agreement between the A.A. groups and the trustees, made in 1955. It is the basis on which the Conference operates. The first 11 articles can be amended by the Conference at any time, but Article 12 is in a class by itself, and cannot be altered in any way, except by a three-quarters written vote of all groups listed in the directories. Article 12 has six Warranties, of the same importance to A.A. world service as the Traditions are to



Coffee break

Just as bottles attract luses, coffeepots drew flocks of Conference members each midmorning and midafternoon during breaks in Conference business. In the Oval Room, soft drinks, tea, and the popular roast-bean brew were served. At the rear of the Terrace Room, tables of A.A. literature and 18 big display boards (handsomely crafted by volunteer Mary Nichols, New York Intergroup staff), showing A.A.'s worldwide growth and many G.S.O. activities, also attracted lots of attention as delegates went to and from meetings.

A.A. as a whole. They are solemn undertakings which guarantee that the Conference itself will conform to A.A.'s Twelve Traditions.

Warranty One: The Conference shall never become the seat of perilous wealth or power.

Warranty Two: Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample reserve, should be its prudent financial principle.

Warranty Three: None of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others.

Warranty Four: All important decisions shall be reached by discussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity.

Warranty Five: No Conference action shall ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy.

Warranty Six: Though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in action and in spirit.

"Freedom under God to grow in his likeness and image will ever be the quest of Alcoholics Anonymous," Bill wrote. May we in service always remember our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Bill Davis (Saskatchewan)

Workshop report-back: "If you want to make mistakes, do things on your own. However, you *could* follow the example of successful experience." Ann Nuckols (Virginia) relayed that advice in her collective report-back on the Concepts workshops. It was one suggestion on how to help groups understand the Conference's responsibility for voicing the conscience of the entire Fellowship. This conscience begins at the group level and goes on to the Conference – not the other way around, Ann pointed out in behalf of her fellow delegate-reporters.

Group conscience should reflect a membership *well informed*, after thorough hearing of minority opinions, workshop members agreed. A.A. group workshops on the Concepts were suggested. About one-third of the delegates reported holding such study sessions in their areas, and practically all said they plan such meetings at mini-conferences, assemblies, and similar gatherings.

It was also agreed the Conference is now ready to begin discussing the possibility of adding the Rights of Appeal and Petition to the Conference Charter, as suggested by Bill (see pp. 28 and 65 in "Twelve Concepts for World Service.")

A well-thought-out service structure and plan for rotation actually increase our ability to fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose, workshop members noted. More familiarity with the *Conference Report*, "The A.A. Service Manual," and "Twelve Concepts" should be encouraged, members agreed.

Advisory Actions related to Concepts: p. 42, report of Conference Report and Charter Committee, item 3.

Discussions Cover a Variety of Topics

Workshops and
discussion topics

A. A. members employed in the alcoholism field

Consensus reached on terminology and roads to clearer understanding

Report-back: The term "two-hatter" should be phased out of all Conference-approved A. A. literature, the Conference agreed in a "sense of the meeting" show of hands Wednesday after George Dorsey (Northern California) gave the pooled report of the delegate-reporters on Tuesday evening's workshops. "A. A. members employed in the alcoholism field" is the preferred terminology which came out of the three sections in which this suggestion was made.

The A. A. membership at large is not sufficiently aware of the Guidelines for Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field, it was felt, but members so employed seem to be pretty well informed. Most A. A. members who work as counselors and in similar jobs understand they are not to be paid for doing Twelfth Step work, conferees believed, but even so, some deviations do occur in practice, with many rationalizations.

A. A.'s who work for alcoholism agencies are well accepted in A. A. groups as long as they follow the Guidelines and A. A.'s Traditions. (Each group should have a reference file of all Guidelines, one workshop section suggested.)

Other suggestions included: (a) holding seminars and discussions (at assemblies, state conventions, etc.) for and about A. A. members in an alcoholism occupation; (b) regular gatherings of such members for *A. A. -meeting purposes only*; (c) a fearless inventory of current Twelfth Step practices (is it easier to drop the new member at a drying-out facility than to take the responsibility for twelfth-stepping?); (d) encouraging interest in the Third Legacy by alcoholism workers who are in A. A.; (e) avoidance of professional jargon; (f) patience (the older alcoholism agencies, which employ A. A.'s of long-term sobriety, are better accepted by A. A.'s than are newer programs); (g) delegates' becoming better acquainted with all professional alcoholism agencies and their workers.

Advisory Actions related to this subject: p. 41, Floor Action 1; p. 43, report of Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, item 3.

Unstructured workshops

Topics chosen on the spot for free-ranging discussions

Group problems, "Chapter Nine" groups, arousing interest in our Third Legacy, public information, and central (inter-group) offices were among the most widely discussed subjects in the ever-popular unstructured workshop sessions, Wednesday evening at the 1975 Conference, moderated by delegates and trustees.

With no questions set in advance, participants in the nine simultaneous workshop sections were free to choose their own topics. A delegate-reporter kept a record of questions and answers in

each workshop. Such a wide range of matters was covered that it proved impossible to prepare an over-all report-back for a plenary Conference session. Reports were compiled and mailed to members after the Conference.

Discussion topics

On Friday afternoon, Conference members focused their attention on three topics that A. A.'s in many areas had been talking about. Six panelists not only expressed their own individual points of view, but relayed local opinions and told how groups and members were acting upon them.

Is sponsorship slipping or only changing?

Where does sponsorship begin today?

I've noticed growing concern among A. A. members about declining sponsorship. I have recently found sponsorship very healthy and strong in many places; but its quantity and quality vary a great deal by locality, and by individual groups. Whether or not there is over-all slippage in sponsorship, I believe it falls short in enough groups to be of general A. A. concern.

Changing? Yes, mostly because of increased activities in the non-A. A. alcoholism world. How are these developments affecting A. A.?

Most noticeable has been *A. A.'s growth*, from an annual rate of about 6% during the 1960's to at least *double* that rate in recent years. This growth has spread thin the sponsorship capacity of some groups.

Also, with more non-A. A. facilities and services for alcoholics, a larger proportion of members are having non-A. A. professional contact. This was shown in our 1974 survey. Those who had received such professional treatment or counseling help *before* A. A. added up to 46% of the total sample. Of this, over half (56%) indicated this help had "played an important part in directing them to A. A." The survey showed a trend likely to continue.

The non-A. A. help referred to included every kind of non-A. A. "treatment or counseling"; detox, psychiatrists, family or marriage counseling, psychiatric and general hospitals, physicians, clergymen — not just treatment or rehab centers. However, I find treatment centers are now the non-A. A. resource most used by A. A. members. In one area of 43 A. A. groups, 40% of the 1,100 members had been to a treatment center. But the proportion varied greatly — from 0 to 100%. Most groups had less than 40% average, but ten of the 43 groups had proportions of 60% or higher.

On the average, throughout A. A., the majority of new arrivals come to A. A. as they always have (probably somewhere between 60% and 75% of them). For them, sponsorship begins where it always has. But a growing minority, and in some groups the majority, have a treatment-center experience upon coming to A. A. This is the changing situation which brings up the question of changing sponsorship.

This in no way lessens the need for sponsorship, which is important for all new members. But for the newcomers with a

treatment-center exposure, sponsorship needs to *begin at a different point* in the new member's recovery career. Usually, much but not all of the beginning work has been done. The person who arrives at A.A.'s door sober, feeling pretty well physically, having learned a good deal about this illness, having begun to face and talk about the realities of his problem, usually having had an introduction to A.A. and sometimes a more intensive orientation to A.A., and usually having had three or four weeks away from home and the job to clear his mind and to start reassessing his life — a person with such a start needs a sponsor who can meet him "where he is at."

Certainly, the sponsor should not run down the treatment-center program, for which the newcomer feels grateful, but rather should help him make the transition into A.A. — help him to "settle in" at his new A.A. home, to get involved in group life, to understand the program, to work the Steps, and to grow in the A.A. way of life, put so well in the March 1975 Grapevine article "Learning to Handle Sobriety." This article beautifully spells out changes which the A.A. way of life produces.

Here, I believe, we have the number one key to sponsorship problems. To the degree that A.A. basics are taken seriously by more members, more members will be *motivated* to sponsor — and will be more able to provide good sponsorship, not just at the beginning of recovery, but at later points as well.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., trustee

Modern sponsorship remains true to A.A.

In the 1960's, it was customary for the Twelfth Step caller to work closely with the subject, and in our area generally to become the sponsor. My sponsor literally lived with me the first crucial weeks. He practically did my thinking for me.

I believe sponsorship is not going out of existence, but we *are* seeing radical changes. Most calls I receive today are from those who really want hospitalization. The old type of sponsor, who carried whiskey and chocolate bars, has passed on. Today, we often find the subject coming from a treatment facility, dry, in good physical condition. But this does not lessen the need for sponsorship.

After each meeting in my home city, we say, "If any person here does not have a sponsor, please see the secretary, and he will appoint a temporary sponsor." Thus, sponsorship is mentioned every time we meet. This causes discussion of sponsorship by the new member, and keeps before the older member the responsibility to become a sponsor.

We also hold discussions on the sponsor's responsibility and what makes a good sponsor. For instance, a leader — and a sponsor is a leader — should not only show and know the way, but also *go* the way. We bring up the necessity of being honest with your subject, even though it may hurt feelings. A good sponsor must also be a good listener.

I do not feel other people coming into the alcoholism field should in any way detract from good A.A. sponsorship. Sponsorship explains the program, thrives on the Steps, and succeeds through the application of our Traditions. This is the way it has been since the one-to-one idea started with Bill and

Bob. It is just as necessary and alive in our 40th year as it ever was.

Joe Mulloy (Tennessee)

Advisory Actions related to this subject: p. 42, report of Conference Agenda Committee, items 3a, 6; p. 43, report of Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, items 2, 4, 5.

A.A. literature: Is there too much? It is too specialized? Is it becoming a substitute for person-to-person contact?

Literature is no substitute for handshakes and sponsorship

I believe there is too much literature. I have watched activities at the literature tables at many meetings. We see people pick up pamphlet after pamphlet, look at them, and lay them down, seemingly puzzled over their purpose.

Our reaction was that the various subjects are too complex, confusing to these newer minds. We were reminded of the statement of Dr. Bob, "Let's not louse this thing up. Let's keep it simple."

Do some of our newer pamphlets violate this? Are some pointed toward outside agencies, not meant primarily for the Fellowship? The increased publication of pamphlets may have gone beyond the needs of any alcoholic.

Is the literature becoming too specialized? Yes. Is it becoming a substitute for person-to-person contact? Yes. The old-fashioned, one-to-one contact is being neglected because of increasing dependence on literature.

Today, many people are coming to our Fellowship involuntarily, committed by the courts and other legal bodies. Many bring their resentments with them. Thus, personal contact and the presentation of *pertinent* literature to the still-suffering alcoholic are increasingly important.

Sponsorship on a one-to-one basis is lacking in our area. Newcomers arrive with literature they received in hospitals, but sponsorship usually was not mentioned upon their release. We are placing too much emphasis on carrying the message to various agencies, instead of to the sick alcoholic through sponsorship.

Fellowship and one-to-one contact can never be replaced by the written word. Literature is very useful *after* a person has received the warm handshake and has witnessed the love and service of one alcoholic for another, to be found only at A.A. meetings and in personal contact with another alcoholic.

Chuck Sherer (Northwest Ohio/Southeast Michigan)

Literature array responds to needs and fills a big budget gap

"The language of the heart" has many nuances, is spoken in many dialects and expressed in many ways. It is universal, yet individual. I found it in A.A. At first, it was a feeling; then I

detected it in voices. When I regained the capacity to think, I began reading. My thirst for knowledge was insatiable. I began accumulating all the A.A. books and pamphlets. A few held no interest for me — but *not one* have I ever discarded!

When I go on a Twelfth Step call, I leave pamphlets with my new friend. I talk about how the Big Book I'm carrying under my arm has helped me. Very often, our wonderful pamphlets carry the message later, even if they are only mute evidence that someone cares.

Too much literature? I think not — if we look at the literature distributed each year [see page 28]. Judging by the quantity of each title sold, there must be a need.

Besides, group contributions have consistently failed to defray the cost of services. In 1973, A.A.W.S. contributed to the General Fund \$150,000 from its publishing income to make up the deficit. Instead of retrenchment, I think we need a more effective marketing program for the distribution of our publishing corporation's output!

In 1952, the second Conference established its own Literature Committee. It was intended that our publishing program would cover the widest possible range of A.A. thinking and experience.

Not a single piece of A.A. literature has come into existence by accident. The idea may originate in a number of ways, but it is carefully scrutinized by the G.S.O. staff, the trustees' Literature Committee, the directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., and the Conference Literature Committee. This provides the "checks and balances" referred to in Concept Seven.

If the *idea* survives and becomes a new literature item, there is obviously a need for it. It is not too specialized, but offers a service required by some segment of our Fellowship. The "checks and balances" procedure also works when it is time to discontinue an item no longer needed.

I sent out a questionnaire in my area. The first 100 responses, the collective conscience of the area, are the basis for this presentation. To "Is there too much A.A. literature?," 65 said no. On "Is it too specialized?," 75 said no. Asked, "Do you use pamphlets to help carry the message?," 81 said yes, and added that they use pamphlets as a backup on a Twelfth Step call. The pamphlets mentioned as most helpful were "Is A.A. for You?," "This Is A.A.," "44 Questions," and "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic."

Some interesting comments were added. "Specialized literature fulfills a need." "It is okay if pamphlets overlap, because some newcomers may have to hear the message in many different ways." Others took the opposite view. "Pamphlets tend to dilute the importance of our basic textbooks." "Many pamphlets seem to be praising ourselves. Bill said, 'We think it better to let our friends recommend us.'" "The value of 'As Bill Sees It' and 'Came to Believe' is questionable insofar as straight A.A. is concerned. We need to reinforce the idea that A.A. is *not* a religion."

Genevieve Leher (Mid-Southern California)

Advisory Actions related to this subject: p. 44, report of Conference Literature Committee, items 2, 3, 4, 5.

The role of the district committee member

Many small districts prove more effective than a few large ones

The district committee member (D.C.M.) is the main link of service communication in the district — in fact, the *only* contact for some A.A.'s. In the D.C.M.'s job, it takes courage and determination to practice principles over personalities. It means visiting groups and talking about Traditions and Service, in addition to Recovery. It means reminding groups of their responsibility for support of our general services.

Each district needs to be small enough that the D.C.M. can visit all the groups regularly. There can be many types of district meetings held regularly for *all* interested members. These can be business meetings, sharing sessions on district problems, or public information meetings, and another of surprising benefit is a meeting to acquaint G.S.R.'s with *all* Conference-approved literature.

A few years ago, Kansas was redistricted into 22 small districts, where we had formerly had six huge ones. This means 44 members (including alternate D.C.M.'s) are involved in the area committee, instead of 12. Here are some other results of the redistricting:

- Every group has an equal voice in state affairs, and that was not possible before.
- We have more qualified D.C.M.'s from whom to choose a delegate.
- With a smaller area, each D.C.M. can visit groups where service is most needed. (Kansas is largely rural. The district where I was D.C.M. had only seven groups — 45 to 60 miles apart.)
- Communication between groups and the state committee is much improved, and we have more participation in round robins.
- The representation of more groups and the participation of more district committee members has created a stronger and better A.A. in Kansas.

We have three committee meetings a year. The evening before, we have a study meeting ("The A.A. Service Manual," Traditions, or Concepts). We urge all A.A.'s to sit in. We need to make D.C.M.'s feel that, as members of the area committee, they share responsibilities with assembly officers, the delegate, and others for the common welfare of the whole area.

Clyde Jones (Kansas)

These five tips on better D.C.M.'s can bring other benefits, too

If the D.C.M. visits a group in his or her district, and the members think a new drunk has just arrived, something is wrong! Service people should be well known as a happy, dedicated bunch in our Fellowship, so those members not

familiar with A.A. general services will be attracted to "want what we have."

As a sponsor is to the new member, so is the D.C.M. to the G.S.R. Service education is an important phase of the D.C.M. role. Here are some training ideas we've used:

Panel presentations at individual groups, chaired by the D.C.M., with all G.S.R.'s and alternates asked to attend each one. Three G.S.R.'s spoke for 15 minutes each on "What Is a G.S.R.?", "Unity," and "Importance of P.I." A question-and-answer session followed. G.S.R.'s rotated the speaking assignments so all had a chance to participate. We tried to cover all groups immediately prior to our assembly, to create enthusiasm. For topics, we used the agenda of this Conference each year.

"Service Manual" study sessions: Two years ago, our districts combined on special meetings for this. We went through the manual chapter by chapter for approximately 11 weeks, rotating the chairing to a person experienced in the capacity that the chapter covered. These sessions were open to all interested members, with plenty of time for discussion. Attendance did drop off, but we ended with about 12 people who had a good knowledge of the manual.

The G.S.O. filmstrip is being shown to each group. All G.S.R.'s and alternates from the district are introduced, and discussion time is provided. If questions are slow, a G.S.R. asks the D.C.M. to explain "Conference-approved literature,"

or the delegate to give current membership figures. At one meeting, most questions came from a member at his *very first* meeting. Who says new members are not interested in service?

Guideline study sessions have been set up in two districts. They are open to all members, and one or two Guidelines are studied at each meeting. Experience has been shared, and members have been surprised to find there is a Guideline to cover a problem they had in their group perhaps just last week. One member phoned to say that plans had been made to purchase land in the name of his A.A. group, and the group had approached the bank for a loan. He sensed this was risky, and was looking for an answer. He attended the session covering the Guideline on Clubs, and left the meeting with much, much shared experience. We did not tell him what his group should do — merely provided him with past experience in similar situations.

A regional conference or a General Service Gratitude Day (held in Winnipeg each year) can give committee members an opportunity to serve as meeting or ticket chairman, treasurer, etc.

While it is the D.C.M.'s responsibility to provide service education for his or her district, the D.C.M. also is in training, because from the committee we elect assembly officers and our delegate. The D.C.M. needs wide experience as a trusted servant.

Reeta Hourie (Manitoba)

Personal Service Highlights

At intervals during Conference week, Panel 25 delegates came to the podium to share their own experiences in Third Legacy work. Here are excerpts from all 45 of these talks.

Alabama/Northwestern Florida: I served as group secretary and treasurer. After about six months, I was elected G.S.R. I attended all area meetings, and when we redistricted, I became D.C.M. Our beloved area secretary passed away, and I was elected to finish the term. I was then elected as area chairman, alternate delegate, and finally delegate. I only accepted these responsibilities because a loving sponsor guided me in the direction of service. The rewards have been more than I ever dreamed. It has just been beautiful, and I hope I can continue to do my part in letting A.A.'s know about our service structure. — *James E. Wright*

Arkansas: Although our state organization is not as strong as we would like, we have made a lot of improvement. Officers of our state assembly and delegates have put forth every effort. Our central office in Little Rock opened several months ago. The number of telephone calls and letters received is a good indication of how much this unit has been needed. The office assisted in publishing our first newsletter, and is also planning a chartered plane and/or bus

to Denver. Five of our districts have meetings regularly. Most people attending assemblies are from these districts. Our concern now is in getting the others organized. — *Gus Jowers*

British Columbia/Yukon: Sober about three years, I had done very little to change my old habits. This attitude led me back to drinking in 1957. After a year of hell, I told my sponsor I was willing to do anything to stay sober. He suggested service. I began in institutions, sponsoring some members when released. In Denver, I was involved as secretary, in Twelfth Step calls, and at assembly meetings. After I moved to Toronto, I was elected G.S.R. Again I moved, to Vancouver, and soon was involved in institutions. I helped start a group, was maintenance man and sweeper for two years. I'm just beginning to understand service work, but, with the help of our servants before me, I have been rewarded beyond all expectations. — *Abe Wiebe*

California (Northern Coastal): Our area has over 600 groups (585 registered); 360 have G.S.R.'s, of whom 154 voted at our fall election. We have three annual assemblies, including a pre-Conference one at which G.S.R.'s advise the delegate concerning agenda topics. Our area committee meets monthly;

average attendance, 35. Our greatest progress in recent years is probably the development of county meetings. There are 11, average attendance 20, so that over 200 G.S.R.'s meet monthly, providing year-round G.S.R. activity and a forum for groups to air local problems and Traditions questions. We have had particular success with the post-Conference assembly, a two-day meeting which features workshops, service talks, and the delegate's Conference report. — *George Dorsey*

California (Southern): The area I represent has 32 districts, with about 840 groups. I have been active in service work seven of my nine years of sobriety — in local central service, then as G.S.R., D.C.M., and delegate via the hat. The seven central offices in our area, with which we work very closely, have voting representation on our area committee. An all-day service symposium in June will include three branches of service — central offices, institutions, and general service. We have an all-day assembly in March, so all agenda items can be discussed and the delegate can know the full group conscience. — *Jim Shaw*

Colorado: We are anxiously awaiting your arrival for the 1975 International Convention. At first, some of us ran in several different directions, wanting to do everything right now. Then, as always, we got the necessary guidance. With the involvement of A.A.'s throughout the area, Colorado has grown closer in unity; we have learned the deeper meaning of love, the value of patience and tolerance, and the priorities principles must have over personalities. — *Don Burow*

Connecticut: Our state is experiencing increasing interest in alcoholism, not only in new groups, but also in industries and schools. To build up interest and cooperation without affiliation, seminars were held on meeting this responsibility. We have made interested non-A.A.'s aware that we are available and willing to share our experiences, within our Traditions. We are developing awareness sessions in junior high. When I first became active in service, we had approximately 200 groups. Now, there are 476. — *Warren Russell*

District of Columbia: My first A.A. service came in my third year, when I traveled 70 miles to participate in the Boston intergroup. On that committee, I learned of the need for groups' financial support of the office, the value of maintaining the telephone lifeline, and the importance of a capable intergroup secretary. In Washington, I have served our intergroup, have been banquet and public relations chairman, and moderate a weekly radio show. I have been G.S.R. and committee member and chairman. Our outstanding service project is our G.S.R. "mini-conference," modeled after this one. — *Fred A. Forbes*

Florida (Northern): Shortly after my coming into the program, my sponsor told me to become active if I wanted to stay sober. I emptied ashtrays, swept the floor, washed cups, and must have made a million cups of coffee. My sponsor, G.S.R. of our group, carried me to an area meeting before my last drink. I became treasurer of my group, secretary, G.S.R., intergroup representative, its chairman, then D.C.M. We had about 40 groups. Our delegate suggested we divide, so we had four districts. All have grown, and our area conference has tripled in size. — *Buck Raulerson*

Florida (Southern): We hold four conferences each year at

various locations. We have 11 districts, and each gets to bid for one of our conferences every two years. One conference each year is an assembly at which all G.S.R.'s vote, to advise the delegate on matters coming up. I have been active continuously for over seven years. Previous to serving as a delegate, I was chairman. Our area conferences help coordinate our state convention and all of our institutional work. Also, we are able to send a considerable sum of money to general service each year through our gratitude dinners, which were instituted some years ago. — *Samuel E. Smith*

Hawaii: Thank God for sponsors! My sponsor told me (he wasn't the type to *suggest* anything) that getting into action was a necessary part of sobriety. So he volunteered me to set up ashtrays, tables, and chairs. I did, for three months. Then I resented it, because he took my choice away. Our group was looking for a coffee maker. Knowing my sponsor, I volunteered before he volunteered me. This was the beginning of my getting into service — answering the telephone at the central office, having my name on the Twelfth Step list, having the answering service in my home after 10:00 p.m., being secretary of my group. — *Harry Lake*

Illinois (Chicago): After my first year of sobriety, I was elected secretary of my group and discovered it was not listed in the A.A. directory. After I registered our group with G.S.O., I received *Box 4-5-9* and became interested in A.A. activity outside our local area. My sponsor, who later became my husband, was active in local service, and I went to service meetings with him. I found that people happy and growing in their sobriety were those active in service work. I have been chairman for a patients-only meeting at a hospital, and co-chaired our first regional conference for delegates, past delegates, and trustees. — *Fran Adams*

Illinois (Southern): I came to this program 12 years ago, but have been sober only ten. A.A. has shown me a new way of life and a good way to live one day at a time. The benefits are wonderful. I was elected G.S.R., then committee member, then delegate. I am very happy and have found an inner peace that I never had before, by living and working the A.A. program. I always want to be able to help some other alcoholic in finding a way to stay sober. I go to meetings five or six nights a week. Service work in this program is very necessary in my life. — *John Neal*

Indiana (Northern): After I had been in A.A. for two months, my sponsor asked me to be chairman for a new group just started. After that, I was chairman and made coffee for a small closed meeting for two years. I was G.S.R. for this group for six years, as no one else seemed to want this responsibility. After that, I was elected state committee member for two years, and served as treasurer for two years. My sponsor said, "Keep busy — you just might stay sober." — *Joe Holman*

Iowa: We are really hopped up about the progress being made here. Groups have been showing a marked increase in attendance and numbers — brought about by the good work of my predecessors, who are always on tap for any call for the reaching hand of A.A. But we are weak in some districts, and work in these is our immediate need. District representatives meet twice a year. Another concern is the lack of a good

institutions program ramrodded by a real organizer. Help or suggestions would be most welcome. Recently, I went to a meeting on sponsorship and Traditions, and got the feeling the value of sponsorship is being played down, because of lack of know-how. — *Al Weston*

Louisiana: Sponsorship seems to have dwindled, so we are pushing closed meetings on sponsorship. We have a large influx of younger members with a dual problem, who slip and slide together. This is due largely to older members' not making it clear that we do understand. We need and appreciate all of the facilities we are blessed with today, but no longer sit with someone around the clock, and do not feel the closeness we once did. This could be changed if we gave the necessary followup. Also, older members sometimes give newer ones the impression "You get all you need right here — just listen to me." One, with better than 25 years, will not permit a G.S.R. to be elected. Says anything beyond the group is politics. — *Dede Hoffmann*

Massachusetts (Eastern): For ten of my 11 years, I have been active in general service. Because of the large increase in the number of groups (now about 500), our 15 districts have been divided into 26, smaller and more manageable. We have monthly discussion of a Tradition at district meetings. One district has discussed all Twelve Concepts, alternating with the Twelve Traditions. At each monthly area committee meeting, along with my regular report, I give a brief explanation of one of the Concepts. We conduct two spring assemblies and one fall assembly. With our central office, we have joint committees on public information and institutions, very active and successful. — *Ray Sullivan*

Michigan (Central): My first A.A. meeting June 1966. Elected G.S.R. December 1966. Committee member 1967. Chairman, central state intra-area 1970. Secretary, central state general service 1971. Treasurer, central state intra-area 1973. Public information chairman, central state 1973. Volunteer alcoholism worker, District Court Probation Department 1968. Paid alcoholism worker, Public Health Department 1973. Started A.A. and Al-Anon groups in our home 1968; still active. Had the pleasure of giving my son his one-year A.A. pin 1974. Helped get a unity council started (1973, with 12 groups) in our three-county area after trying for seven years. — *Duane S. Harder*

Michigan (Southeastern): This is my fourth entrance into A.A., and my most important. I found that service throughout the Fellowship is where it is all at. I have served on our central office board and in general service work 14 years. I was chairman of the first East Central Regional Conference and of the second East Central Regional Delegates' Mini-Conference. I helped start a halfway house for women. — *Andy Quaid*

Minnesota (Southern): Every county has a detoxification center, all with A.A. cooperation. Many people in their teens and twenties find help in A.A. A.A.'s visit junior and senior high schools. We have programs successful in getting senior citizens involved in A.A. There is need for literature in larger type faces for them. Many court referrals become very strong members. The state of Minnesota will treat over 12,000 people in hospitals and halfway houses next year, and 90% will be referred to A.A. Most stay, to become good members. — *Marv Spooner*

Missouri (Eastern): I was coaxed, pushed, and badgered into attending my first assembly in 1965. Being the only person from my district, I was told I was elected and had a vote. Only a smattering of groups was represented. Now, our quarterly business meetings have attendance over 100; assemblies, 200 to 400. But we still have far to go. We are beset by group apathy, isolationism, and lack of unity. An active, enthusiastic committee member results in a growing district. But in an inactive district, groups resist and resent all efforts to get them out of their little, walled-in world. Our institutions committee has made great progress. Any person who wants A.A. is automatically put in touch with our committee 40 days before discharge from any institution of the Missouri Department of Corrections. Most hospitals dealing with alcoholism have flourishing A.A. groups. — *Byron Barnes*

Missouri (Western): When I first began to attend meetings as a G.S.R., I thought they were boring and downright juvenile. I was an eager beaver, and the old heads just let me blow my stack. Finally, I realized "Easy Does It" was the answer to my problem. I served three terms as G.S.R. We have fine institutions and public information committees, but there is room for improvement. When I hear returning delegates make reports, attendance and interest are discouraging, sometimes embarrassing. Some members have never read *Box 4-5-9*. I am also concerned about sponsorship. I hear, "That man came two or three times and never came back." "Did anyone call him?" "No, he knows where the place is." That isn't the way I was taught. — *Francis P. Ryan*

Nevada: I came into A.A. about the time our state A.A.'s smoked the peace pipe after a north-south feud. Instead of having our assembly in the north or south, we met in the middle! Compromise of this nature set the tone. We decided to meet annually instead of biannually. We have come to know each other better, and cooperate in workshops and gab sessions for two days. There is room for growth in many towns — though, with such sparse population, they do well to hold their own. But in Las Vegas, a second social club allowed for more meeting space: eight or nine groups sprang into being. Two years ago, our assembly decided to encourage group membership. Before, all A.A.'s considered themselves members of all groups. — *Joan Barclay*

New Jersey (Northern): After the usual group service, and one year as intergroup representative, my general service commitment began at the Convention in Miami. I became G.S.R., then D.C.M., chairman of our state convention and of our North Jersey panel, then program chairman for our regional convention. We reorganized our district committees into county committees, which are beginning to function as copies of the state panel. One county has a P.I. committee, a professional relations committee, a committee for contacts, and a continuing workshop for speaking at non-A.A. meetings. We hope members who become interested in county work will eventually be attracted to the state panel. — *James Riley*

New York (Central): It took me a year to find out where I was. After a couple of years, my home group was to have the area meeting. "What's that?" I asked. The G.S.R. didn't have answers, so, being noisy and nosy, I found out where the meeting was, and went. Before I had my coat off, the chairman said, "Will you have the meeting next month?" "Why,

sure!" I didn't even know what I was talking about. But I found out. I became G.S.R. and, after attending many area meetings, committee member. Later, I was elected area chairman. From the hat, I became alternate delegate, then was elected delegate. — *James P. Hunter*

New York (Southeastern): I was elected to each group office that the group volunteered my services for. My sponsor said these positions would help me stay sober. I served at the N.Y. Intergroup office, then became G.S.R. Through this, I found out what a great big wonderful fellowship this is. I was a committee member, convention treasurer and ticket chairman, then chairman of the area committee. We started mini-assemblies for the 500-plus groups in our area, to help them better understand general service. As my sponsor would say, being delegate will help me stay sober. — *Walter Fetterer*

North Carolina: Membership in our more than 225 groups is steadily increasing. At our semiannual assemblies, over 75% of groups are represented by their G.S.R.'s. Workshop topics this year will be taken from this Conference agenda. A state P.I. committee has been formed, and a P.I.C. is also functioning in each area. Our problems include cooperating with outside agencies and informing the general public and special groups about A.A. while abiding by Tradition Eleven. We know these things will be worked through as long as each of us does his or her part, always remembering our primary purpose. — *Edith Campbell*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: I hope those of us who try to serve never become complacent and feel it is "good enough," as there is still much to be done. Generally speaking, our people are Legacies-minded; only rarely do power-drivers surface. With the recent growth of commissions on alcohol and other agencies doing good work in the field, occasional incidents arise. Understanding on both sides is most important. No outside agency is bound by our Traditions, but they are vital to us. One of our central service committees made significant changes in the local structure to assure that every call for A.A. is answered. — *Charlie McCarthy*

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): On my A.A. honeymoon, I vowed, "I never want to get involved in organizational stuff!" But growth in the program does change our thinking. In 1972, someone pushed me into general service work. I wish they had pushed me sooner. It wasn't until I became involved that I realized the importance of all Three Legacies. When I was dubious about accepting the nomination as delegate, one of our oldtimers said, "The job seeks the person — the person doesn't seek the job!" He stated that group conscience would decide who would be delegate. I continue to be amazed at God's will for me. — *Reitha Gresham*

Ohio (Northeastern): At our election assembly, only 27 voting members were present, so we realized we had our work cut out for us. We started with a letter to all groups and intergroups, to bring home the message of general service. Our January meeting was much better attended — about 70. But with approximately 300 groups in the area, we are still a long way from home. We conducted a school for G.S.R.'s and committee members, using the outline on how one region built a service structure. As delegate, I plan to send monthly letters to committee members and encourage them to hold district meetings. We have held sharing sessions on the Conference,

and will have more. I hope to give a delegate's report in each of our 18 districts. — *Bob Bacon*

Oklahoma: We have 151 groups, with a membership of 1,886; all but 42 groups contribute. Workshop committee sessions are well attended by the membership in each district, as well as interested members from neighboring districts. Lively discussion on facets of service work and the Traditions is led by former delegates, committee members, and G.S.R.'s. All A.A.'s are encouraged to attend and become informed. At our 1974 assembly, we had 104 groups represented; a total of 248 members attended, including 67 observers — future service people gaining knowledge of service structure and dedication to the principle of carrying the message. — *Clark McCall*

Ontario (Eastern): When I was a year sober, I was posted 750 miles from home. After about ten months of doing relatively little, I became desperate. One of the first meetings I attended was in a psychiatric hospital. Patients had no way of attending outside meetings. I spent the next two years taking those who wanted to go. My original group elected me G.S.R. I have also been a D.C.M., have served on the district P.I. committee, and sponsor meetings in the local jail. When I ran for delegate two years ago, the name that came out of the hat was not mine. That was good for me — I needed less ego and more experience. I was grateful to be elected this time, again from the hat. — *Earl G. Homuth*

Ontario (Northeastern): Included in my A.A. life are such jobs as G.S.R., D.C.M., delegate, and, more important, ash-tray cleaner, coffee maker, floor sweeper, and group greeter. In our city, we are now obtaining a rehab unit and a recovery home. We have three assemblies a year, an annual conference (with almost 800 present), and many small round-ups. All our districts have monthly G.S.R. meetings. I heard some time ago, "Grab a broom, and you will be one of the clique." — *Bill Syms*

Ontario (Northwestern): Rapid growth demands strong service to meet group needs and deal with problems — such as insuring that the flood of new people does not water down our program. In our area, we beat out the old message that the G.S.R. should be the best man in the group. It has paid off. A mini-conference helped to cement our service people together, spark them, and remind us of our responsibilities. Most groups have a Tradition meeting every second week. This informs the newcomer as to what A.A. can and cannot do, and helps keep the older member from going off on a tangent. — *Jack Davis*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): I am grateful to my sponsor and older members of my group, who realized I needed service activity to enhance my sobriety. When they elected me group treasurer, their faith and trust in me helped me to regain confidence in myself. I have served a few new groups as secretary, treasurer, chairman, and G.S.R., and have also been district coordinator for detox and prison groups, alternate and district committee member, alternate delegate, and state chairman. The rewards of service work are too numerous to mention. — *Francis A. Green*

Pennsylvania (Western): I have nearly the same feeling at my first Conference I had at my first A.A. meeting. What am I

doing here? What's going on? It must be something good; the people present seem to love it. And I am going to find out what it is. When I began to serve as G.S.R., I had academic knowledge of the structure of the Fellowship, but no real faith in its efficacy. Then I became D.C.M. and was shown the tremendous possibilities for good that our world services are constantly exploring and effecting. I realized that my group's regular contributions to G.S.O. are among the most important things we do. I realized that the G.S.R. giving time and love and talent was calling me to join him in a world service program, not simply to have a seat in some formal body in A.A. — not to neglect local A.A., but to aid its growth. — *Ellis Bedford*

Quebec (Northeastern): I helped start a group in my own town, then moved to the city. I was active in my district through different committees, but felt I was not giving enough for what I had received, and kept looking forward to learning and serving. I was asked to be delegate. This, for me, is the occasion to thank A.A. for the blessings and years of happiness. My area covers thousands of square miles. Communications are not easy, but I intend to be regularly in contact with all districts and to visit all the groups of my territory (including those way north) to report my Conference experiences. Groups need more information about all the work G.S.O. is doing. — *Benoit Perron*

Quebec (Southeastern): Our area covers 60,000 square miles. I was brought to A.A. by a former delegate, and I have been his runner-up ever since. For a good while, I remained seated in my group, but six years ago became G.S.R. I succeeded my sponsor as delegate. The main purpose of my term will be to organize better communications. Last May, we had the first area gratitude dinner in Quebec, and sent \$1,000 to G.S.O. — *Raymond Houle*

Texas (Northeastern): I was not looking for A.A. nor sobriety when I found the program through the efforts of my wife, by the state hospital route. I was janitor, coffee maker, and secretary of my group. There early, I did a great deal of reading before meeting time. I am still janitor and coffee maker. During 15 years of sobriety, I have been active in state hospitals and state and Federal institutions, and have made meetings, assemblies, and conventions all around the state and surrounding states. I was elected G.S.R., then D.C.M. I served in every capacity I could and now have the privilege of serving as delegate. — *John Henderson*

Texas (Southeastern): I was about a year old in A.A. when I was elected G.S.R. I went to my first meeting with not the foggiest idea of what I had been elected to do, but I had been told to say "Yes" in this program. Service work has played a vital role in my sobriety. Our monthly sharing sessions have grown from a few interested people to as many as a hundred. At quarterly business meetings, we get down to nitty-gritty problems. We have a workable liaison between general service and intergroup. Our public information committee sees that we have excellent coverage in TV, radio, and press, carefully monitored for anonymity breaks. Our institutional work is carried on with the same enthusiasm. — *Olga Morris*

Utah: My sponsors' inspiration, guidance, and example led me to read A.A.'s basic texts, which gave me greater understanding of what A.A. really is. At my first assembly, I had been dry six months. I have enjoyed being a trusted servant in these

capacities: group chairman and secretary, central office representative, G.S.R., D.C.M., outside sponsor at a prison, area chairman, alternate delegate, and delegate. Our districts are beginning to understand unity and general services, and our committees are gaining support from more groups. — *Ike Bowers*

Virginia: Joining A.A. in Baltimore, then moving to a small town, I found myself in a different environment, but was encouraged to take part very early. When our youngsters went away to school, I was introduced to new, exciting service. I began to expand my span of A.A. and started taking new girls to state assemblies. Our area has grown during the past 18 years, so we are in a position to fulfill the Responsibility pledge anywhere, any time. Navy and V.A. hospitals in our area create an influx of new people. We try to be friendly with them, especially those there under duress. We are beginning to see results. — *Ann Nuckols*

Washington: Never before have so many under 30 come to A.A. To be caught in their enthusiasm has been a real joy. I believe most older members feel the truth exists inside us, not in our hairstyles, dress, skin color, or age. In my area, young A.A.'s put on a "winter holiday" convention. Their knowledge of the Traditions and sense of responsibility were heartwarming. The chairman was 25. One young Indian member has served for eight years, since he was 22. There is no need to be concerned about A.A. for those yet to come when we have the depth of sobriety and the devotion to A.A. seen in our young people. — *Natalie Schwanke*

West Virginia: I was appointed G.S.R. by the group's ramrod and told how to vote. Elections were prearranged anyway, so I went along with the system. A lot of jockeying was done to get the conference held in the city of the person who wanted to be elected. It was routine to elect the chairman the new delegate. In 1968, we had our man picked for chairman, and created a few new groups to get more votes. We won, but our new groups were challenged, and a guy with 20 months' sobriety was elected chairman instead. This guy talked about structure and insisted we read "The A.A. Service Manual." Interest increased, and we had a lot of infighting. But in 1970, we elected our officers by Third Legacy procedure for the first time. — *Larry S. [surname omitted at delegate's request]*

Wisconsin (Southern): The understanding of A.A. service, like recovery and spiritual awakening, is not a sudden enlightenment, but a gradual growing process. The capability for service derives from an ordinary affliction, which a loving God has transformed into a unique asset. The motivation for my A.A. service is the same as for my drinking — I want to change the way I feel. The purpose is to enhance the quality of my sobriety. (If I take credit for the sobriety of any other alcoholic, I have to take the blame for every alcoholic who is still drinking.) The objective of A.A. service is to carry the message, often transmitted through family, friends, or others in the field of alcoholism. The results of A.A. service depend upon a Power greater than myself. — *Bernard Scarseth*

The average length of sobriety of the 91 area delegates at the 25th Conference was 12.6 years. Average age of delegates: 53, ranging from 34 to 66.

Massive A.A. Growth Shown in Reports of Trustees, Directors, Staff, Committees

G.S.B. and
G.S.O. reports

General Service Board

Membership, literature sales, and expenses all going up

Trustees' report: I am happy to report the continued growth and increasing vitality of our Fellowship.

All available data — reports from regional and general service trustees at our quarterly meetings, committee activities, book and pamphlet sales, group contributions, Grapevine subscriptions, and correspondence — indicate our Fellowship is still continuing to expand rapidly.

I feel our continuing growth is especially heartening in the face of economic and political unrest in world affairs. In human terms, expansion of A.A. means we are carrying the A.A. message to more alcoholics throughout the world than ever before.

Both contributions and literature sales were up in 1974, and continue to rise in 1975.

However, there are causes for concern. Group contributions still do not begin to meet the cost of services furnished by your General Service Office. Furthermore, although total contributions are up, the gap is widening. Increases in literature sales have been more than offset by increased printing and operating costs and ever-mounting inflationary pressures. These necessitate the first general price rise in A.A. literature in more than 35 years, as previously authorized by the 1971 and 1973 Conferences.

As you know, your board of trustees has an authorized strength of 21 members. Of these, seven (Class A) are non-alcoholics, and 14 (Class B) are alcoholics. The board functions like any similar group in business. Nearly a dozen committees meet at regular intervals to consider matters under their jurisdiction, subject to the approval of the board.

Delegation of responsibility makes it possible for us to do a better and more thorough job in specific areas such as cooperation with the professional community, public information, institutional work, and literature, as well as in planning events such as this Conference and the upcoming Convention in Denver. We can all be pleased to note Denver seems to be heading for record heights, in both attendance and altitude!

The committee system also enables us to seek advice and consultation from experts in specific professional or business areas such as finance and management. These committees report directly to the board.

During the past 12 months, we (1) approved price increase and new discount structure for A.A. Conference-approved literature; (2) approved an increase in the A.A. World Services, Inc., Board of Directors from seven to nine, with the additional members being Class B (alcoholic) out-of-town trustees; (3) voted to participate in the 1976 World Service Meeting on the same basis as previously, meaning we will assume approximately 60% of the expense; (4) approved a new general manager for A.A.W.S.; and (5) approved more space and needed

improvements for A.A.W.S. because of increased volume of activity.

Since there have been changes in the format of the trustees' quarterly weekends of meetings, we now have more time to devote to long-range planning and problems we are apt to confront in years ahead.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairman

A.A.W.S.

Board of A.A. World Services works the year round

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.), is a membership corporation controlled by the trustees, who are the *members*. Its *directors* are elected by the members at their annual meeting in April. Thus, it is, in effect, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the G.S. Board.

At monthly meetings, reports are given on various G.S.O. activities, and literature prices are set. The directors also approve or disapprove requests for permission to reprint our copyrighted literature. G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members, the general manager, the controller, and the departmental coordinator also attend the meetings.

In January, directors requested authorization to increase the number of directors from seven to nine.

A general price increase on literature, plus a new discount on quantity purchases, takes effect May 1, 1975.

Last September, Bob Pearson joined G.S.O. as general manager, thus enabling Bob Hitchins to devote more time to board activities and other out-of-office matters.

Distribution of A.A. literature notably increased in 1974. Sales were \$1,244,700, compared with \$1,152,900 in 1973. (To help defray costs of other services — which contributions could not meet — A.A.W.S. donated \$100,000 to the General Fund.) Distribution of books, pamphlets, etc. totaled 5,145,228 individual units. Free literature sent amounted to 310,500 pieces — inventory value, \$11,078.

Five departments, made up of nonalcoholics, back up our G.S.O. staff. They are:

Accounting — headed by Mario Wistol — which includes a bookkeeper, assistant bookkeeper, accounts-receivable clerk, five full-time accounting clerks, one part-time and three full-time clerk-typists.

Files, headed by Wilma Joseph, with two full-time file clerks and a part-time employee.

Records, supervised by Lena Machado and her assistant, Carol Nielson, has eight people in charge of group information and directory changes.

Shipping, supervised by Al Cryan and his assistant, Haywood Hicks, has 13 full-time and two part-time employees. All incoming and outgoing mail is processed through this department. It also handles maintenance of the Scriptomatic file, mimeographing and distribution of service materials and reports, and quarterly inventories.

Stenographic, supervised by Donna Berkowitz and her assistant, Mary Feeley, employs 14 women—nine stenographers, two clerks, a purchasing clerk, a receptionist, and a switchboard operator.

Walter Murphy, chairman

Literature distributed — 1974

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	137,548
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	64,570
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	21,598
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	14,683
As Bill Sees It	19,693
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish edition	1,369
Total	259,461

Booklet

Came to Believe	23,216
-----------------	--------

Pamphlets

This Is A.A.	246,700
A.A. — 44 Questions and Answers	224,200
Is A.A. for You?	389,500
Young People and A.A.	136,400
A.A. for the Woman	116,200
Three Talks to Medical Societies — by Bill W.	85,300
The Alcoholic Husband	140,800
The Alcoholic Wife	124,700
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	26,900
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	132,200
The Jack Alexander Article	100,500
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	94,200
Is A.A. for You? — Short and Simple (New)	91,200
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	79,900
What Happened to Joe	118,700
It Happened to Alice	86,300
The A.A. Group	53,800
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	46,200
Inside A.A.	62,400
The G.S.R.	36,000
A.A. and the Armed Services (New)	26,900

A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	160,300
The A.A. Service Manual	4,600
Twelve Traditions Illustrated	37,900
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	14,600
The Co-Founders of A.A.	59,600
Understanding Anonymity	92,500
A.A. and the Medical Profession	55,300
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	59,100
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	54,500
A.A. in Prisons	27,000
A.A. in Hospitals	40,200
If You Are a Professional	69,700
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem	62,900
The Fellowship of A.A.	89,700
A.A. in Your Community	132,900
Profile of an A.A. Meeting	68,500
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	21,500
A Member's-Eye View of Alcoholics Anonymous	83,600
Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous	57,400
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	42,000
Problems Other Than Alcohol	76,500
Foreign Translations	116,800
Total	3,846,100

Miscellaneous

Tapes of A.A. Talks	572
Wallet Cards — two-fold	710,628
Wallet Cards — I Am Responsible	95,300
Wallet Cards — Anonymity	45,050
Parchment — Scrolls	4,699
Plaques	908
How It Works	147,400
Beginners Meeting Kit	2,596
Group Handbook	3,254
Wire Racks	1,146
Cassettes	130
A.A. Public Information Manual	1,410
Twelve Concepts for World Service	3,358

Archives

Special room set up at G.S.O. to house historical items

Trustees' committee: During the past year, an attractive archives room has been set up. Nonalcoholic Nell Wing is in charge, always available to answer questions on A.A. history, with a part-time assistant, Harriet Gillen (an A.A.).

Bill's subject files and early group files have been microfilmed, and about 60 tapes have been made from early recorded material. Additional selections will be made for microfilming and taping in 1975.

The chairman thanked all members of the Archives Committee-at-large for historical material sent us, and suggested some early members might like to tape their recollections. Several have, and others plan to do so.

An A.A. from Akron taped her remembrances of Dr. Bob, and other such interviews are planned. A microfilm reader and tape recorder are part of the new archives room equipment. Each

request for access to the archives is decided on by the committee. Two inquiries from writers who are A.A. members were approved.

George Gordon, Ph.D., chairman

Conference

Members' suggestions lead to improvements in 1975 meeting

Staff report: In "As Bill Sees It," Bill says: "The unity of A.A. is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. Without unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God." And "Clearly, our first duty to A.A.'s future is to maintain in full strength what we now have. Only the most vigilant caretaking can assure this. Never should we be lulled into complacent self-satisfaction by the wide acclaim and success that are everywhere ours. This is the subtle temptation which could render us stagnant today, perchance disintegrate us tomorrow. We have always rallied to meet and transcend failure and crisis.

Problems have been our stimulants. How well, though, shall we be able to meet the problems of success?"

Twenty-five General Service Conferences have certainly played a major share in maintaining A.A. unity and in dealing with both crisis and success. The Conference represents to all of us the *collective* conscience of our entire Fellowship. It has kept us constantly aware of our common welfare.

G.S.O. is grateful to all delegates for cooperation in handling group information cards, so our mailing list can be as complete and accurate as possible, and for seeing that G.S.O. received information promptly on election of new area delegates, committee officers, and district committee members.

Area committee secretaries have done a fine job of reporting on assembly and committee meetings, and G.S.O. is grateful to be on the mailing list for these. One of the Conference secretary's responsibilities is to read these minutes carefully. It has been a rewarding learning experience for this secretary. Items concerning institutions, public information, relations with the professional community, Grapevine, literature, etc. are marked to the attention of staff members involved, who find the information helpful in their assignments, too.

As we receive suggestions for the Conference agenda, and after they have been presented to the trustees' Committee on the Conference and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval, this information is shared in the *Quarterly Report* and Box 4-5-9. Preliminary agendas were mailed early in Janu-

ary this year, to be available for January assemblies.

Some responsibilities of the Conference secretary are:

- 1 Correspondence with all past and present delegates. (Approximately 615 past delegates are on the G.S.O. mailing list for Box 4-5-9 and the *Quarterly Report*.)
- 2 Preparation of the *Quarterly Report* following meetings of the General Service Board and its standing committees. It goes to delegates, past delegates, trustees, past trustees, directors of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, area committee officers, district committee members, central offices, and World Service Meeting delegates.
- 3 Collection of suggestions for Conference theme and agenda and presenting them to the Conference Agenda Committee and trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval and/or selection. These are reported in the *Quarterly Report* and Box 4-5-9.
- 4 Preparation of the agenda, in consultation with the general manager and members of the committees mentioned previously.
- 5 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the Conference.
- 6 Sending monthly letters to delegates, then corresponding with them in preparation for the Conference.



- 7 Coordination of activities related to the annual meeting.
- 8 Reviewing all communications from area committees and D.C.M.'s.
- 9 Scheduling and routing material for Conference Manuals. Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*, and the *Final Conference Report*.
- 10 Working with the editor on these publications.
- 11 Preparation of summaries of Ask-It Basket questions and answers and Conference Advisory Actions.
- 12 Working with the general manager, office manager, and staff in all phases of Conference planning.

Cora Louise Belford

Trustees' committee: We reviewed suggestions from the 1974 Conference evaluation questionnaires and recommended many — for instance: an orientation session conducted by regional trustees with the new delegates; a time limitation on use of the microphone during floor discussions; a new format for the Ask-It Basket — one session of one and a half hours; opening each Conference day with the Serenity Prayer, ending with the Lord's Prayer.

We reviewed agenda subjects, and the preliminary agenda was mailed to all delegates in January.

In February, the chairman drew the names of Panel 25 delegates for Conference committee assignments.

We recommended preparation of the chart illustrating Conference membership [see p. 53].

To improve workshop mechanics, an orientation session for moderators was scheduled.

We reviewed suggestions for the theme and recommended three to the Agenda Committee for its final choice.

The 1974 evaluation questionnaire was reviewed, and its use in 1975 was recommended.

Margaret J. Carlson, chairman

40th Anniversary International Convention

Events planned for Denver include regional alkathons

Staff report: Over 10,000 registrations for Denver have come in, as of April 1.

Shaping up, the Convention looks like one big A.A. meeting after another. About 30 alkathons will run from 8:00 a.m. until 2:00 a.m. Five daily workshops start at 9:00 a.m. Two-hour panel sessions, at which non-A.A. friends will speak, are scheduled mornings and afternoons.

All meetings will be held in the Denver Convention Complex,

except midnight alkathons in the New Albany, Cosmopolitan, Regency, and Brown Palace Hotels and the Holiday and Executive Tower Inns.

Free buses will be available, with your badge as your fare.

The Denver Food Committee will advise restaurants and hotels that an unusual amount of coffee and soft drinks will be needed.

Three committees are at work on this year's International Convention — G.S.O. Planning, trustees', and Conference, plus the ones in Colorado, of course.

Lois will be with us in Denver, and we hope you won't miss this opportunity to share A.A., Al-Anon, and Alateen, along with thousands of other A.A.'s from around the world celebrating our 40th anniversary.

Waneta New

Trustees' committee: Established in 1973, this committee has overseen all aspects of the 40th Anniversary International Convention, especially changes from previous Conventions.

Some local conventions usually held between May and early July changed dates to avoid conflict with the July 4-6 celebration in Denver, Colo.

Regional and general service trustees will chair alkathons and name their speakers. Regional alkathons are scheduled according to A.A. regional population and anticipated attendance.

The committee also approved the following:

- Names of guest speakers and the over-all program.
- Format for Friday-night and Sunday-morning meetings — three speakers, 30 minutes each.
- A registration fee of \$15 for all Convention meetings and entertainment, with refund cutoff date of June 1.
- The Al-Anon budget and mailing of an Al-Anon flyer.
- Gasoline expenses (15¢ per mile) for the Transportation Committee.

The committee also discussed the subject of local meetings observing A.A.'s 40th anniversary. We decided not to promote these, but if we are asked to help, we shall do all we can.

Donald G. Austin, chairman

Host Committee report: After the past five days of being crammed with kindness and information, being whirled through sessions, I feel stuffed and dizzy, like a rookie astronaut who has just eaten a ten-course dinner in a centrifuge.

On this last day, I'm thinking of new friends I've made. Ordinarily, it would be a year before I'd see you again. This time, however, many of us will be seeing each other, I hope, in Denver the first week in July. So to me this is more than a report. It's an invitation, an assurance to

A.A.'s all over the world that you'll be welcome at the Sixth International Convention of our Fellowship.

Waneta New, our Convention secretary, says the *latest* figure on advance registrations is 12,000, with more coming in every day. We are expecting as many as 15- or 16,000 A.A., Al-Anon and Alateen members. That'll be several thousand more than at any past International!

Housing: Many of you will come thousands of miles. Four years ago, the Host Committee began lining up hotels close to Denver's big, new, modern Convention Center. Over 7,000 rooms have been set aside in the best and most convenient hotels and motels. Reservations have nearly filled up the major downtown hotels. Still, there are rooms available. For those with campers, there is a list of camp grounds. Weeks ago, camper space was reserved by a member coming from New Zealand!

Transportation: A.A. meetings, the Saturday-night show, and the pre-Convention dances will all take place in the huge Convention Center. Bus and taxi service will be available. The local bus company is cooperating to assure Convention-goers good service to and from locations outside the Convention Center area. Denver A.A.'s on the Transportation Committee will use their own cars to meet non-A.A. speakers at the airport, and will be available for emergencies and special situations.

Food: A.A.'s get hungry. The Food Committee is alerting luxury cafés and hamburger joints alike to multiply their usual coffee allotment two or three times. The committee will have a list of names and locations of scores of eating places, with their price range. In the main Convention Hall, light snacks will be available.

Hospitality: When you get to Denver, you'll be wondering about such problems as "How do I get to the Albany Hotel?," "In what convention hall is the World Hello meeting?," and "How do I get in touch with my friend Charley K. from Sassafras Springs?" Leave it to our Hospitality Committee. These official greeters will be on duty from early in the morning to late at night at the Convention Complex to direct you to registration desks, the various meetings, and friends registered at the Convention.

Information: A.A. members at booths in the Convention Hall and the main hotels will have programs and other information about the Convention itself, eating places, and bus schedules.

Entertainment: We A.A.'s usually provide our own entertainment, but we like good professional entertainment, too. Our Entertainment Committee has come up with some. The Saturday-night show will feature Enzo Stuarti, backed by the famous Ray Bloch orchestra of the Ed Sullivan show. Also on the bill are Hal Le Roy, the Spurrllows (16 young dancer-singers), Skiles and Henderson, Gene Sheldon, and Talurah Lee. You've seen most of these on the Merv Griffin and Johnny Carson shows. The M.C. will be TV's Jack Bailey — who emceed the 1960 show in Long Beach. By the way, these entertainers are *not* playing a benefit. A.A. is paying these professional artists for their services, demonstrating that we hold out our hand only to *give* help, not to ask for outside contributions of either money

or talent. Thursday, the night before the Convention opens, there will be two dances. One features a rock combo (non-acid). The other will have two orchestras alternating: Ray Bloch and a Country Western group.

Program: So far, I haven't mentioned the main reason we look forward to these get-togethers — the three-day program of A.A. meetings, panel meetings, workshops, and daytime and midnight talkathons — plus something extra that can't be put into words. If you attended other A.A. Conventions, you know it — the marvelous feeling of fellowship, the excitement, joy, and gratitude that God gives to us who share this common bond, this daily reprieve from alcoholism. Until we meet in Denver, God bless you all.

Don Burow (Colorado), reporting on behalf of the Denver Host Committee and its chairman, Jack Mohr

Cooperation with the Professional Community

A.A.'s role in the alcoholism field is steadily reexamined

Staff report: In Vermont and Massachusetts, meetings for A.A.'s working in the alcoholism field were attended by the C.P.C. chairman and secretary. The latter spoke on the woman alcoholic at the Delaware Summer Institute on Alcoholism, in Wilmington.

In 1974, for the first time, a G.S.O. staff member attended the full course of the Summer School for Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University. We were also responsible for the open A.A. meeting for all students.

We participated in gatherings of the National Council on Alcoholism, the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, and an interstate regional conference on alcoholism, in New York. Cornell medical students and those of the Alcoholism Personnel Training Program, Rutgers, visited G.S.O.

Our Professional Exhibit was shown in nine cities at annual national meetings of N.I.A.A., N.C.A., Association of School Administrators, New England Hospital Association, American Personnel and Guidance Association, American Orthopsychiatric Association, National Conference on Social Welfare, American Nurses Association, National Medical Association, National Federation of Licensed Practical Nurses, and the first North American Congress on Alcohol and Drug Problems. As a result, we received 2,232 requests for literature.

Mary Ellen Uribe

Trustees' committee: During the past year, trustees and G.S.O. staff have participated in several national meetings. Highlight was the North American Congress on Alcohol and Drug Problems in San Francisco in December. Dr. John L. Norris reported on the 1974 membership survey. With Mary Ellen Uribe, we visited A.A. groups in the area to share experience and clarify some misunderstandings concerning members employed in the alcoholism field.

At the 1974 meeting of the National Council on Alcoholism in Denver, A.A. had a workshop for such members.

One committee member chaired a panel on cooperation with the professional community at the Northern New Jersey Area conference, and another attended the annual conference of the Association of Halfway House Alcoholism Programs in Middlebury, Conn.

Dr. Norris delivered a paper on A.A. at a scientific conference on alcoholism research in Washington, D.C.

Willard O. Foster, special assistant to the deputy director of the U.S. National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, met with our committee. He said most alcoholism programs employ A.A.'s and A.A. is generally regarded as *the* long-term recovery program. He suggested we reexamine: (a) our concept of cooperation versus affiliation (are we too rigid at times?); (b) promotion versus attraction — where to draw the line; (c) talking to professionals in *their* language; (d) putting more stress on what A.A. does *not* do.

Communication between A.A.'s and professionals was also discussed, because not enough Twelfth Step work and sponsorship are being done. In some areas, A.A.'s invite professionals to A.A. assemblies to inform them about the Fellowship.

The committee decided not to prepare, at this time, A.A. study material for alcoholism rehabilitation centers, but feels audiovisual material about A.A. is overdue.

Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field, and Cooperating with Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs were updated. The pamphlet "Cooperation but Not Affiliation" was rewritten, under the title "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics."

The third edition of our newsletter *About A.A.* was mailed in December. It was well accepted and we received many requests for it.

Robert Macpherson, chairman

Institutions

A.A. reaches more alcoholics in hospitals and prisons

Staff report: The 1970 records show 925 prison groups; 1974, 1,021. In 1970, we listed 767 hospital groups; in 1974, 1,046. The significant increase in the latter reflects activity of alcoholism agencies and treatment centers. Regardless of the initial treatment, A.A. is usually recommended.

Correspondence shows the need for greater acceptance and followup by A.A. of the newcomer who sobered up in a hospital and received or is receiving professional treatment.

A.A. groups in prisons need more outside sponsors, speakers, correspondence with outside A.A.'s, and literature.

The institutions staff member informs the Fellowship of these needs through G.S.O. publications and correspondence. In addition, we correspond with those in institutions, and encourage other members to. We send Group Handbooks and

complimentary literature to new groups, provide updated prison and hospital directories every two years, and send the A.A. directories for the U.S. and Canada to hospital and prison groups. Each institutions group receives *Box 4-5-9*, plus the *Institutions Bulletin* three times yearly. Discount packages of A.A. literature are available to inside groups and to institutions committees. Guidelines available are those on Cooperation with Rehabilitation Centers, Cooperating with Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs, and Institutional Committees. Tapes and films are also available, on a loan basis without charge.

The Institutions Correspondence Service has about 100 outside A.A.'s sharing with those on the inside. However, more correspondents are needed.

Services provided by the institutions desk open the door to A.A. recovery, with the help of local institutions committees as well as inside and outside A.A. sponsors.

June Russell

Trustees' committee: This body encourages A.A. members to carry the message to alcoholics in institutions and reviews all aspects of service to institutions A.A. groups and committees.

On a 1974 Conference recommendation, a questionnaire was sent to all delegates to find out about the institutions committee in each area. A summary report of the survey was compiled, but there was inadequate information. Fewer than half of the delegates responded.

We decided a simplified version of "Memo to an Inmate" was not imperative, but the necessity of changing the questionnaire in the pamphlet was obvious. One example was "Do you lose time from work due to drinking?" The questions have been revised for the rerun of the pamphlet.

Changes will be made in the pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons," using the term "correctional" instead of "penal."

A study made by Rutgers of older problem drinkers in nursing homes, rehab centers, and other facilities was brought to our attention. We want to cooperate with A.A. efforts directed to elder citizens in institutions.

A letter requesting information about A.A. in adult correctional institutions has been sent to wardens and superintendents in the New England and North Atlantic states, and will be sent to other areas later.

Austin MacCormick, chairman

Internationalists

487 members on ships carry the message around the world

Staff report: We have 487 seagoing A.A.'s who carry the A.A. message around the world. Four meetings aboard ship are listed with G.S.O.

These members keep in touch with A.A. through correspon-

dence with each other and G.S.O. We provide each Internationalist with names and addresses of others, and with the *A.A. International Directory* and the U.S. and Canadian directories. These are their meeting lists. Several inactive Internationalists serve as port contacts in various parts of the world. Six times a year, the *Round Robin* newsletter is sent to Internationalists. It shares excerpts of their letters. On alternate months, *Box 4-5-9* is sent.

In 1948, a seagoing A.A. left the Big Book in three Far East ports. Many A.A. groups were started by Internationalists, and one started a ham radio group, which carries the message over the airwaves around the world.

June Russell

Literature

New stories being considered to update the Big Book

Trustees' committee: In cooperation with the Conference committee, the following actions were taken:

Stories for updating the Big Book were chosen for review by trustees' and Conference committees.

The new booklet "Living Sober" is at the printers.

The idea of a pamphlet of Dr. Bob's and Bill's last talks was approved.

A writer was assigned to prepare "So You Think You Are Special," with a first draft April 1.

"Are we weakening our structure with so much literature and getting away from the essential one-to-one, personal relationship?" Question was referred to the Conference Literature Committee.

It was suggested that a manuscript on "reentry" be explored for possible inclusion in the new pamphlet "So You Think You Are Special" and in the revision of "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," to be ready this summer.

A committee to review all A.A. literature, to see where pamphlets can be combined or dropped, was appointed. Its recommendations adopted include dropping the older version of "Is A.A. for You?," "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous,"

"Our Critics Can Be Our Benefactors," and "A.A. as a Community Service"; and combining and updating "The Alcoholic Husband" and "The Alcoholic Wife."

Rejected were suggestions that the 1969-71 Traditions series in the Grapevine be made into a pamphlet; that the word "rarely" be changed to "never" (Big Book, start of fifth chapter); and that another guide to the Fourth and Fifth Steps be prepared.

The view of a past delegate that the "program of recovery" is "suggested," not the Steps, was noted with appreciation.

It was suggested that the title of Chapter 8 ("To Wives") in the Big Book be changed to "Spouses" or to "Mates."

Questions for use in updating "A.A. for the Woman" and "Young People and A.A." were reviewed.

George Gordon, Ph.D., chairman

Loners

Over 450 Lone Members share by mail in four languages

Staff report: We added over 40 Loners to our list this year. Estimated at 450, they include 43 who speak Spanish; 41, French; three, German. Yolanda Lazo helps correspond with the Spanish-speaking.

Loners are A.A.'s who "go it alone" because no A.A. meeting is nearby or because they are housebound or disabled. There is a unique quality about the isolated A.A. who does not have the A.A. meeting or social contact we have. The Loner reads literature, writes letters, works on Steps, and turns to a Higher Power. The isolated member knows a lot about the spiritual side of the program.

This year in *Loners Meeting*, a meeting by mail, we discuss two Steps in each bimonthly issue.

Loner Sponsors, now over 500, correspond with Loners.

Lone Members try to start A.A. groups in their communities. It's not always easy. Sometimes, they read the Big Book aloud while waiting weeks for a fellow alcoholic to show up. New groups have started in Newfoundland, Alaska, and Northern Ireland through such efforts. A.A. works by mail!

Susan Coyle

Nominating

Way to reduce number of trustee candidates proposed

Trustees' committee: Established by the General Service Board in 1944, this committee reviews backgrounds of, and makes recommendation on, all trustee candidates for the board, and corporate directors of A.A. World Services and the Grapevine. Its members help elect trustees.



Since the last Conference, the committee recommended:

1 That Gordon M. Patrick, Toronto, Ont., be elected to the G.S. Board, as a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee, and Charles H. Hanson, Fairfield, Conn., be elected as a general service trustee — following presentation of their names to the '75 Conference for disapproval, if any.

2 That the following also be elected to the General Service Board following presentation to the '75 Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A	
John L. Norris, M.D.	Austin McCormick
John Daniel Bealer, M.D.	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.	Arthur Miles

Class B	
Margaret J. Carlson	Walter Murphy
David T. Cooke	Terrance Penton
George Gordon, Ph.D.	Peter A. G. Watters
James G. Griffin	R. Bruce Wight
Robert Macpherson	Stanley R. Wilsey
Two regional trustees: N.E. U.S., S.E. U.S.	
One general service trustee—Canada	

3 That the following be elected officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairman</i>	John L. Norris, M.D.
<i>First vice-chairman</i>	Austin McCormick
<i>Second vice-chairman</i>	Margaret J. Carlson
<i>Secretary</i>	Terrance Penton
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur Miles
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Ann Macfarlane
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Dennis Manders

4 That the following be elected directors of A.A. World Services, Inc.,

Christian Anderson	Ann Macfarlane
Jerry Danzig	Robert Macpherson
Robert Hitchins	Walter Murphy
Martin Le Boutillier	

5 That Edward Small, New York, N.Y., and Polly Marsh, Greenwich, Conn., be elected as directors of the Grapevine.

6 That the following officers and additional directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be elected:

Charles H. Hanson, <i>president, chairman</i>	Tom Carpenter
George Gordon, Ph.D., <i>treasurer</i>	Joseph Huber Jr.
Paula Carpenter, <i>vice-president, secretary</i>	Austin McCormick
	Jack Morley

7 That Eastern and Western Missouri's request for change of region from West Central to Southwest and Alaska's for change of region from Pacific to Western Canada be presented to the '75 Conference. Since Alaska could then be eligible to elect Class B (alcoholic) candidates for both Western Canadian trustee and general service trustee Canada, it was further recommended that Eastern Canadian delegates also be polled in Step 2 of "Procedure for Requesting Change of Region" (page 96 of "The A.A. Service Manual").

8 To furnish more specific information regarding trustee candidates' employment in the field of alcoholism, that Class B

trustee résumé forms also ask whether the candidate is now working in the field of alcoholism, for how long, with whom, with what title, and with or without salary.

9 That the following procedure be adopted in the election at future Conferences of Class B general service trustees — U.S./Canada, subject to the approval of this Conference:

a Each Conference area may elect one candidate, or two or more areas may jointly propose a single candidate via Third Legacy procedure.

b Résumés of all candidates will be reviewed for eligibility by the trustees' Nominating Committee.

c Delegates from each region will caucus prior to the election, using Third Legacy procedure, to reduce the number of candidates to one each in the U.S. and two each in the Canadian regions. A maximum of six candidates for general service trustee — U.S. and a maximum of four candidates for general service trustee — Canada will be presented to the voting members of the Conference for election.

d Voting members of the Conference will be all delegates from the electing country (U.S. or Canada) and all members of the trustees' Nominating Committee. This recommendation was made at the request of the '74 Conference, for reducing the number of candidates.

Junior Anderson, chairman

Overseas

Membership outside U.S. and Canada up 10,000 in a year

Staff report: Membership overseas — 107,127; groups overseas — 6,088. The increase in membership since April 1974 is approximately 10,000; in groups, 313.

At the first World Service Meeting, in 1969, Bill said: "The first meeting of the General Service Conference was held in 1951. It was hoped that some day other countries, by the necessity of geography and language, would form general service centers of their own. It was never thought that New York would be the seat of the 'government' of A.A. Rather, it would become the center with the oldest experience, and this experience would be shared with other offices, which would be free to make their own choices."

The third World Service Meeting, in London, England, more than demonstrated this expected development. It was hosted by the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous of Great Britain and Northern Ireland. The U.S.-Canadian G.S. Board was represented by the same number of delegates (two) as every other country. Three New York staff members attended to assist the English staff.

At G.S.O., we help in establishment of overseas boards and centers, which provide for groups in their own countries the services that we used to provide worldwide.

These 20 literature distribution centers provide their new

groups with complimentary literature: Argentina, Australia, Belgium (Flemish and French), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Finland, France, Germany, Guatemala, Holland, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South and Southwest Africa, Sweden, and Switzerland (French and German).

Argentina now has a G.S. board and a G.S. office. They have been publishing several pamphlets (with permission of A.A.W.S., Inc.) and this year obtained permission to reprint the Big Book. They have developed a general service conference.

Australia now has its own G.S.O., from which the conference and publishing company operate, servicing their central offices. We now subsidize their distribution of complimentary literature to new groups.

Brazil has had a literature distribution center in São Paulo since 1969, and A.A.'s in Brazil are now working toward establishing a general service board and office.

Colombia's G.S. Board has printed 26 Conference-approved pamphlets, as well as the Big Book and "As Bill Sees It."

Finland has translated almost all of our Conference-approved literature. The latest is "Come to Believe." Because 8% of their population is Swedish-speaking, they also publish a few pamphlets in Swedish.

Germany continues to work on its structure and has relocated its service office. It publishes the Big Book in German.

Norway has the Big Book, "Twelve and Twelve," and nine pamphlets in Norwegian, and is translating four more pamphlets.

Mexico and *Colombia* work together on translations, so there will be uniformity of literature in Spanish. Mexico has 18 Conference-approved pamphlets, and this year cooperated with a program planned by the federal ministry of Health and Public Assistance for rehabilitation of alcoholics.

South Africa is working on literature for the Bantu and other Africans in their own dialects. Since many groups are economically underprivileged, this literature is provided at 50% of cost. They are investigating the possibility of producing comic-strip-form pamphlets for Africans.

Sweden publishes the Big Book in Swedish. Sweden and Finland work together on Swedish pamphlets.

United Kingdom intergroups provide the necessary conference structure with representation from all groups.

Publications similar to our Grapevine and Box 4-5-9 are: Belgium — 5 to 12; Colombia — *El Mensaje*; Finland — *The Decision*; Germany — *Information*; New Zealand — *Mainstay*; Norway — Box 15387; Sweden — Box 16387; South Africa — *Regmaker*; United Kingdom — *Share*.

In the last year, we've continued to work with A.A. members in several other countries around the world. We've seen considerable progress in our growth in Italy, Guyana, and Trinidad, West Indies. We will continue to help provide whatever services are needed in areas where no board or office exists,

and to help in the development of these boards and offices when requested to do so.

Betty Liddle

Policy

Guests and discussions help the board make decisions

Trustees' committee: This is a forum for discussion and review of policy matters that might affect A.A. as a whole. Voting members are: eight regional trustees, two general service trustees from outside the New York area, two G.S.O. staff members, the president and a director of the Grapevine, the president and a director of A.A.W.S., and two additional trustees designated by the chairman of the G.S. Board.

Some items discussed at meetings since the 1974 Conference are:

National developments which might affect A.A., reported by Willard O. Foster, special assistant to the deputy director, U.S. National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, Washington, D.C. Mr. Foster suggested that A.A. needs: (a) to be alert to meet the needs of the ever-increasing number of alcoholic referrals; (b) to concentrate on sponsorship and Twelfth Step work, A.A.'s primary purpose, resisting the urge to do things that A.A. is not designed to do; and (c) to do more to let professionals know what A.A. can and cannot do.

Use of the A.A. program in a hospital, clinic or rehabilitation center. The consensus was that we should do more to carry the message to such facilities and provide information about the program to professionals.

Does the increasing number of A.A. members employed in the alcoholism field affect A.A.? It was felt that problems affecting these members will diminish as their job expertise increases, and as knowledge about A.A. increases.

If there is a decline in sponsorship, can anything be done about it? Suggestions offered include special sponsorship meetings, emphasis in all A.A. publications on the value of sponsorship to continuing sobriety, and formation of Big Book study groups to provide new members with basic group sponsorship.

Increase in the number of regional meetings of past and present delegates and trustees. The consensus was that these meetings are helpful, using experience to increase unity.

The showing of the film "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" at A.A. orientation sessions in institutions. It was felt this would not be suitable.

Preparation of audiovisual material about the A.A. program. This was recommended.

"How an A.A. Member Functions as a Professional in the Field of Alcoholism." This was the topic of a talk by Jim McNerney, program director of Little Hill Alina Lodge in Blairstown, N.J. Copies of the talk are available at G.S.O.

Are G.S.O. and the Fellowship as a whole putting too much emphasis on informing the public about A.A. and cooperation with professionals, at the expense of Twelfth Step work at the group level? The response was that we could not put too much emphasis on these two important aspects of carrying the message, but there is need for an in-depth discussion on sponsorship.

Money from A.A. registration at Al-Anon conventions. It was decided we cannot accept these contributions.

Donald G. Austin, chairman

Public Information

1974 totals: 3,882 mentions in the press, 8,589 inquiries

Staff report: This assignment helps carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic and potential alcoholic through the media (news-papers, magazines, radio/TV). We also seek to reach others in a position to help, such as the spouse or employer.

During 1974, we answered 8,589 inquiries, reviewed 3,882 press clippings, distributed 198 color-TV spots and 230 radio spots, and sent 41 One-Way Displays for use at local county and state meetings. A.A. is now listed in 55 encyclopedias and reference books.

We have almost 200 local P.I. committees and 532 P.I. contacts. We provide them with the P.I. Kit (including background editorial and radio-TV material and the A.A. Fact File), the bimonthly *P.I. Bulletin*, radio-TV spots, and Guidelines for P.I. Committees.

The annual anonymity letter was mailed in November to approximately 500 dailies.

Material was supplied to 21 writers. We helped with coverage of A.A. on seven major radio and TV programs; and Bob Pearson recorded for NBC radio two announcements for the holiday season. Information was made available to eight educational and community service organizations.

Phyllis Masback

Trustees' committee: During the past year, we worked to provide information about the Fellowship to the public at large.

The 1974 membership survey was extremely successful. Questionnaires were sent to 450 groups (3% of the total U.S. and Canadian groups listed). Over 13,000 returns were received, only four out of 91 areas not heard from. All states and provinces were represented.

Results were announced at the North American Congress on Alcohol and Drug Problems in San Francisco in December, with a press conference. Over 300 press clippings have been received, and the survey was mentioned during CBS news with Walter Cronkite and on NBC's *Today* show. Releases were sent to P.I. committees for local use.

In conjunction with the C.P.C. Committee, a display and other material based on the 1974 survey are being prepared.

We recommend that *individual* letters to the press on anonymity breaks be discontinued — but *not* the *annual* anonymity letter to the press. We cannot expect the press to preserve and protect our Traditions for us; this is our job. However, when requested by the delegate, we will continue to send the anonymity letter, along with the anonymity pamphlet and wallet card, to identifiable members whose anonymity has been broken.

An article on anonymity in the May 1975 Grapevine may be placed with one of the feature news services. It explains why the A.A. member stubbornly remains anonymous at the media level.

An article about A.A. is being prepared for closed-circuit TV to about 140,000 doctors.

A paper stressing the positive aspects of A.A. recovery ("Who Is the A.A. Member Today?") was sent in June to the P.I. mailing list. Our pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" has been revised, and a special discount package for public information speakers is now available.

The P.I. Committee is working with the Host Committee in Denver in planning publicity for the International Convention.

Walter Murphy, chairman

Service coordinator

Materials useful to groups and members are kept moving

Staff report: *New Groups* — Complimentary literature and a Group Handbook are sent to each, and it is added to the G.S.O. mailing list to receive Box 4-5-9, the appropriate directory, and other communications.

Directories — These are once again being published. The new *International A.A. Directory* (outside U.S. and Canada) is now available. The other three — Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S. — will be available later. A copy is sent free to each group listed therein. All are priced at 75¢. Our biennial institutions directories, *Hospital and Rehabilitation Centers* and *Correctional Facilities*, are also scheduled this year.

Guidelines — There are now 13: (1) Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers, (2) Armed Services, (3) Central or Intergroup Offices, (4) Clubs, (5) Conferences and Conventions, (6) Cooperation with Court, A.S.A.P. and Similar Programs, (7) Institutional Committees, (8) Public Information Committees, (9) Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon, (10) On Industry Programs, (11) A.A. Cooperation with Alcoholism Agencies and Facilities, (12) For Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field, (13) Current Usage of Directories.

Films — Two 16 mm. color films, "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," are distributed free to groups in institutions, and rented to other A.A. groups at \$35.00 per week. The G.S.O. filmstrip sells for \$6.00.

Tapes and cassettes — Eight tapes on reels are \$3.00 each, and a cassette of a talk by Bill on A.A.'s Three Legacies is \$3.50.

Service material – Also available are such miscellaneous items as listings of Loners, Internationalists, armed forces groups, members who like to exchange tapes, etc.

Box 4-5-9 – Published every other month in English, Spanish, and French, it shares A.A. experience worldwide, gives news about A.A., and discusses problems. Subscriptions are \$1.50; in bulk, 10 for \$3.50. Some 20 overseas offices now receive bulk supplies so they can mail to their own groups.

Literature kits – These are sent on a complimentary basis or in response to orders.

Traffic – Production of all bulletins, service material, pamphlets, and books is scheduled and controlled by the service coordinator.

A.A.'s copyright – All Conference-approved literature is copyrighted. Permission for any of it to be reprinted or quoted must be granted by A.A. World Services, Inc.

Beth Kuhlmann

Staff coordinator

G.S.O. staff greeted 1,100 visitors during 1974

Staff report: The ten G.S.O. staff members have these specific assignments: staff coordinator, service coordinator, General Service Conference, cooperation with the professional community, public information, overseas, the World Service Meeting, the 1975 Convention, institutions, Internationalists, and Lone Members. Bulletins and reports pertinent to them include *Box 4-5-9* (English, Spanish and French), *Quarterly Report*, *About A.A.*, *P.I. Bulletin*, *World Service Meeting Report*, *Institutions Bulletin*, *Round Robin*, and *Loners Meeting*.

Staff members are also secretaries of board and Conference committees.

The work of first importance to the staff is answering correspondence, as it was in 1941 when the first letters began to come into the office at 30 Vesey Street as a result of the Jack Alexander *Saturday Evening Post* article. Approximately 20,000 letters a year are answered individually by the staff. Another rewarding aspect of our work is the invitations received from the ever-increasing number of A.A. get-togethers. During these trips, we are able to learn of local activities, and that helps us to be a better service office.

In 1974, about 1,100 visitors from all over the world came to see G.S.O. Visitors spend time with the staffer corresponding with their area, or with the staff member who is concerned with their particular A.A. interest.

Two weekly folders, of correspondence and of publications, are circulated to all the staff. Staff meetings, held three times a month, help keep the staff informed and provide a forum for discussion of problems that need some direction from the group conscience.

Ann Macfarlane

World Service Meeting

World sharing expands A.A. knowledge and responsibility

Staff report: For the first time, a World Service Meeting was held outside the United States – the third, in Great Britain last October. Represented were: Australia, Belgium, Central America (Northern and Southern Zones), Finland, France, Germany, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, Argentina, Colombia, Sweden, United States/Canada. The theme was "Sharing."

Committee meetings (Agenda, Finance, Literature/Publishing, and Policy) took on a new aspect at the world level. Workshops were held on communications between countries, internal communications (bulletins, magazines, services to groups, conferences, and conventions), and external communications (working with professionals, public information, and A.A. in industry).

The following was adopted as the "World Service Meeting Statement of Purpose":

"The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is the same as that of all A.A. activity: to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers – wherever in the world he may be, whatever the language he speaks. The World Service Meeting seeks ways and means of accomplishing this goal by serving as a forum for sharing the experience, strength, and hope of delegates who come together every two years from all corners of the world. It can also represent an expression of the group conscience on a worldwide basis. Experience teaches us that organizing ourselves into a sound structure enables us to develop and deliver our services more effectively. The World Service Meeting encourages the planning of sound service structure, suited to the needs and capabilities of the various countries, and the exploration of expanding A.A. services to reach the alcoholic through internal communication, literature distribution, sponsorship, public information, community relations, and institutions work."

The next meeting will be held in New York in 1976. Suggested theme is "Working With Others."

It was found that Finland and Germany had made some progress in carrying the message to Russia and other East European countries.

Topics suggested for workshops at the next meeting are: special groups that have requirements for membership; service bulletins; institutions around the world.

It was recommended that all G.S.O.'s include in literature to new groups either "The A.A. Service Manual" or "The A.A. Group" pamphlet. It was suggested that a *World Service Bulletin* be issued periodically, and that the W.S. structure be allowed to develop on a language basis, instead of on a national basis.

It was also recommended that W.S.M. delegates' fees remain at \$400. But, with the aim of making the W.S. Meeting self-supporting, it was noted that nations willing and able to make additional contributions should feel free to do so.

It was suggested that when an area feels the need for a publishing operation, it should develop a formal plan for submission to A.A. World Services, Inc., insuring at the same time that each individual member of the World Service Meeting Publishing/Literature Committee is fully informed.

The policy of no observers at the meetings was reaffirmed, as was the principle of rotation on a two-meeting (four-year) basis for W.S. delegates.

The G.S.O. in England did a marvelous job with a very limited staff. The chairman of the U.K. board, Ronald L., was always available. We are very grateful to the G.S.O. staff in London and members of its board for their fine work.

One delegate summed up the World Service Meeting this way: "Actually, there isn't any national A.A., but one A.A. in the whole world!"

Waneta New

A.A. directories

New directories offer better A.A. service

The 24th Conference approved the following recommendations — that:

- Delegates assume responsibility for all directory cards in their areas.
- *Only full names and phone numbers for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information be published.* (This will be clearly indicated on the card.)
- Meeting-place information be included on group information cards. *This is for reference at G.S.O. only, not for the directory.*
- Part I (U.S. and Canada) of the directory be divided into three sections: (a) Eastern U.S., (b) Western U.S., (c) Canada.

- Work be scheduled so that Part II of the directory (all other countries) may be distributed before summer, for vacation travelers.

- A staggered (pardon the expression) system of mailing be established to spread work at G.S.O. throughout the year.

These recommendations are being followed.

The delegates responded in true A.A. fashion to their new responsibility of distributing and collecting the group information cards. As a result, the return of these cards has been the best we have ever had, and the directories will be much more accurate. We are most grateful to all the delegates for their splendid performance of a difficult task.

A new method of production has been found, and the conversion is in process. The first directory completed was the international, mailed in February. The prison and hospital directories should be in print shortly. The Canadian directory will be the next one published, after institutions. Information cards for all groups in the Eastern U.S. have been processed. Cards from the Western U.S. are being processed now. Conversion to this new system is time-consuming, but has been going forward smoothly.

The greatest amount of time is taken in line-by-line proofreading of each print-out against the card. The amount of each group's contributions will be balanced and proofread before publication.

It is not yet possible to give a schedule of publication dates. But we will be ahead of our original schedule. It seems reasonable to think the two institutions directories and the Canadian will be available in the second quarter. The two U.S. directories will probably be completed in early summer. Our schedule for 1976 will undoubtedly be way ahead of 1975.

Midge McFadden

The report of the trustees' Finance Committee is included in the presentation "Group Support for Group Services" (p. 11). For Grapevine reports, see the Grapevine presentation (p. 12).

Questions Reflect Fellowship Concerns

The padlocked Ask-It Basket in the main meeting room enabled any Conference member to ask, anonymously, any question whatsoever. In two sessions scheduled for the purpose, all but a few of the queries were answered on the floor of the Conference.

Al-Anon

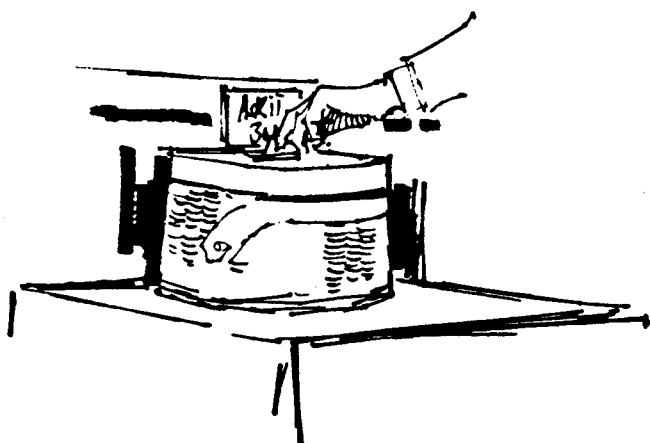
Q. Is there not a violation of tradition with "family groups"? Does not the use of "agency" jargon, such as referring to alcoholism as a "family disease," tend to promote violations?
A. If the word "family" appears in the group name, the group is not listed in the A.A. directories. We have no control over the terms used by others.

Q. Is it written in the Traditions that we should pay expenses for Al-Anon speakers who participate at an A.A. conference?
A. See Guidelines on Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon.

Q. What about financial support from Al-Anon groups for A.A. phone-answering services?
A. Financial help from Al-Anon would be breaking our Traditions. A.A. and Al-Anon should not have the same phone.

A.A. directories

Q. What method do we use to estimate A.A. membership?
A. A.A. makes no effort to keep complete membership records at either the group or the international level, but in



response to demand, we do make an annual estimate. This is based on the actual reported figures of groups and members. Where some of the groups in an area do not include membership figures, an average is made of the reporting groups in each state or province, and this average is assigned arbitrarily to the groups whose reports omit membership figures. The total figure for reported members obtained by this method is then factored to account for the members who do not regularly attend meetings, to obtain an estimated membership for public release. We believe the resulting estimate of membership is extremely conservative.

Q. Should A.A. directories be distributed to institution inmates?

A. A.A.'s on the inside are working on the same lines as A.A.'s on the outside and should be treated as such. The directory is sent to the group secretary, not to the inmates.

Central or intergroup offices

Q. When is A.A.W.S. going to give central offices the status of "wholesalers," rather than "captive retail consumers"? Why do bookstores get a better break on literature and book costs?

A. In order to make our books available in bookstores, we must give these stores the standard trade discount, needed to cover their overhead. But the total number of copies involved is only a minimal part of our whole distribution. A.A. groups and central offices now get discounts on quantity orders.

Q. When an area has both an A.A. intergroup office and an A.A. answering service, which should have first listing in the local telephone book?

A. Should be solved locally.

Cooperation with the professional community

Q. A local alcoholism organization has requested names, addresses, and telephone numbers of our district committee members. How should this be handled?

A. It was the sense of the meeting that this agency's name and address should be given to the D.C.M.'s to handle as they choose.

Q. By a show of hands, how many areas have a committee on cooperation with the professional community?

A. 24.

Q. Sponsors are being recruited by institutions, courts, doctors, etc. Aren't we responsible only to the newcomer and for carrying the A. A. message?

A. When professionals request sponsorship, every effort is made to provide it to the alcoholic regardless of the source.

Q. How much help can be accepted from Social Actions programs in the Air Force, Army, and Navy?

A. In any situation where an A. A. group is formed under the auspices of an institution which requires conformity to established regulations, members must abide by these regulations and accept what help is offered in the interest of providing the A.A. program for alcoholics. We hope that all groups will conform to Tradition Seven as soon as possible after being organized.

Q. The Guideline originally suggested that A.A.'s employed in the alcoholism field not hold group office. Why was this changed (after so much government money entered the picture), and who authorized the change?

A. It was a 1966 Conference action, reaffirmed in 1974.

General Service Board

Q. In view of the Sixth Tradition, why did the trustees in effect subsidize with A.A. money the publishing of Bill W.'s biography by an outside publisher?

A. Not a cent of A.A. money has gone to the publisher. The trustees' interest was to see that a biographer was selected who would do an accurate job — or at least to lend our resources to help him make the biography accurate and portray A.A. in the proper manner. We also arranged to purchase a number of books at cost in order to make them available to A.A. members at a savings over retail. The author's advance was from the publisher.

General Service Conference

Q. In how many areas does the immediate past delegate rotate (either automatically or by election) to area chairman, rather than area chairman being eligible for nomination as delegate? Where this is done, does the experience gained as delegate prove helpful to the area assembly chairman?

A. Show of hands: 15 do rotate to area chairman, and experience does prove helpful.

Q. What do you do about an officer or appointed coordinator who has been in office too long?

A. Hold an election.

Q. In areas that do not have one central location for annual assemblies, how many maintain a list of locations for rotation purposes (with information on accommodations, etc.)?

A. Show of hands: About 30 do this.

Q. What is G.S.O.'s or Conference opinion on delegate's report? Should it be given to A.A.'s only, or is it considered okay to give reports at open meetings?

A. Some felt it was okay to give it at open meetings as long as only first names and initials were used. Others felt use of full

names would not be considered an anonymity break in this instance. Show of hands indicated the majority felt it was okay to give reports at open meetings.

Q. How do we remove a G.S.R. or committee member if he (or she) is not doing his duty and we see the need to have him replaced?

A. Some opinions: (1) Contact him or her and ask whether he or she wishes to continue; (2) have an alternate; (3) replace a person not doing the job; (4) automatically replace this person if he or she doesn't attend a certain number of meetings.

Q. Please indicate by a show of hands: How many delegates are working in the field of alcoholism as (1) counselors and (2) directors?

A. Counselors, one; directors, four.

General Service Office

Q. Do delegates receive copies of letters from people in their areas about problems of general service, Traditions, etc.? Can they request that G.S.O. notify them or send them copies?

A. We have a policy of not sending letters we receive to anyone. People writing these letters are writing confidentially, and without their permission we would not send the letters out.

Q. Can our archival library give us a list of all the General Service Conference themes over the past 24 years? Is there a list available of all general service trustees and all Conference delegates over the past 24 years, including their tenure in office?

A. Yes, all are available on request.

Q. A.A. spent much time in the past convincing the A.M.A. that alcoholism was a disease. Now it seems things have reversed, and A.A. more and more refers to alcohol as a "drug" and to our "addiction." Is it now proper that we identify ourselves with statements such as "I'm Joe and I'm a drug addict"?

A. We have never made any effort to convince the A.M.A. about medical problems, and, even though alcohol is referred to as a drug, we continue to call ourselves alcoholics.

Q. A.A. World Services is too slow in its mailing services. Could it use U.P.S. or set up small warehouses of materials in various areas?

A. Both options are being considered.

Grapevine

Q. If non-A.A.-authored articles (gray section in the Grapevine) are of interest and educational, have they not already served their purpose in other publications? Some non-A.A. authors in the GV appear to be using it as a springboard for their programs. Do others get this feeling? Should not A.A. publications be confined to A.A. material?

A. This information was put into the Grapevine some years ago in the belief that, as alcoholics, we might be interested in alcoholism. It is printed on gray pages to distinguish it from A.A. material in the magazine. Often, these items are contrary to A.A. philosophy. The 1974 Conference approved that we continue to publish this material. It is purely for information, and endorsement or approval by A.A. or the Grapevine should not be inferred.

Q. Rather than buy single back issues of the Grapevine for \$1.00, is it possible to buy a full year (say 1956) at a lower price?

A. If available, yes. Back issues are priced higher because of the time and cost of processing each order by hand.

Group affairs

Q. How can a military group handle the problem of selecting group officers in a constantly rotating community? New group did not find help in Guidelines on this.

A. They will have to adjust to the particular situation in which they find themselves, and rotate accordingly.

Q. Do any delegates know of any deaf-mute A.A. members? If so, could their names, addresses, etc. be shared with others, perhaps through the Loner secretary? Correspondence might be very valuable to their recoveries.

A. Delegate Byron Barnes (Eastern Missouri) reported one A.A. group of deaf people in St. Louis; Jack Barnes (Northern Interior California), two in his state. According to Fred Forbes (District of Columbia) and Ray Sullivan (Eastern Massachusetts), simultaneous translation is provided for the deaf at some meetings in their areas. Jim McCartin (Western New York) said A.A.'s in his area put on a meeting for teachers of the deaf.

Q. Is it permissible to talk on one of the Steps at an open or closed discussion meeting? Some members object, and say this should be done at a Step meeting only.

A. Consensus was it can be done at any meeting.

Q. What is the feeling of the Conference about films on alcoholism furnished by tax-supported agencies and shown at A.A. meetings?

A. Sense of the meeting was that we should stick to the program. However, this can be decided on a group-autonomy basis, as long as the group does not endorse these films.

Q. Has anyone any experience to share in regard to children 10-15 years old suffering from alcoholism? Do they fit into our meetings?

A. One person said these very young alcoholics in his area were sponsored by young people in A.A. — 18-21-year-olds. Another said they fit into groups and meetings perfectly.

Q. If this is not a religious program, why is the Lord's Prayer recited at the close of A.A. meetings?

A. Early members did it, and we have continued the custom. Not all groups do it. It is up to the group and each individual member to decide what they wish to do.

Literature

Q. Who receives the royalties from book sales? What did this amount to in 1974? In 1973?

A. They used to go to Bill, now go to heirs designated in his will. Amounts are in your financial statements for 1973 and 1974.

Q. More and more members are asking for a book on daily meditations such as "24 Hours a Day." Is it possible for our Fellowship to publish such a book?

A. Past Conferences have disapproved the idea of putting out a book to compete with "the 24-hour book." Our Conference-

approved "As Bill Sees It" is filled with meditative material.

Q. Should we add a chapter to the Big Book explaining new techniques in the treatment of alcoholism, such as counseling, medication, treatment units, halfway houses, and ways to obtain grants for treatment centers?

A. Sense of the meeting: No. However, the *story* section is being updated.

Q. Do you know of any A.A. copyrights being violated? What can be done about it?

A. Yes. We present the matter to the A.A.W.S. directors for consideration. If reprint permission is granted, proper credit must be given.

Q. Should the display of non-A.A. literature be discouraged at all conventions and A.A. meetings?

A. The Literature Committee reemphasized a previous Conference action urging that non-Conference-approved literature be displayed *separately* from Conference-approved literature.

Public information

Q. Have any new statistics developed as a result of the surveys of 1971 and 1974 to replace the generalized estimate that 50% of the alcoholics coming to A.A. remain, 25% go out and drink again, and the other 25% cannot be accounted for?

A. The new survey shows that 62% of them sober up in the first year; of those with five years, 95% will be sober and still going to A.A. meetings.

Advisory Actions

1975 Conference Voices Group Conscience

The group conscience of our Fellowship as a whole in 1975 was expressed largely in the nine following "Advisory (to the board) Actions" which the General Service Board approved in its legally required annual meeting just after the Conference, as shown by this excerpt from the board minutes.

Floor Actions

The following Advisory Actions were approved by the 25th General Service Conference, and the General Service Board approves and concurs that:

1 We drop the term "two-hatter" in our official literature and use instead "A.A. member employed in the field of alcoholism" or the equivalent. [See workshop on "A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field," p. 19.]

2 The following Class B trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board: N.M. "Mac" Cheater, general service trustee, Canada (four years); John Waterfield, Northeast U.S. (four years); Mike Rainbolt, Southeast U.S. (four years).

Q. Is it written in the Traditions that a fee should be charged for a public information dinner?

A. The sense of the meeting was that at a public meeting of any kind a fee should not be charged.

Steps

Q. Please name the "principles" (referred to in Step Twelve) which we strive to practice in all our affairs. Do any of Bill's writings include specific listing of these principles?

A. Step Twelve refers to the principles expressed in all the other Steps.

Traditions

Q. Could we have a Conference opinion on A.A. groups accepting sums of money, or payment of rents by state- or province-funded agencies, and rationalizing same by saying a payment of \$1.00 a year makes it okay within our Traditions and Preamble?

A. This is contrary to our self-support Tradition.

World Service Meeting

Q. Our delegate to the first World Service Meeting was chosen by the Conference delegates. When did this change to having W.S.M. delegates appointed by Dr. Jack, and why?

A. Delegates to this Conference have a two-year term, whereas World Service Meeting delegates have a four-year term. It is important for us to operate under the same plan as the other countries do. This was approved by the 1973 Conference.

3 The request from Alaska to be admitted to the West Canada Region from the Pacific Region be tabled for one year, to permit time for all Alaskan groups to be polled on this.

4 The Eastern and Western Missouri areas be granted permission to change from the West Central Region to the Southwest Region.

5 No further discussion of John O.'s letter concerning St. Luke's Hospital in Phoenix is necessary, and a vote of confidence was unanimously given to Milton Maxwell, Class A trustee.

6 A feasibility study regarding a paperback edition of the Big Book, and alternatives, be made and reported on at the 1976 Conference.

7 The concept presented by Dr. Norris on conferences in which staff and trustees would visit in the regions and work with local service people should be further explored and developed.

8 Delegates be given background information on Class A

and general service (in-town) trustee nominees when they are presented to the Conference prior to election by the General Service Board.

9 A unanimous vote of appreciation be given to Ann MacFarlane for her many years of service, as proposed by the delegates-only meeting.

Conference committee reports approved by the Conference also constitute Conference Actions. Here are summaries of the reports as approved:

Agenda

1 The A. A. meeting at the opening dinner be retained, and the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs be presented for such talks every other year with one delegate speaker. On alternate years, there be delegate speakers with a delegate chairman, and this format be reviewed every year by the Agenda Committee. The committee reviewed the recommendation received from the Committee on Conference Policy and Admissions that the opening-night A. A. meeting should always include the G.S.O. and GV staff members, but the committee prefers the original recommendation.

2 In view of the fact that the 1974 Conference spent many hours discussing the question of special-purpose groups, it is the feeling of the committee that the Conference should concern itself with other matters, and that further discussion of this subject would *not* be productive at the present time. Therefore, it is the unanimous recommendation of this committee that a two-year moratorium (until 1977) be placed on discussion of special-purpose groups.

3 The following suggestions for the 1976 Conference agenda be considered:

a Presentation followed by a workshop on sponsorship of the new member. [See discussion topic "Is Sponsorship Slipping or Only Changing?," p. 19.]

b Public information presentation and workshop, with emphasis on the importance of carrying the message in this way.

c The suggestion from the Conference Institutions Committee that the subject of A. A. in hospitals be discussed at the Conference was accepted, and the committee suggests that the subject can best be discussed in a structured workshop.

d One unstructured workshop be retained for the 1976 Conference.

e A presentation and discussion on A. A. literature.

f The Ask-It Basket be retained in a one- to one-and-a-half-hour session.

g Visit to G.S.O. and Grapevine be continued, unless the time is needed for Conference business.

4 The delegates make every effort to send to G.S.O. no later than October 1 their suggestions for the 1976 Confer-

ence agenda and those of their G.S.R.'s and area committee members for consideration.

5 The same basic format for the Conference agenda be retained.

6 The 1976 Conference theme be built around sponsorship; the following are suggestions for possible themes: (a) Sponsorship – the Language of the Heart; (b) Sharing Through Sponsorship; (c) Sponsorship – the Hand of A. A.; (d) Sponsorship – Sharing Our Way of Life; (e) Growth Through Sponsorship; (f) Sponsorship – Our Primary Purpose; (g) Love for One Another Through Sponsorship; (h) When Anyone, Anywhere . . . [See note 3a, at left.]

The committee elected Fran Adams (Chicago) chairman, and Jim Wright (Alabama/Northwest Florida) alternate chairman.

Bill Davis (Saskatchewan), chairman

Conference Report and Charter

The committee recommended that:

1 "The A. A. Service Manual" be updated to include the following changes on page 30: The glossary of Conference Language be simplified; repetitive terms, such as "area committee member" and "district committee member" be deleted, and the term "district committee member" be used exclusively.

2 The use of full names in the 1975 *Conference Report* be included throughout the report, since the report is *confidential*.

3 In order to familiarize A. A.'s (at group level) with the Twelve Concepts, the trustees' Literature Committee consider publishing the Twelve Concepts in pamphlet form similar to "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated." [See presentation "A. A.'s Twelve Concepts for World Service," p. 15.]

4 All Conference members act as news reporters by sharing anecdotal material during Conference week with the committee. This material could then be included in the *Conference Report* under a section called "Coffee Break." The material could be humorous, sentimental, or informational anecdotes about our week together.

5 The committee review and return completed draft of *Conference Report* one week after its receipt.

6 A suggestion be made to all A. A. groups to purchase the 1975 *Conference Report*.

7 Study and consideration be given to adding the Rights of Appeal and Petition to the Conference Charter, according to Bill's wishes, so that action may be taken on this at a future Conference.

The committee elected Joan A. Barclay (Nevada) chairman, and Francis A. Green (Eastern Pennsylvania) alternate chairman.

Margi Blake (San Diego, California), chairman

Cooperation with the Professional Community

The committee recommended that:

- 1 The film "Bill's Own Story" may be shown at A.A. orientation sessions in rehab facilities provided it is under the control of an A.A. member.
- 2 Although most A.A.'s understand the difference among Twelfth Step work, sponsorship, and referral to A.A., there is still a big need of sponsorship in some areas. [See discussion topic "Is Sponsorship Slipping or Only Changing?," p. 19.]
- 3 Attitudes and not titles are the problem with the "two-hatter." If changing the title could change attitudes, a change could be considered. [See workshop on "A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field," p. 19.]
- 4 We continue to cooperate with the professionals, because doing so helps us to fulfill our primary purpose of carrying the message of A.A. to the alcoholic. As Bill suggested, "Let's be friendly with our friends." [See note on 2, above.]
- 5 More sharing of the results of cooperation between the professionals and A.A.'s might improve understanding of professional efforts in the field of alcoholism.
- 6 More time be spent on the study of the Traditions by all A.A. members, including those working as professionals in the field. The Traditions enable us to better our relations with the professional community and with each other. [See presentation "Understanding and Living the A.A. Traditions," p. 8.]

The committee elected Jim Shaw (Southern California) chairman, and Natalie Schwanke (Washington), alternate chairman.

Pete Slager (Western Michigan), chairman

Finance

The committee recommended that:

- 1 Delegates, in reports to their areas, place more emphasis on broadening the base of group support, because the committee felt that the dependence on literature income could become detrimental to the Fellowship structure.
- 2 The *60-30-10 suggested group contribution formula be used where applicable and practicable, as well as the \$3.65 per year, per member plan. And the 60-30-10 plan should be encouraged by G.S.O. and all delegates. [*60% to the intergroup (central office); 30% to G.S.O.; 10% to the area committee.]
- 3 The recommended \$10 maximum on birthday contributions be eliminated from the birthday envelope.
- 4 Delegates emphasize to the groups the effect that inflation has had on the contribution dollar and the necessity for adjusting contributions accordingly.
- 5 A set of the quarterly contribution statements be mailed to all delegates for their areas on a twice-yearly basis, rather than

on a once-a-year basis, as is now the practice. These statements are to cover the six-month period ending June 30 and the 12-month period ending December 31.

- 6 Contributions continue to be listed in the A.A. directories, and the contributions from the previous calendar year be used.
- 7 Any recommended changes concerning the policy of charging handling costs only on literature orders not accompanied by cash be tabled until the 1976 Conference.
- 8 Upon reviewing the G.S.O. salary structure, it was the sense of the meeting that the structure is sound. This information is available to delegates upon request.

The committee elected George Dorsey (Northern Coastal California) chairman, and Ray Sullivan (Eastern Massachusetts) alternate chairman.

Carlton Mendell (Maine), chairman

[See presentation "Group Support for Group Services," p. 11.]

Grapevine

The committee recommended that:

- 1 Delegates communicate with the publishers of A.A. newsletters in their areas and urge them to use Grapevine blurbs, discussion topics, or other notices on the Grapevine regularly in their newsletters.
- 2 A letter be sent to the remaining pay-as-you-go groups explaining the advantages of prepaid subscriptions and notifying these groups that the pay-as-you-go plan will be terminated as of January 1, 1976.
- 3 All delegates make all A.A. members aware that they can subscribe to the Grapevine as individuals.

The committee elected Don Burow (Colorado) chairman, and Retha Gresham (Central/Southeastern Ohio) alternate chairman.

Louis Geoffrion (Southwest Quebec), chairman

[See Grapevine presentation, p. 12.]

Institutions

The committee recommended that:

- 1 The 1975 trustees' Institutions Committee report be approved. The Conference committee would like to express their gratitude to the trustees' committee for the fine job they are doing.
- 2 We endeavor to improve communication between intergroup (central office) and general service institutions committees by emphasizing the concept that general service committees exist to provide service wherever needed, including service to intergroup or central office institutions committees. One

person from each institutions committee be charged with the responsibility of acting as liaison to the other, and communication may be further improved by: (a) exchanging minutes of meetings between the two committees, and (b) instituting joint workshops and sharing sessions at area assemblies.

3 In an effort to place greater emphasis on the importance of hospitals as a part of over-all institutions committee work, delegates, upon return to their areas, will furnish the G.S.O. secretary of the Institutions Committee with the names and addresses of A.A. members who are currently interested in hospital work. The secretary could then keep these people fully informed of institutional activity, thereby creating greater interest and more activity in the hospital field.

4 The following changes be made in the Guidelines on Institutional Committees: (a) Page 4 heading be changed to read, "Relationship to A.A. in the Area or District"; (b) number 1 under this same heading to read: "Group representative at intergroup/central office or area meetings."

5 "The Suggested Duties of the G.I.R." be published in the *Institutions Bulletin*.

The committee elected Ike Bowers (Utah) chairman and Ann Nuckols (Virginia) alternate chairman.

Joe Mulloy (Tennessee), chairman

International Convention

The committee met with the trustees' Convention Committee and accepted the trustees' committee report as read by Don Austin, chairman.

There are about 12,000 registrations as of April 24. Registration deadline is May 15.

There will be two big meetings (Friday night and Sunday morning); the Big Show on Saturday night; 34 alkathon A.A. meetings; 12 workshops; 12 panel meetings. Two guest speakers, one A.A. speaker, and a trustee/director chairman will make up the panels.

The Conference committee chairman reported the luncheon for past and present delegates and trustees will be Saturday, July 5, in the Holiday Inn Downtown. The price is \$6.50 per person, and a letter went to all concerned on April 16, 1975.

Don Burow, delegate from Colorado, gave the report of the Convention Host Committee and expressed the enthusiasm of the members.

The committee discussed the questionnaire on evaluation of the Convention, which will be given to all registrants with their badges. Some items on the questionnaire include ratings of meetings, food, housing, and transportation.

The committee discussed the method of opening and closing workshops, panel meetings, and alkathon A.A. meetings. It was decided that these meetings will open with the Serenity Prayer and close with the Lord's Prayer.

Jack Barnes (Northern Interior California), chairman

Literature

The committee recommended that:

1 The trustees' Literature Committee report be accepted.

2 The original "Is A.A. for You?" pamphlet be dropped and the simplified version be used.

3 "The Alcoholic Husband" and "The Alcoholic Wife" be combined into one pamphlet called "The Alcoholic Mate," or another appropriate title.

4 The reprints "Why Alcoholics Anonymous Is Anonymous," "Our Critics Can Be Our Benefactors," and "A.A. as a Community Resource" be dropped.

5 "The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous" pamphlet be dropped.

6 A paragraph dealing with the problems of the use of mood-changing pills by A.A. members who hold group office should *not* be added to an appropriate A.A. pamphlet, because it was felt that this decision is up to local autonomy.

7 An illustrated pamphlet like "What Happened to Joe?" and "It Happened to Alice" directed to teen-age and pre-teen-age alcoholics be prepared.

8 Two teen-age stories be added to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A."

9 Previous Conference action recommending that non-Conference-approved literature and Conference-approved literature be displayed *separately* be reaffirmed.

10 The committee commended George Gordon for the tremendous job he has done as chairman of the trustees' Literature Committee.

11 The committee also thanked Beth Kuhlmann, secretary, for her help throughout the past two years.

The committee elected W. J. Syms (Northeastern Ontario) chairman, and Olga Morris (Southeastern Texas) alternate.

[The Conference did *not* approve a recommendation that a study guide for the Twelve Steps be prepared.]

Chuck Sherer (Northwest Ohio/Southeast Michigan), chairman

[See discussion topic "A.A. Literature," p. 20.]

Policy and Admissions

The committee recommended that:

1 The revised Composition, Scope, Procedure, and History be accepted as mailed.

2 Each delegate receive only the agenda pertinent to his or her committee, but may receive any others on request.

3 *Ex-officio* members not be restored.

4 A committee on Traditions not be established, but it be further recommended that individual delegates assume the responsibility to familiarize their area groups and members with the Traditions. [See presentation "Understanding and Living the A.A. Traditions," p. 8.]

5 Regional meetings of delegates and past delegates and trustees be encouraged on the basis of fellowship, but further recommended that no actions be taken at these meetings.

6 Timing on the 1975 Conference agenda mailing be retained for the 1976 Conference.

8 It is the responsibility of the area committee to see that the contribution of \$200 toward Conference expenses be paid by March 1, and if this is not received by March 1, a letter be sent to the delegate reminding him of this omission.

We also reviewed the 1975 Conference questionnaire and made specific suggestions to the trustees' Conference Committee.

The committee elected Byron Barnes (Eastern Missouri) chairman, and Duane Harder (Central Michigan) alternate chairman. [After election as area delegates' chairman, Byron resigned as chairman. Duane will serve as chairman, and Sam Smith (Southern Florida), who received the next-highest number of votes, will serve as alternate.]

[Note: It was the opinion of the trustees, when reviewing Conference Advisory Actions, that there was great positive value in having delegates participate in the same workshop sections throughout the Conference, and it was their recommendation that this practice be continued for at least another year. They agreed consideration might be given to rotating staff and trustee participants.]

Bob Tetrault (Western Massachusetts), chairman

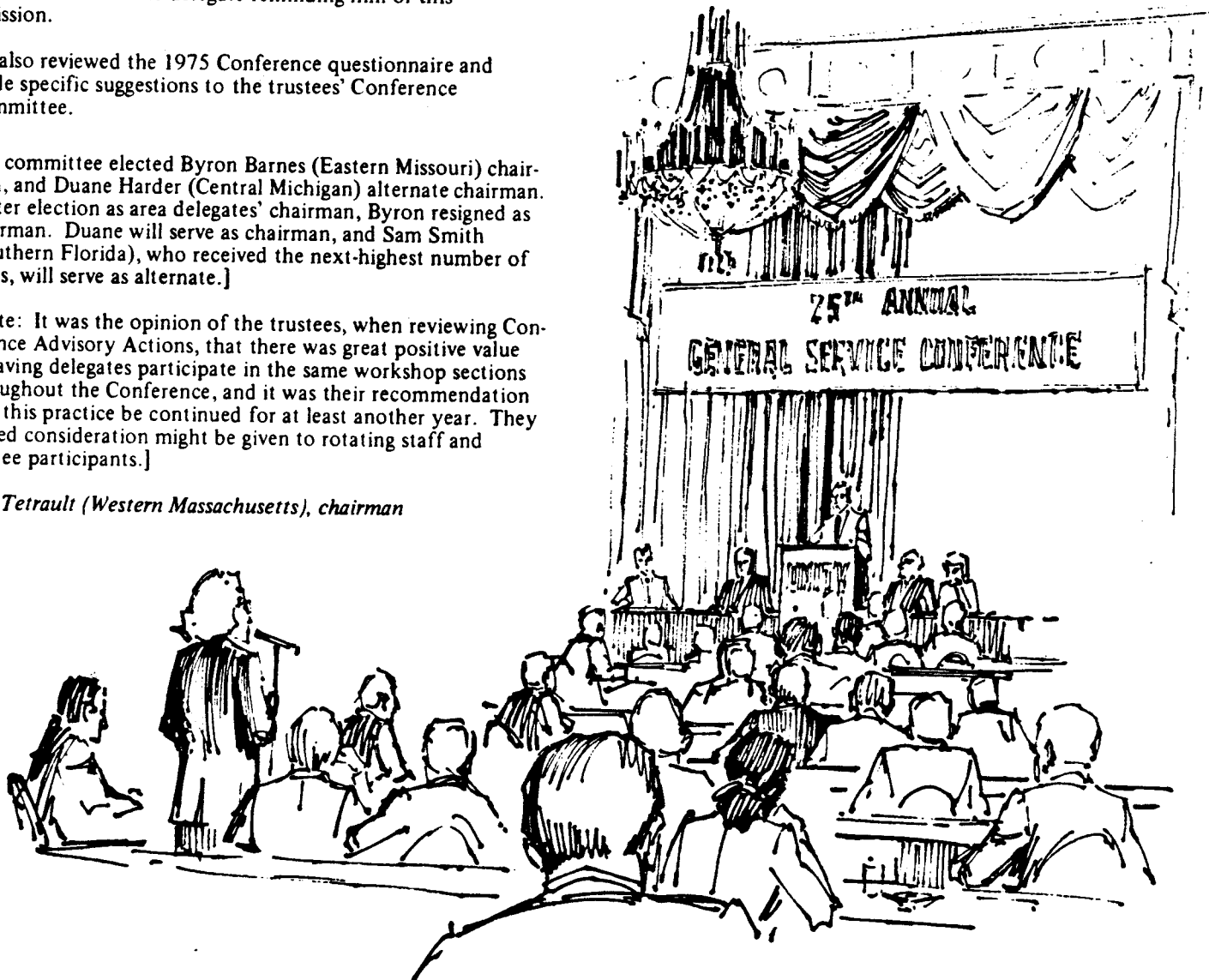
Public Information

The committee recommended that:

1 The committee accept the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee, made by Walter Murphy.

2 We revise the present P.I. Guidelines, so they will provide specific suggestions for P.I. speakers, and also information to assist delegates in setting up P.I. committees at the area level where there is a need and a desire for this assistance.

3 The P.I. Committee continue to review annually the P.I.



Kit, in an effort to delete duplicate material and make the kit more effective and more manageable.

The committee agreed that:

1 Receiving copies of the annual anonymity letter made it possible for delegates to inform more local newspapers about our tradition of anonymity. Panel 25 delegates receive copies of the annual anonymity letter at the close of the Conference, and we continue to send it to all delegates annually.

2 The press release on the 1974 membership survey results was well received in local areas where used.

The committee elected Warren Russell (Connecticut) chairman, and Abe Wiebe (British Columbia/Yukon) alternate chairman.

Don Dusha (Vermont), chairman

Committee on Trustees

The committee recommended that:

1 The report of the trustees' Nominating Committee to the Conference be accepted as presented.

2 The following addition be made to Class B trustee résumé forms in order that more specific information may be obtained in connection with employment in the field of alcoholism: "Employment in the Field of Alcoholism . . . Now working in field of alcoholism? How long? Salaried or volunteer? With whom? Title?"

3 The following procedure be adopted for reducing the number of candidates presented to the Conference in the election of general service trustees, U.S./Canada:

a Each Conference area may elect one candidate, or two or more areas may jointly propose a single candidate via Third Legacy procedure.

b Résumés of all candidates will be reviewed for eligibility by the trustees' Nominating Committee.

c Delegates from each region will caucus prior to the election to reduce the number of candidates, using Third Legacy procedure, to one each in the U.S. and two each in the Canadian regions. A maximum of six candidates for general service trustee, U.S., and a maximum of four candidates for general service trustee, Canada, will be presented to the voting members of the Conference for election.

d Voting members of the Conference will be all delegates from the electing country (U.S. or Canada) and all members of the trustees' Nominating Committee.

The physical arrangements for the caucus of delegates from each region, as required in paragraph "c" above, should be made during the Conference, prior to the election, possibly in the form of regional luncheons.

4 Gordon Patrick be elected as a Class A trustee at the annual meeting of the General Service Board.

5 Charles H. Hanson be elected as a Class B trustee at the annual meeting of the General Service Board.

6 The following slate of officers and trustees to the General Service Board be accepted for the period beginning April, 1975: [See the report of the trustees' Nominating Committee – p. 34 – items 2 and 3; and Advisory Action #2, p. 41.]

7 The procedure to be used when a Conference area requests a change of region be reviewed by the 1976 Conference Committee on Trustees, in order to clarify the voting rights of an area moving into or out of an electing region.

The committee elected F. P. Ryan (Western Missouri) chairman, and Bob Bacon (Northeast Ohio) alternate chairman.

Noel Le Clair (Southern New Jersey), chairman

Delegates-Only Meeting

The delegates-only meeting opened with the Serenity Prayer. The chairman then opened the meeting for discussion.

1 Mick McFarland recommended that no items be brought up that were already on the agenda.

2 The sense of the meeting was that the scheduling of the Conference was sufficient.

3 Delegates felt that they had enough participation.

4 It was suggested that delegates should have name tags in advance, so those who arrive early for next year's Conference may identify each other as early arrivers.

5 A vote of confidence and appreciation from Panel 24 and Panel 25 was given to Ann Macfarlane for her many years of service at G.S.O.

6 Jack Barnes agreed to share a brochure named "Building a Service Structure" with those delegates who want it.

7 One delegate asked that when outside agencies get permission from G.S.O. on use of A. A. phraseology, the delegate involved should be notified.

8 Since items for the agenda must be established by a certain date, it was suggested that any changes in the agenda should be voiced at the beginning of the Conference and approval sought for any such changes.

9 The delegates-only meeting recommended that any matter brought before the Conference that requires a vote, either by a sense of the meeting or other voting procedure, shall be given the right of discussion before the vote is taken.

Byron Barnes (Eastern Missouri) was elected delegate chairman, and Harry Lake (Hawaii) alternate delegate chairman.

Mick McFarland (Kentucky), chairman

INCOME STATEMENT

Financial statements

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1974

INCOME			
	1974	1973	
Net sales, after book discounts waived of \$102,141 in 1974 and \$80,561 in 1973	\$1,244,684	\$1,152,873	
Less: Cost of printing	368,168	324,182	
Royalties	148,348	116,997	
Gross Profit from Literature	728,168	711,694	
Contributions – A.A. groups and members	749,804	645,903	
Interest income	8,044	10,526	
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>1,486,016</u>	<u>1,368,123</u>	
EXPENSES			
Salaries	709,620	608,775	
Rent	82,094	66,214	
Office construction costs	10,108	82,468	
Box 4-5-9	38,186	29,544	
Directories – prepublication expenses (1974)	4,755	44,664	
Other General Service Office Printing	31,852	28,089	
Shipping and mailing	150,044	124,028	
Other office expenses	119,328	128,843	
Insurance and taxes	64,930	51,087	
Professional services	24,580	20,000	
Board, committee, staff meetings	24,194	22,129	
1974 World Service Meeting	17,106	–	
Writing, research	9,188	3,911	
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	18,879	22,463	
General Service Conference	50,299	46,394	
Archives – office expense	4,741	–	
Film, filmstrip, display boards	472	1,667	
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>1,360,376</u>	<u>1,280,276</u>	
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>125,640</u>	<u>87,847</u>	
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION			
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 260,584	\$ 321,841	
General Fund – General Service Board	(134,944)	(233,994)	
CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1974			
	<u>Reserve</u>	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Convention Guaranty</u>
Balance, January 1, 1974	\$309,174	\$ 59,603	\$ 14,884
Book discounts		102,142	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500	
Investment income	22,147	4,232	907
Less: Current funding costs		(58,483)	
Actuary fee		(4,420)	
Balance, December 31, 1974	<u>331,321</u>	<u>106,574</u>	<u>15,791</u>

() denotes red figures.

Amounts in these financial statements under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 – by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts – for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1974

	1974	1973
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$ 333,821</u>	<u>\$ 310,608</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	\$ 47,380	\$ 44,679
Printing	81,721	71,407
Mailing – Service	28,492	31,474
– Postage	10,807	4,534
Other printing costs	4,781	5,341
Calendar costs	13,506	12,845
Best Cartoons	751	1,089
Rent	8,958	7,940
Telephone	1,337	1,235
Office supplies and expenses	2,063	2,579
Other editorial expenses	3,783	3,503
Office cleaning	1,772	1,350
<u>Total</u>	205,351	187,976
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	54,413	58,222
Data processing costs	17,520	7,662
Stationery and supplies	2,610	2,513
Rent	8,958	7,940
Telephone	1,340	1,235
Other office expense	1,781	1,349
Selling expense	13,541	11,947
Postage	9,059	7,873
Office cleaning	1,772	1,349
Bad debts	1,198	1,842
<u>Total</u>	112,192	101,932
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	2,958	3,388
Legal and accounting	3,741	4,300
Taxes	5,676	5,143
Meetings and conferences	1,061	970
Furniture and equipment	45	1,525
Contribution to Retirement Plan	3,500	3,500
Office relocation	–	2,666
<u>Total</u>	16,981	21,492
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>334,524</u>	<u>311,400</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(703)	(792)
Add: Interest earned	<u>12,819</u>	<u>10,267</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (EXHIBIT C)	<u>12,116</u>	<u>9,475</u>

(continued)

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

The CONVENTION OPERATING FUND was established in 1974 to record the fiscal operations of the 1975 International Convention. Any resulting surplus will be transferred to the GENERAL FUND.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY FUND was established in 1972 by subscriptions from A.A. members in Colorado, and by a transfer from the General Fund for the purpose of making up a deficit, if any, incurred in connection with the Convention to be held in Denver in 1975. To the extent not so used it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

Financial statements

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1974

	December 31, 1974		December 31, 1973	
OPERATING FUNDS	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$ 202,308	\$ 105,850	\$ 89,538	\$ 92,412
Savings accounts and certificates	15,463	47,771	162,421	20,386
Marketable securities	-	145,291	-	125,169
Accounts receivable	85,320	6,915	123,963	8,392
Due from Convention Operating Fund	22,275	-	-	-
Due from Grapevine	5,000	-	8,000	-
Inventories	458,400	5,140	300,318	8,265
Prepaid expenses	22,413	9,526	24,563	7,585
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>811,179</u>	<u>320,493</u>	<u>708,803</u>	<u>262,569</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	121,726	15,398	150,353	19,034
Due Pension Fund	6,988	-	6,625	-
Prepaid subscriptions, unearned income	-	225,357	-	170,913
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	-	7,000	-	7,000
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>128,714</u>	<u>247,755</u>	<u>156,978</u>	<u>196,947</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	551,825	65,622	416,223	64,147
Net income for year (Exhibits A and B)	125,640	12,116	87,847	9,475
Contribution received (paid)	5,000	(5,000)	8,000	(8,000)
Transfer from Memorial Fund	-	-	39,755	-
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>682,465</u>	<u>72,738</u>	<u>551,825</u>	<u>65,622</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$ 661,964		\$ 501,380	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Note A)	20,501		50,445	
<u>Total Operating Funds - as above</u>	<u>682,465</u>		<u>551,825</u>	
Reserve Fund	331,321		309,174	
Deferred Pension Fund	106,574		59,603	
Convention Guaranty Fund	15,791		14,884	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,136,151</u>		<u>935,486</u>	
RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION AND CONVENTION FUNDS				
	Reserve	Pension	Convention Funds	
			Guaranty	Operating
Cash	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 42,228
Savings accounts and certificates	12,737	99,587	15,584	-
Due from A.A.W.S.	-	6,987	-	-
Preliminary Convention expenses	-	-	-	22,287
U.S. Treasury obligations	200,010	-	-	-
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	109,320	-	-	-
Accrued interest	9,254	-	207	-
Due to General Fund	-	-	-	(22,275)
Advance receipts	-	-	-	(42,240)
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>331,321</u>	<u>106,574</u>	<u>15,791</u>	<u>-0-</u>

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

The GENERAL FUND, which comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed. In 1973 the Conference approved the consolidation of the MEMORIAL FUND - which was established in 1971 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members in memory of Bill W. - with the GENERAL FUND.

NOTE A - After transfers of \$100,000 in 1974 and \$150,000 in 1973 from Publishing to General Fund.

These financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountants.

1975 G.S.O. Budget

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$1,485,300*
Less: Cost of Products	627,300
Gross Profit from Sales	858,000

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	522,600
	335,400

*Based upon the sale of:

140,000 Books — "Alcoholics Anonymous"

68,000 Books — "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
(Reg.)

22,600 Books — "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
(Pocket)

15,500 Books — "A.A. Comes of Age"

20,500 Books — "As Bill Sees It"
and

Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

*Sales Income budgeted to include price increases
effective 5/1/75

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$ 787,600
---------------	------------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	989,600**
	(202,000)

**Includes cost of General Service Conference — \$50,600

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 8,000
----------	----------

TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of Income (Expense)	74,500***
	(66,500)

***Board Meetings, P.I.C. Expense, C.P.C. Expense, Legal and
Auditing Fees, and Special Projects

The Publishing activity will contribute \$268,500 to offset the
budgeted deficits.

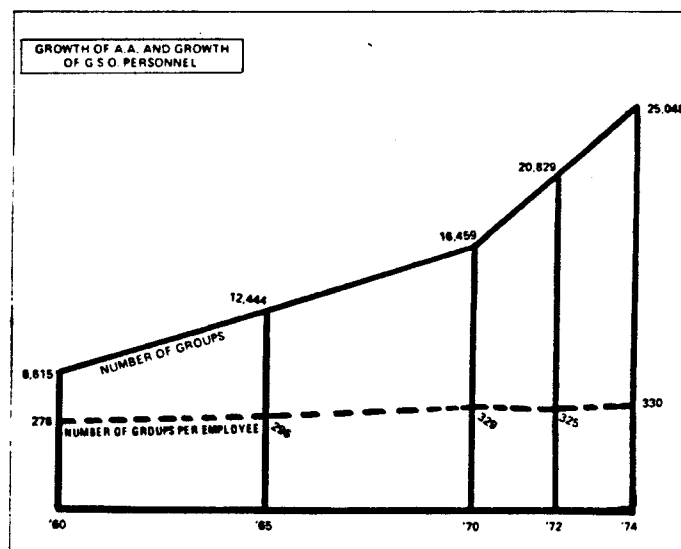
1975 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales.....	400,000
Estimated Expense.....	397,500
Net income from operations	2,500
Interest from investments	14,100
Net Income.....	16,600

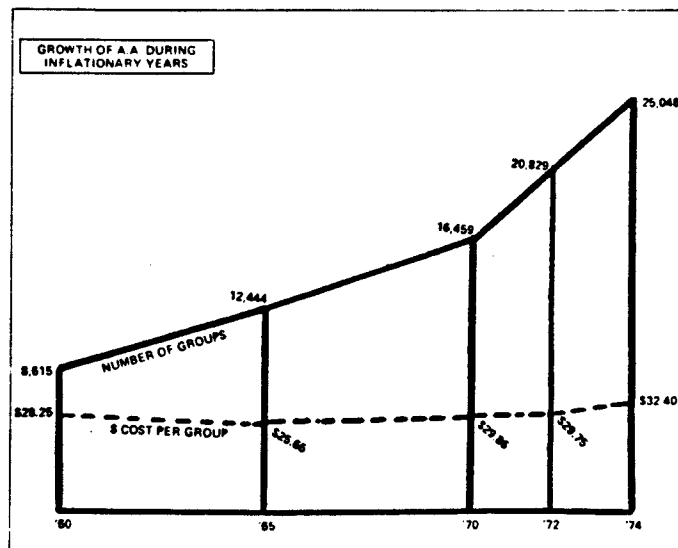
How efficient has G.S.O.'s growth been? In terms of personnel — in 1960, there was one employee for 278 groups. Today, one employee serves 330 groups.

During the past 14 years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$243,400 to \$834,200 for group services. During that same period, cost of living increased 80%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$28.25 to \$18.65.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1960	8,615	31	278	\$28.25	100
1965	12,444	42	296	25.65	107
1970	16,459	50	329	29.86	135
1972	20,829	64	325	29.75	151
1974	25,048	76	330	32.40	180



1. (Above) There are almost three times as many groups today as in 1960. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 330 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 278 in 1960.



2. (Above) During the years 1960 through 1974, even though the cost of living increased 80%, constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$32.40 in 1974, compared with \$28.25 in 1960 — an increase of only 15%.

1974 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita	CANADA	# Gps. re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita
Alabama	119	67	56.3%	17	25.3%	\$ 3,770.36	1,756	\$ 2.14	Alberta	195	107	54.8%	27	25.2%	\$ 6,025.17	2,314	\$ 2.60
Alaska	44	24	54.5	12	50.0	2,051.40	732	2.80	Atlantic Provinces								
Arizona	209	128	61.4	40	31.2	9,078.17	3,123	2.90	New Brunswick	66	35	53.0	9	25.7	1,703.30	816	2.09
Arkansas	101	62	61.3	24	38.7	3,797.68	1,275	2.97	Newfoundland	31	7	22.5	1	14.3	466.07	235	1.98
California	2,033	1,139	56.0	526	46.2	76,826.99	56,518	1.35	Nova Scotia	90	54	60.0	10	18.5	3,102.22	1,045	2.97
Colorado	200	132	66.0	52	39.4	11,072.03	3,417	3.24	Prince Ed. Island	28	15	53.6	1	6.7	868.18	410	2.12
Connecticut	404	208	51.4	73	35.1	15,549.01	7,641	2.03	British Columbia	324	186	57.4	56	30.1	15,558.38	4,248	3.66
Delaware	60	39	65.0	15	38.5	2,611.65	830	3.14	Manitoba	97	52	53.6	11	21.2	5,457.91	2,099	2.60
Dist. of Columbia	92	57	61.9	35	61.4	6,334.40	2,482	2.55	N.W. Territories	9	4	44.4	-0-	0.0	100.00	50	2.00
Florida	540	353	65.3	173	49.0	38,052.22	9,890	3.84	Ontario	689	395	57.3	163	41.3	51,575.04	9,807	5.25
Georgia	243	158	65.0	67	42.4	9,896.41	4,083	2.42	Quebec	736	425	57.7	189	44.5	17,627.01	19,756	0.89
Hawaii	60	53	88.3	24	45.3	5,536.84	1,078	5.14	Saskatchewan	160	96	60.0	21	21.9	8,393.09	2,114	3.97
Idaho	50	29	58.0	7	24.1	1,549.23	756	2.05	Yukon Terr.	2	1	50.0	-0-	0.0	80.80	28	2.88
Illinois	1,117	402	35.9	144	35.8	24,094.71	19,002	1.27	TOTAL for CANADA	2,427	1,377	56.7%	488	35.4%	\$110,957.17	42,922	\$ 2.59
Indiana	301	175	58.1	80	45.7	12,477.85	5,302	2.35	TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	16,875	9,602	56.9%	4,028	42.0%	\$740,774.16	330,785	\$ 2.24
Iowa	167	105	62.8	32	30.5	8,578.33	2,917	2.94	FOREIGN & OTHER								
Kansas	157	110	70.0	42	38.2	7,666.16	3,061	2.50	Foreign						3,541.06		
Kentucky	178	111	62.3	53	47.7	13,060.11	2,393	5.46	World Hello						92.00		
Louisiana	155	76	49.0	24	31.6	3,696.92	2,703	1.37	International Doctors						325.00		
Maine	84	56	66.6	15	26.8	2,673.35	1,063	2.51	Hospital Groups						4,247.91		
Maryland	347	195	56.2	87	44.6	12,336.76	4,561	2.70	Prison Groups						220.57		
Massachusetts	475	228	48.0	98	43.0	16,949.29	10,740	1.58	Internationalists						336.25		
Michigan	587	335	57.0	153	45.7	24,959.42	16,112	1.55	GRAND TOTAL						\$749,536.95		
Minnesota	422	249	59.0	104	41.8	2,624.89	1,359	1.93									
Mississippi	75	43	57.3	12	27.9	10,256.95	4,352	2.36									
Missouri	287	164	57.1	58	35.4	3,764.49	1,017	3.70									
Montana	101	50	49.5	19	38.0	6,824.57	2,007	3.40									
Nebraska	149	91	61.0	35	38.5	2,456.30	1,554	1.58									
Nevada	73	42	57.5	24	57.1	3,408.25	1,934	1.76									
New Hampshire	93	48	51.6	14	29.2	24,057.62	8,073	2.98									
New Jersey	474	291	61.3	150	51.6	3,583.45	1,389	2.58									
New Mexico	84	53	63.1	21	39.6	47,952.81	18,431	2.60									
New York	958	548	57.2	275	50.2	12,628.62	3,955	3.19									
North Carolina	227	178	78.4	63	35.4	2,490.09	997	2.49									
North Dakota	85	56	65.8	11	19.6	22,234.33	12,929	1.71									
Ohio	667	335	50.2	109	32.5	9,536.49	2,454	3.88									
Oklahoma	164	130	79.2	90	69.2	4,795.87	1,755	2.73									
Oregon	155	92	59.3	42	45.7	28,031.85	9,115	3.07									
Pennsylvania	511	335	65.5	148	44.2	3,715.55	1,288	2.88									
Rhode Island	61	35	57.3	18	51.4	4,090.12	1,500	2.72									
South Carolina	97	64	65.9	28	43.8	2,273.00	1,830	1.24									
South Dakota	70	37	52.8	5	13.5	5,109.03	2,388	2.13									
Tennessee	148	80	54.0	24	30.0	25,704.09	15,782	1.62									
Texas	548	287	52.3	128	44.6	1,682.86	1,421	1.18									
Utah	77	40	51.9	17	42.5	2,598.80	944	2.75									
Vermont	51	36	70.5	11	30.6	15,681.55	3,592	4.36									
Virginia	258	189	73.2	87	46.0	17,364.01	4,746	3.65									
Washington	320	206	64.3	131	63.6	4,517.10	1,715	2.63									
West Virginia	87	47	54.0	29	61.7	12,009.95	5,969	2.01									
Wisconsin	375	204	54.4	76	37.3	647.05	406	1.59									
Wyoming	35	14	40.0	4	28.6	1,979.77	1,035	1.91									
Commonwealth of P.R.	61	34	55.7	12	35.3	463.00	66	7.02									
Canal Zone	1	1	100.0	1	100.0	325.75	78	4.17									
Bahama Islands	7	2	28.5	-0-	0.0	180.00	20	9.00									
Virgin Islands of U.S.	4	2	50.0	1	50.0	\$629,816.99	287,863	\$ 2.19									
Total for U.S.	14,448	8,225	56.9%	3,540	43.0%	\$225,911	225,911	2.46									

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1974 — 1973

	# Gps. re-ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member-ship	Contrib. per Capita
U.S. 1974	14,448	8,225	56.9%	3,540	43.0%	\$629,816.99	287,863	\$ 2.19
U.S. 1973	12,869	7,686	59.7	3,108	40.4	555,567.73	225,911	2.46
Increase (Decrease)	1,579	539	(2.8%)	432	2.6%	74,249.26	61,952	(0.27)
Canada 1974	2,427	1,377	56.7%	488	35.4%	\$110,957.17	42,922	\$ 2.59
Canada 1973	2,122	1,233	58.1	386	31.3	80,398.52	35,091	2.29
Increase (Decrease)	305	144	(1.4%)	102	4.1%	\$ 30,558.65	7,831	\$ 0.30
U.S. & Canada 1974	16,875	9,602	56.9%	4,028	42.0%	\$740,774.16	330,785	\$ 2.24
U.S. & Canada 1973	14,991	8,919	59.4	3,494	39.2	635,966.25	261,002	2.44
Increase (Decrease)	1,884	683	(2.5%)	534	2.8%	\$104,807.91	69,783	\$(0.20)

Conference Agenda

- ** Bill Davis, Sask.
Tony Fowler, S.W. Tex.
Dorothy Gadoury, R.I.
- *** Nancy Rushing, Miss.
Don Wenning, S. Ind.

Fran Adams, Chicago
Earl Homuth, E. Ont.
Clark McCall, Okla.
Jim Wright, Ala./N.W. Fla.

Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

Conference Report & Charter

- ** Margi Blake, Calif. (San Diego)
Wayne Bramble, Mont.
- *** Bob Fowler, Ga.
- * George McKerral, N.W. Que.

Joan Barclay, Nev.
Frank Green, E. Pa.
Dede Hoffman, La.
John Neal, S. Ill.
Marvin Spooner, S. Minn.

Secretary: Susan Coyle

Finance

- Gordon Hagen, N. Minn.
Richard McFarland, Ky.
- ** Carlton Mendell, Me.
Paul Slatky, N. Wis./Upper Mich.

George Dorsey, N. Calif.
Raymond Houle, S.E. Que.
Gus Jowers, Ark.
Larry Sebastian, W. Va.
Ray Sullivan, E. Mass.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

- Neal Boeshart, Nebr.
- *** Pete Charland, N.H.
- ** Louis Geoffrion, S.W. Que.
Eddie MacInnes, N.B./P.E.I.
Howard Smith, Oreg.

Don Burow, Colo.
Fred Forbes, D.C.
Retha Gresham, S.E. Ohio
Bernard Scarseth, S. Wis.
H. A. Weston, Iowa

Secretary: Paula Carpenter

Institutions

- *** Fred Blair, N. Dak.
Roy Homer, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
Reeta Hourie, Man.
- ** Joe Mulloy, Tenn.

Ike Bowers, Utah
John Henderson, N.E. Tex.
Charles McCarthy, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
Ann Nuckols, Va.
Jim Riley, N. N.J.

Secretary: June Russell

Literature

- Clayton Hocker, Del.
Gene Leher, Mid-S. Calif.
Bill Leicht, Alta.
- *** Jim McCartin, W. N.Y.
- ** Chuck Sherer, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.

Ellis Bedford, W. Pa.
Joe Holman, N. Ind.
Olga Morris, S.E. Tex.
W. J. Syms, N.E. Ont.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann

Conference Policy/Admissions

- Peggy Busch, S.C.
Hank Skees, N. Ill.
- *** Wesley Smith, Ariz.
- ** Bob Tetrault, W. Mass.

Byron Barnes, E. Mo.
Jack Davis, N.W. Ont.
Duane Harder, Cent. Mich.
Jim Hunter, Cent. N.Y.
Sam Smith, S. Fla.

Secretary: Ann Macfarlane

Public Information

- Jack Barnes, Calif. (N. Interior)
Donald Browns, Idaho
- ** Don Dusha, Vt.
Brian Gilmore, N.W. Tex.
Duncan McArthur, W. Ont.

Walter Fetterer, S.E. N.Y.
Andy Quaid, S.E. Mich.
Warren Russell, Conn.
Abe Wiebe, B.C./Yukon

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Trinidad Rivera Chevere, P.R.
- *** Jo Hajdu, Alsk.
- Lorraine Schall, N.M.
- Tom Shoemaker, Md.
- ** Pete Slager, W. Mich.

Edith Campbell, N.C.
Buck Raulerson, N. Fla.
Natalie Schwanke, Wash.
Jim Shaw, S. Calif.

Secretary: Mary Ellen Uribe

Committee on Trustees

- Tiny Donaldson, N.Y. (H./M./B.)
- *** Clyde Jones, Kans.
- * "Turk" Lassiter, Wyo.
- ** Noel LeClair, S. N.J.
- Horton Stoakes, S. Dak.

Bob Bacon, N.E. Ohio
Harry Lake, Haw.
Benoit Perron, N.E. Que.
Frank Ryan, W. Mo.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Committee on the 1975 International Convention

- ** Jack Barnes, Calif. (N. Interior)
Pete Charland, N.H.
Bob Fowler, Ga.
Reeta Hourie, Man.
Hank Skees, N. Ill.

Ellis Bedford, W. Pa.
Charles McCarthy, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
Clark McCall, Okla.
Frank Ryan, W. Mo.

Secretary: Waneta New

1975 Final Conference Report

Editor: Barry Leach
Production: Janet Graves
Drawings: Al Herr

- * Alternate Delegate
- ** Chairman
- *** Alternate Chairman

1975 Trustees' Committees

Archives

George Gordon, Ph.D., *chairman*
Lee Belford, Ph.D.
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Nell Wing, *archivist/librarian*
Midge McFadden, *secretary*

Conference

Margaret Carlson, *chairman*
Christian Anderson
David Cooke
James G. Griffin
Peter A. C. Watters
Cora Louise Belford, *secretary*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Robert Macpherson, *chairman*
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.,
co-chairman
Andrew W. Abrahams, M.D.
Donald G. Austin
John D. Bealer, M.D.
Thomas P. Carpenter
David Cooke
Barry Leach
Peter A. C. Watters
Ross Von Wiegand
Mary Ellen Uribe, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Arthur J. Miles, *chairman*
George Gordon, Ph.D.
Robert Macpherson
Walter Murphy
Stephen Owen Sr.
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.
Robert E. Hitchins, *secretary*

Finance and Budgetary

Arthur J. Miles, *chairman*
Thomas P. Carpenter,
co-chairman
Donald G. Austin
John D. Bealer, M.D.
George Gordon, Ph.D.
Martin Le Boutillier
Robert Macpherson
R. Bruce Wight
Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A.
Dennis I. Manders, *secretary*

Institutions

Austin McCormick, *chairman*
Thomas Grafton, *co-chairman*
Jeanne Conway
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Joseph Huber Jr.
John McLeon
Jeannette Spencer
R. Bruce Wight
June Russell, *secretary*

International Convention

Donald G. Austin, *chairman*
Junior Anderson
Terrance Penton
Stanley Wilsey
Waneta New, *secretary*

Literature

George Gordon, Ph.D., *chairman*
Ralph Ahringer, *co-chairman*
Margaret Carlson
Paula Carpenter
Fan Content
Charles Edgar
James G. Griffin
Ann Macfarlane
John E. Ryall
Edward Small
Janet Graves (consultant)
Barry Leach (consultant)
Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

Nominating

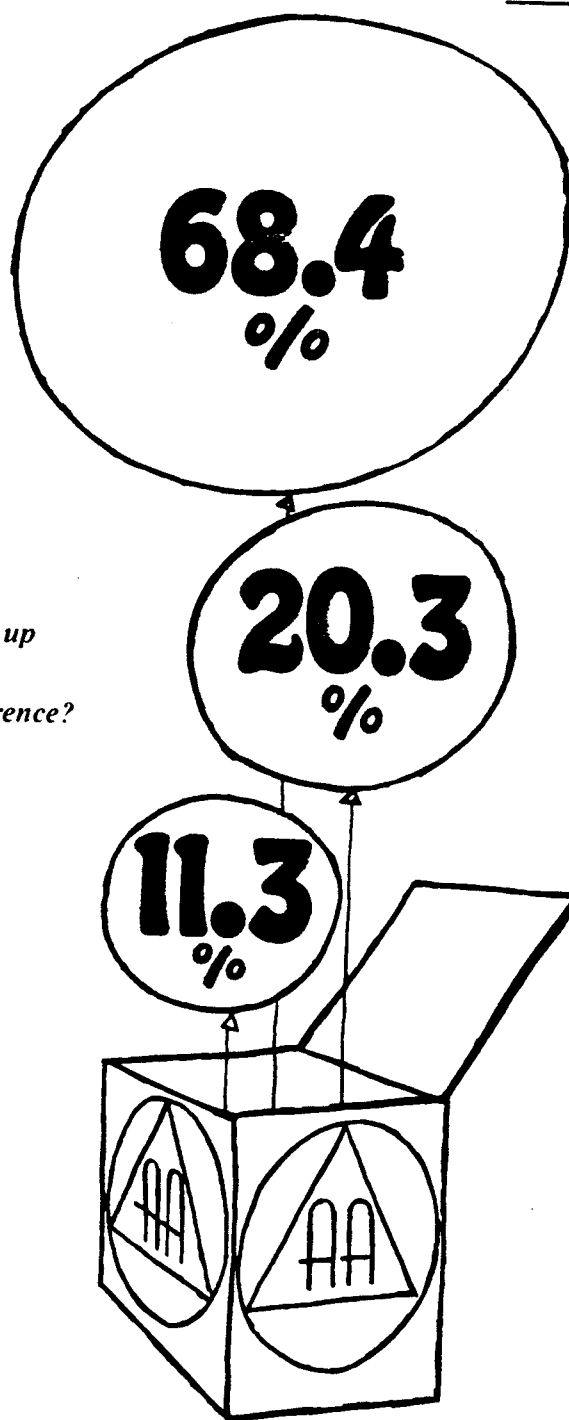
Junior Anderson, *chairman*
Thomas D. Grafton, *co-chairman*
Christian Anderson
David Cooke
Charles H. Hanson
Austin McCormick
Walter Murphy
Terrance Penton
Peter A. C. Watters
Stanley Wilsey
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Policy

Donald G. Austin, *chairman*
James G. Griffin, *co-chairman*
Ralph Ahringer
Junior Anderson
John D. Bealer, M.D.
Cora Louise Belford
Margaret Carlson
David Cooke
Vincent Dole, M.D.
George Gordon, Ph.D.
Beth Kuhlmann
Robert Macpherson
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
Walter Murphy
Terrance Penton
Peter A. C. Watters
R. Bruce Wight
Stanley Wilsey
Ann Macfarlane, *secretary*

Public Information

Walter Murphy, *chairman*
Jerry Danzig, *co-chairman*
David Black
John Bragg
Charles H. Hanson
Virginia Mailman
Jack Morley
Fay Stanley Shulman
Janet Graves (consultant)
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*



91 delegates – 68.4%. Function: represent A.A. groups in fulfilling their ultimate responsibility for A.A.'s world services.

27 trustees, A.A.W.S. directors, Grapevine directors – 20.3%. Function: responsible for policy and implementation.

15 General Service Office and Grapevine staff – 11.3%. Function: carry out policies of, and report to, General Service Board and Conference.

Every Conference member has not only a vote but a voice; not only a right but a responsibility to express his or her views.

Robert E. Hitchins, John L. Norris, M.D., and Robert Pearson are ex-officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

1975 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

John L. Norris, M.D. (Box 251, New London, N.H. 03257), is chairman of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. He is also a member of the trustees' Nominating Committee and was elected to the board in January 1951. Before his retirement, "Dr. Jack" was associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co., Rochester, N.Y. He is former chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and former president of the Industrial Medicine Association and the American Academy of Occupational Medicine.

John D. Bealer, M.D. (3639 Emerson Circle, Bethlehem, Pa. 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John serves on the trustees' Policy and Finance Committees and on the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Vincent P. Dole, M.D. (Rockefeller University, 66th St. and York Ave., New York, N.Y. 10021), was elected to the board in April 1965. He is a professor and senior physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the trustees' Policy and Institutions Committees.

Austin H. MacCormick (Osborne Association, 114 E. 30th St., New York, N.Y. 10016) is first vice-chairman of the General Service Board; was elected to the board in April 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the board previously from October 1949 to April 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a member of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate and Editorial Boards, chairman of the trustees' Institutions Committee, and a member of the Nominating Committee.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (86 Mitchell Ave., Piscataway, N.J. 08854), was elected to the board in April 1971. He is professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. For 18 years prior to that, he was on the faculty of Washington State University, Pullman. He has published many research papers dealing with alcohol, alcoholics, and A.A. He serves on the trustees' Policy and Archives Committees and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Arthur J. Miles (Dime Savings Bank of New York, Fifth Ave. and 48th St., New York, N.Y. 10017) was elected to the board in 1970. He is an executive vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and is on the board of trustees of the Brooklyn Institute of Arts and the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He is chairman of the trustees' Finance and Employee Retirement Committees, and treasurer of the G.S. Board.

***Gordon M. Patrick** (Apt. 409, 50 Underhill Dr., Don Mills, Ont. M3R 2J6, Canada), elected to the board in 1975, is director of counseling services for the Ontario Government Employee Alcoholism Program. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he is now a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism, and serves the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America as vice-chairman of its Occupational Program Section, which he helped to found. A long-time friend of A.A., he considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

****Ralph W. Ahringer** (73 Plymouth Dr. N., Glen Head, N.Y. 11545), elected to the board in April 1971, is chairman and president of the Grapevine Corporate Board and a member of the Nominating, Literature, and Policy Committees. Ralph had his last drink in 1954. He has been a delegate (Panel 13), chairman and treasurer of the Southeastern New York General Service Committee, and president of New York Intergroup. He is advertising manager of Sabin Robbins Paper Co.

****Junior H. Anderson** (31 La Salle Rd., Needham Heights, Mass. 02194), was elected as regional trustee in 1972 from the Northeast Region. He has been sober 17 years and active in group and area A.A., including service as delegate (Panel 19). Junior is sales representative in the Boston district office of the Otis Elevator Company. He is married, with four daughters. He serves as chairman of the Nominating Committee, and is a member of the Policy and Convention Committees.

****Donald G. Austin** (P.O. Drawer #1, Chappell Hill Farm, Chappell Hill, Tex. 77426) was elected to the board from the Southwest Region in April 1971. Don had his last drink in 1953. He is a former chairman of the Texas State A.A. Convention. He is also chairman of the Texas Commission on Alcoholism and a member of the board of the Houston Council on Alcoholism. Don serves on the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and Policy, Finance, Institutions, and Convention Committees.

Margaret J. Carlson (218 Regency Park Dr., Regency Park Apts., Agawam, Mass. 01001) was elected to the board as a general service trustee, U.S., in April 1973. She has had continuous sobriety since 1959 and is interested in P.I., institutions, honor court, and general service activities. Margaret is a former delegate (Panel 20) and was area delegate chairman in 1971. She is employed as administrator of the Alcoholism Detox Center of Greater Springfield. Margaret is a member of the Policy and Literature Committees and chairman of the Conference Committee.

***N.M. ("Mac") Cheater** (5 Frost Ave., Winnipeg, Man. R3K0E1, Canada) was elected general service trustee, Canada, in 1975. He had his last drink in 1956. A Panel 12 delegate, Mac introduced Big Book study sessions in his province. He chaired the first Winter Conference in Manitoba. Mac is sales manager of a television station, is active in civic clubs, and is married.

**New trustee*

***Retiring as of April 1975*

David T. Cooke (229 Dublin Rd., Raleigh, N.C. 27609) was elected in 1974 as Southeastern U.S. regional trustee for a three-year term. Dave had his last drink in 1957, began Third Legacy work as G.S.R., and in 1965 became area committee member and officer. He was Conference delegate in 1967-68. Dave served as chairman of his state committee in 1969-70 and has served on his state governor's Advisory Council on Alcoholism. Married, he has been a high-school teacher and is now a highway engineer for a state department. Dave is a member of the Policy and Conference Committees and Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

George N. Gordon, Ph.D. (110-15 71 Rd., Forest Hills, N.Y. 11375), a director and treasurer of the A.A. Grapevine, was elected general service trustee in 1972. Since his last drink, in 1964, he has served his local group in most offices and the New York Intergroup Association on several committees. He is chairman of the Communications Arts Department at Hofstra University in Hempstead, N.Y., and author or co-author of 15 nonfiction books, 13 of them written after joining A.A. George is a member of the Finance Committee in the capacity of Grapevine treasurer, a member of the Policy and Employee Retirement Committees, and chairman of the Archives and Literature Committees.

****Thomas D. Grafton** (#1 Iroquois Bay, St. Boniface 6, Man., Canada) was elected to the board as a general service trustee, Canada, in April 1971. He had his last drink in 1960 and is a former delegate (Panel 18) from Manitoba and former chairman of the Manitoba General Service Committee. A member of the legal firm of Grafton and Co., Tom is also a member of the Canadian Bar Association. He serves as a member of the Policy, Institutions, and Nominating Committees.

James G. Griffin (302 S. Jefferson, North Platte, Nebr. 69101) was elected trustee from the West Central Region April 1972. He has been sober over 20 years and has served as G.S.R., committee member, chairman of the state committee, and delegate (Panel 18). He is married, owns and pilots his own plane, and has had a successful career for 17 years in the insurance business. He is a member of the Policy, Literature, and Conference Committees.

***Charles H. Hanson** (42 Puritan Rd., Fairfield, Conn. 06430) was elected general service trustee in 1975 and continues to serve on the Grapevine Corporate Board and the trustees' Public Information Committee. Chuck had his last drink in 1966. A frequent Grapevine contributor, he is married and the father of three. He is now president of an advertising agency, after supervisory duties in three of the best-known Madison Avenue firms.

Robert Macpherson (Rocktree Apts., P.O. Box 192, Pleasant Valley, Conn. 06063) was elected to the board in July 1973. He had his last drink in 1947 and has been an active member of the same group since 1949. Bob was a member of the first Connecticut General Service Assembly in 1951 and a Panel 9 delegate. His business life was in office management and accounting. Bob is married and retired, with a small accounting and tax practice. He serves on the Policy, Finance, and Employee Retirement Committees, and is chairman of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

**New trustee*

Walter J. Murphy (401 E. 81st St., New York, N.Y. 10028) was elected general service trustee in 1973. He has been active in A.A. for 15 years. He is currently chairman of A.A.W.S. and the Public Information Committee and is a member of the Nominating, Policy, and Employee Retirement Committees. He is public relations counsel for N.C.A., its New York City affiliate, and the Smithers Alcoholism Center. He is married and has one son.

Terrance Penton (132 28th St., Brandon, Man., Canada), was elected in 1974 to serve the last two years of retiring Matt Newell's unexpired term as a regional trustee for Western Canada. Then sober 14 years, Terry served on roundup and area G.S. committees and as Conference delegate (Panel 20). He has chaired the advisory committee of his provincial alcoholism foundation. A chartered life underwriter for 25 years, Terry is married and owns an estate-planning consulting firm. He serves on the Policy, Nominating, and Convention Committees.

***Mike Rainbolt** (P.O. Box 248, Cordell, Okla. 73632). When elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in 1975, Mike had 28 years' sobriety. After group and area service, he was a Panel 15 delegate, later chaired his state P.I. committee, and is still active in state A.A. An alumnus of Oklahoma University, Mike has a background in real estate and land titles and is a petroleum landman, operating his own oil and gas exploration firm. He is married and an elder in his church.

***John E. Waterfield** (2900 Adams Mill Road, Washington, D.C. 20009) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 18 years' sobriety. John was a Panel 23 delegate, having served previously in many group, intergroup, and G.S. area capacities in A.A., as well as on his local alcoholism council. He set up a one-to-one "sponsorship" program for informing medical students about A.A., and originated the mini-conference idea. Married, John has his own creative advertising and marketing business.

Peter A. G. Watters (366 Rebecca St., Oakville, Ont., Canada), was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1974. Pete has been sober since 1960. He was chairman of Toronto Intergroup 1965-66, Conference delegate 1967-68, and chairman of the Ontario G.S. Committee. He has been on advisory committees to local recovery and addiction-research facilities. Single, Pete is vice-president and owner of an education products distributorship. He serves on the Policy, Nominating, and Conference Committees.

R. Bruce Wight (2336 North Lewis Ave., Waukegan, Ill. 60085) was elected in 1974 to a three-year term as East Central U.S. regional trustee. Bruce had his last drink in 1951. He was Conference delegate on Panel 14, and is still on his area G.S. committee. He serves on his county mental health advisory board. Bruce has had extensive military and business experience, and is president of a manufacturing corporation. His wife, Helen, is also in A.A. Bruce is on the Policy, Finance, and Institutions Committees.

Stanley R. Wilsey (110 Toyon Drive, Fairfax, Calif. 94930) had been sober 23 years when elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1974. Stan has been a Conference delegate

***Retiring as of April 1975*

1975 Conference Members

and editor of *Good News*, local A.A. newspaper, and was advisory co-chairman of the 1960 International A.A. Convention in Long Beach. Married, Stan has had experience in the food, insurance, and auto businesses and as a police official. He now supervises investigation for a state department concerned with registration of vehicles and the licensing of drivers. Stan is a member of the Policy, Nominating, and Convention Committees.

A.A. World Services directors

Walter J. Murphy, <i>chairman</i>	Robert Macpherson, <i>treasurer</i>
Robert E. Hitchins, <i>president</i>	Christian Anderson
Jerry Danzig, <i>first vice-president</i>	Martin Le Boutillier
Ann Macfarlane, <i>second vice-president</i>	Beth Kuhlmann, <i>secretary (nonvoting)</i>

A.A. Grapevine directors

Ralph Ahringer, <i>chairman, president</i>	Grapevine staff
Paula Carpenter, <i>vice-president, secretary</i>	
George N. Gordon, <i>treasurer</i>	
Thomas Carpenter	
Charles H. Hanson	
Joseph Huber Jr.	
Austin MacCormick	Paula Carpenter, <i>managing editor</i>
Jack Morley	Jack Morley, <i>editor</i>
Edward Small	

General Service Office staff

Robert E. Hitchins, <i>chairman, General Services</i>	Cora Louise Belford
Robert G. Pearson, <i>general manager</i>	Susan Coyle
Niles Peebles, <i>assistant general manager</i>	Beth Kuhlmann
Midge McFadden, <i>assistant to manager</i>	Betty Liddle
	Ann Macfarlane
	Phyllis Masback
	Waneta New
	June Russell
	Mary Ellen Uribe

Others attending Conference (not as voting members)

Non-A.A.
 Donna Berkowitz, *supervisor, Stenographic*
 Charles Columbia, *assistant controller*
 Ann Couig, *assistant to Conference secretary*
 Al Cryan, *supervisor, Shipping*
 Edward Gordon, *assistant controller*
 Kleina Jones, *departmental coordinator/personnel manager*
 Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File*
 Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records*
 Dennis Manders, *controller*
 Denise Stern, *office manager*
 Madeline Whitlock, *recording secretary*
 Nell Wing, *archivist*
 Mario Wistol, *supervisor, Accounting*
 Owen J. Flanagan, *C.P.A.*

A.A.

Yolanda Lazo, *correspondence assistant*
 Two observers from trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community
 Two observers from trustees' Finance Committee
 Two observers from Grapevine Editorial Board
 Two observers from trustees' Institutions Committee
 Two observers from trustees' Literature Committee
 Two observers from trustees' Public Information Committee

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 25th Conference is made up of Panel 24 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 25 (new delegates).

State	Panel	
Alabama & N.W. Florida	(25)	James E. Wright, 406 Woodrow Street, Ft. Walton Beach, FL 32548
Alaska	(24)	Jo Hajdu, Box 627, Kodiak, AK 99615
Arizona	(24)	Wesley T. Smith, 3022 West Glendora, Phoenix, AZ 85107
Arkansas	(25)	James A. (Gus) Jowers, 218 Garfield Avenue, Newport, AR 72112
California	(25)	Southern - Jim Shaw, 8815 Stewart Avenue, Los Angeles, CA 90045
	(25)	Northern Coastal - George Dorsey, 4761 Paradise Drive, Tiburon, CA 94920
	(24)	Northern Interior - Jack Barnes, 1117 El Terino Avenue, Modesto, CA 95359
	(24)	San Diego - Margi Blake, P.O. Box 719, Oceanside, CA 92054
	(24)	Mid-Southern - Genevieve R. Leher, P.O. Box 3134, Torrance, CA 90510
Colorado	(25)	Don Burrow, 412 East 11 Street, Loveland, CO 80537
Connecticut	(25)	Warren Russell, 31 Andover Road, East Hartford, CT 06108
Delaware	(24)	Clayton Hocker, Ocean View, DE 19970
District of Columbia	(25)	Fred Forbes, 51-47 Massachusetts Avenue, Bethesda, MD 20016
Florida	(25)	Northern - S.A. (Buck) Raulerson, 429 Second Avenue N., Jacksonville Beach, FL 32250
	(25)	Southern - Samuel E. Smith, 820 N.W. 87 Avenue, Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126
Georgia	(24)	Robert Fowler, 321 East 48 Street, Savannah, GA 31405
Hawaii	(25)	Harry Lake, 1303 C. Kipapui, Pearl City, HI 96782
Idaho	(24)	Donald E. Browns, 318 N. Fifth, Payette, ID 83661

State	Panel	State	Panel
Illinois	(25) Chicago – Fran Adams, 3310 Grant, Evanston, IL 60201	Nebraska	(24) Neal Boeshart, 104 Hillcrest Avenue, Laurel, NB 68745
	(24) Northern – Henry Skees, 7828 40th Avenue, Kenosha, WI 53140	Nevada	(25) Joan A. Barclay, 1520 Arthur Avenue, Las Vegas, NV 89101
	(25) Southern – John Neal, Box 68, Louisville, IL 62858	New Hampshire	(24) Pete Charland, 45 Clover Lane, Portsmouth, NH 03801
Indiana	(25) Northern – Joseph Holman, 1418 Fletcher Avenue, Fort Wayne, IN 46803	New Jersey	(25) Northern – James Riley, 3 Pearl Street, Dumont, NJ 07628
	(24) Southern – Don Wenning, 324 E. North Street, Greensburg, IN 47240		(24) Southern – Noel LeClair, 157 Cooper Avenue, Woodlynne, NJ 08107
Iowa	(25) H. A. (Al) Weston, 2621 Guthrie, Des Moines, IA 50316	New Mexico	(24) Lorraine Schall, 4212 Constitution, N.E., Albuquerque, NM 87110
Kansas	(24) Clyde Jones, Box 454, Coffeyville, KS 67337	New York	(25) Central – James P. Hunter, 57 Oswego Street, Baldwinsville, NY 13027
Kentucky	(24) Richard (Mick) McFarland, 1903 Payne Street, Louisville, KY 40206		(24) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Arthur (Tiny) Donaldson, Box 247, R.D. 2, Catskill, NY 12414
Louisiana	(25) Dede Hoffmann, 1225 Trudeau Drive, Metairie, LA 70003		(25) *Southeastern – Walter Fetterer, 51-10 Marathon Parkway, Little Neck, NY 11362
Maine	(24) Carlton Mendell, Box 1861, Portland, ME 04104		(24) Western – James McCartin, 304 Charlesgate Circle, Amherst, NY 14051
Maryland	(24) Thomas Shoemaker, 482 Mirabile Lane, Baltimore, MD 21224		(25) Edith Campbell, Box 181, Chapel Hill, NC 27514
Massachusetts	(25) Eastern – Ray Sullivan, 180 Broadway, Lynn, MA 01904	North Carolina	(24) Fred Blair, 2515 S. 10, Grand Forks, ND 58201
	(24) Western – Robert Tetrault, 266 Centre Street, Indian Orchard, MA 01151	North Dakota	(25) Central & Southeast – Retha M. Gresham, 959 Woodhill Drive, Columbus, OH 43212
Michigan	(25) Central – Duane Harder, 2144 South Unionville Road, Bay Port, MI 48720	Ohio	(25) Northeast – Robert Bacon, 958 Brittain Road, Akron, OH 44305
	(25) Southeast – Andrew Quaid Jr., 634 Lakewood Boulevard, Detroit, MI 48215		(24) N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – Chuck Sherer, 1704 Mulberry Street, Toledo, OH 43608
	(24) Western – Peter Slager, Box 211, Montague, MI 49437		(24) S.S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Roy Homer, 4560 Walton Creek Road, Cincinnati, OH 45243
Minnesota	(24) Northern – Gordon B. Hagen, 214 E. Cedar Street, Fergus Falls, MN 56537	Oklahoma	(25) Clark McCall, 439 N.W. 44 Street, Oklahoma City, OK 73118
	(25) Southern – Marvin Spooner, 7300 13th Avenue So., Richfield, MN 55423	Oregon	(24) Howard Smith, 495 S.E. 19 Street, Gresham, OR 97030
Mississippi	(24) Nancy Rushing, 2833 14th Place, Meridian, MS 39301		(25) Eastern – Francis (Fran) A. Green, 34 Berger Street, Emmaus, PA 18049
Missouri	(25) Eastern – Byron Barnes, 7 E. 9th, Fulton, MO 65251	Pennsylvania	(25) Western – Ellis Bedford, 1741 Outlook Drive, Verona, PA 15147
	(25) Western – F. P. Ryan, P.O. Box 613, Marshall, MO 65340		
Montana	(24) Wayne Bramble, 620 Grand Avenue, Billings, MT 59102	*Walter Fetterer died on May 8, 1975; his term will be filled by the alternate delegate, Len Jordan, 483 West End Avenue, New York, N.Y. 10024.	

1975 Conference Members

State	Panel	Canada	Province	Panel
Rhode Island	(24) Dorothy Gadoury, 45 East Shore Drive, Apt. 1, Coventry, RI 02816			
South Carolina	(24) Peggy Busch, 1212 Hahn Street, Aiken, SC 29801		Alberta	(24) Bill Leicht, Box 474, Innisfail, Alta., Canada
South Dakota	(24) Horton Stoakes, 302 N. Sherman Avenue, Sioux Falls, SD 57103		British Columbia/ Yukon	(25) Abe Wiebe, 4446 Quebec Street, Vancouver, B.C., Canada V5V 3L7
Tennessee	(24) J. J. (Joe) Mulloy, P.O. Box 2763, Nashville, TN 37219		Manitoba	(24) Reeta Hourie, 494 Main Street, Selkirk, Man., Canada R1A 1W3
Texas	(25) Northeast - John B. Henderson, P.O. Box 754, Linden, TX 75563		New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	(24) Eddie MacInnis, Box 1444, Charlottetown, P.E.I., Canada
	(24) Northwest - Brian Gilmore, 2508 62nd Street, Lubbock, TX 79413		Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	(25) Charles McCarthy, 6 Wyncrest Drive, Dartmouth, N.S., Canada B2X 1C6
	(25) Southeast - Olga Morris, P.O. Box 276, Friendswood, TX 77546		Ontario	(25) Eastern - Earl G. Homuth, 152 Laurier Avenue, Pembroke, Ont., Canada K8A 2J2
	(24) Southwest - Tony Fowler, 1609 N. Laurent, Victoria, TX 77901			(25) Northeastern - W. J. (Bill) Syms, 70 McNabb, Sault Ste. Marie, Ont., Canada
Utah	(25) Ike Bowers, 5072 El Amador, Salt Lake City, UT 84117			(25) Northwestern - Jack Davis, 123 East Francis Street, Thunder Bay F, Ont., Canada
Vermont	(24) Don Dusha, P.O. Box 175, East Arlington, VT 05252			(24) Western - Duncan McArthur, 337 Dunlop Crescent, Burlington, Ont., Canada
Virginia	(25) Ann Nuckols, 3301 Clover Hill Drive, Portsmouth, VA 23703			(25) Northeastern - Benoit Perron, 2030 Boulevard Père Lelièvre, Quebec, Que., Canada G1P 2X1
Washington	(25) Natalie Schwanke, 4558 110th N.E., Kirkland, WA 98033		Quebec	(24) *Northwestern - George McKerral, 99 - 11th Street, Laval des Rapides, Que., Canada H7N 1T2
West Virginia	(25) Larry Sebastian, 310 Maryland Avenue, Clarksburg, WV 26301			(25) Southeastern - Raymond Houle, 449 Notre Dame Ouest, Victoriaville, Que., Canada G6P 1S7
Wisconsin	(24) N. Wisconsin/Upper Michigan - Paul Slatky, 1132 13th Avenue, Green Bay, WI 54304			(24) Southwestern - Louis Geoffrion, 768 St. Clare Road, Mt. Royal, Que., Canada H3R 2M3
	(25) Southern - Bernard Scarseth, 1524 South 22 Street, La Crosse, WI 54601			(24) W.G. (Bill) Davis, 616 20th Street West, Prince Albert, Sask., Canada S6V 4H3
Wyoming	(24) *Larry W. (Turk) Lassiter, River Route, Box 34, Basin, WY 82410			
Puerto Rico	(24) Trinidad Rivera Chevere, 1102 14th N.E. Street, Puerto Nuevo, Puerto Rico 00920			